

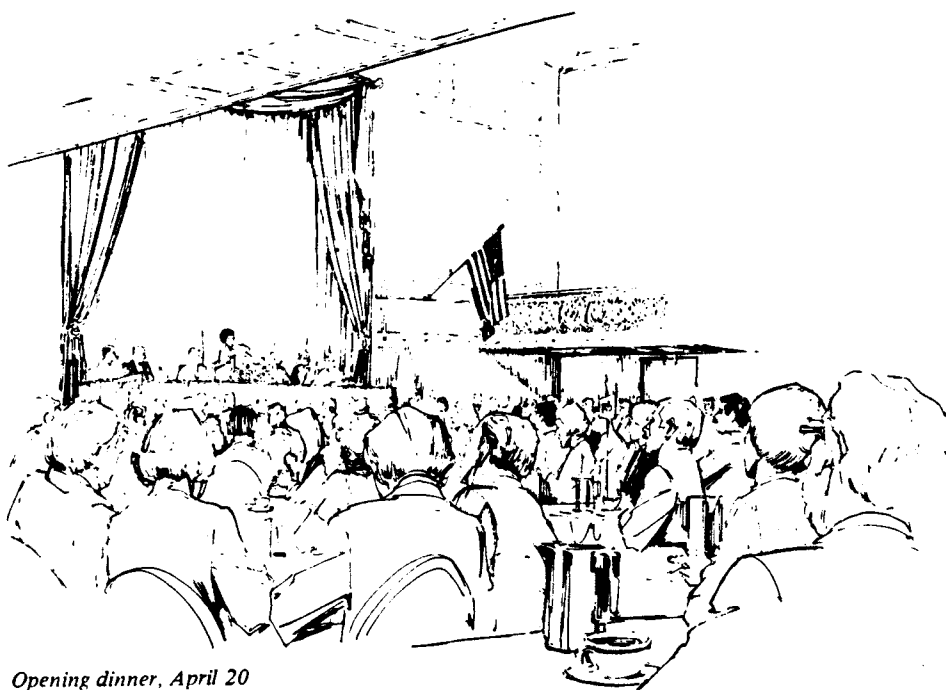
Participation: The Key to Recovery

The Thirtieth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1980

Final Report

Roosevelt Hotel
New York City
April 20-26



Opening dinner, April 20



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Drawings in this issue by Al Herr



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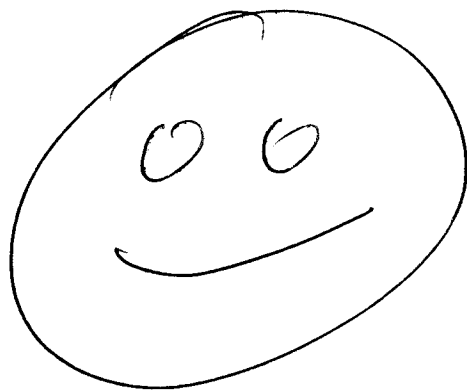
Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

A.A. Regional Forums: See trustee committee and staff reports, p. 38.

Regional trustees: See talks by retiring trustees, pp. 8-9; Ask-It Basket question, pp. 27-28; report of trustees' Nominating Committee, pp. 40-41; Advisory Action 69, p. 49; brief biographies, pp. 58-59

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30th Conference Lives Up to Its Theme

Opening day

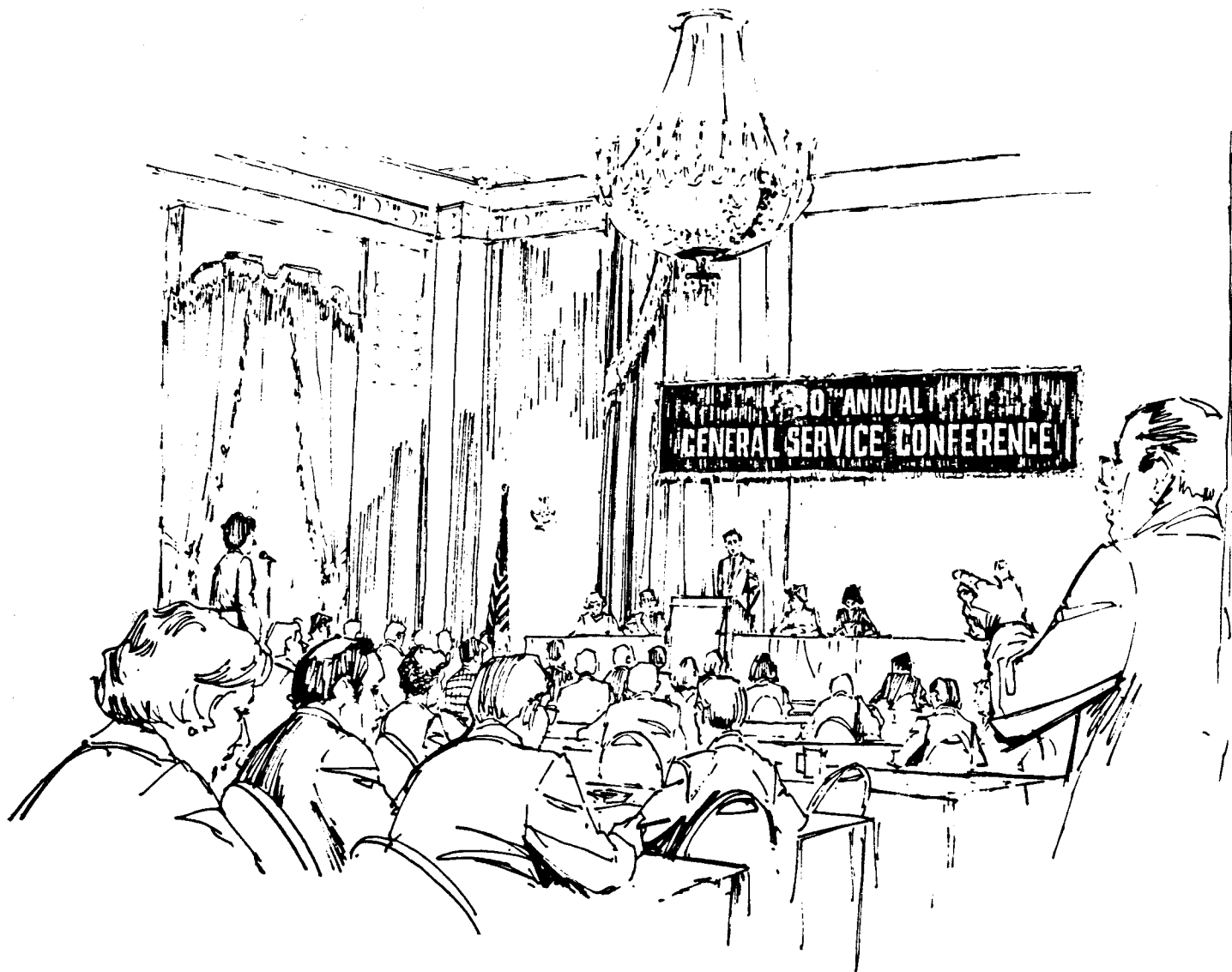
Lively debate, along with a palpable sense of unity, characterized the 30th General Service Conference, April 20-26, 1980. All Conference members brought to life the theme, "Participation: The Key to Recovery."

Unofficially, the week opened on Sunday afternoon and evening. At an afternoon "trusted servants' sharing session," moderated by Frank Buffo (delegate from Utah), delegates, trustees, General Service Office and Grapevine staff members, and A.A. World Services and GV directors talked of their impressions of previous Conferences. The Sunday-night opening dinner was, as always, a moving occasion, as Conference members and guests got acquainted across the tables and enjoyed the A.A. meeting. LaVelle Clifford (Southwest U.S. regional trustee) led the meeting this year, and speakers were Curtis Monahan (G.S.O. staff), Retha Gresham (Grapevine staff), Anna Diggs (Central and Southeastern Ohio delegate), Herb Weatherwax (Hawaii), and Judd Black (Central New York).

Vice-chairperson Gordon Patrick, presiding in place of Milton

Maxwell, who was unable to be present, began the week's official business Monday morning, April 21, in the Terrace Room of New York's Hotel Roosevelt. Bob Pearson (G.S.O.'s general manager) then called the roll of Conference members and introduced Conference committee chairpersons. After the keynote address by Cec Corrigan (see next page) and words of welcome from Bob Bisanz, area delegate chairperson (p. 7), formal Conference proceedings began with the General Service Board report.

More reports, presentations, Ask-It Basket sessions, a viewing of the new archives filmstrip, a viewing and sharing session on the film "A.A.—An Inside View," opportunity to see and hear new public information TV and radio spots, and, of course, committee meetings—the heart of the Conference—jam-packed the five working days. An innovation this year was the Thursday-evening sharing session on "How Well Is Our Conference Structure Working?" (p. 7). All participated in discussion; once again, a sense of unity prevailed; and each person present left with a conviction that this year's Conference meeting was working splendidly.



Opening talk

‘What have I got to contribute?’

We will open this 30th Annual A.A. Conference with the Serenity Prayer. But just before that, I would like to observe one minute of silence in remembrance and honor of our old friend Austin MacCormick [trustee emeritus, who died on October 24, 1979, aged 86]. Many in this room will remember him with deep affection, and it is hard to accept the fact that he isn't sitting back there. I know Austin will be here with us in spirit. . . .

New delegates of Panel 30, I wonder if you are feeling a bit as I did at my first Conference, asking yourselves. "What on earth am I doing here? What have I got to contribute to this Conference?" But if you feel scared and inadequate, just think how a nonalcoholic trustee feels who hasn't even "qualified"!

I pondered about this contribution thing until I recalled back in my high school days when we had a Rugby team. There was a kid by the name of Doc who was a real enthusiastic football player. He just loved the game and anything associated with it. The only trouble was that Doc had trouble with his hands and his feet and didn't coordinate very well. He didn't make the team. Doc wasn't disappointed. He became the water-bearer, the team mascot, and a morale-booster. And Doc made a great contribution, because he was enthusiastic. I love the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous and everything about it, and the only thing I can contribute is a little enthusiasm.

I can promise the Panel 30 delegates the experience of a lifetime here. Miracles will happen in this room. You will gain a new perspective on our Fellowship. You will learn that it isn't "they" who are responsible for A.A., but you. The phrase "trusted servant" will take on a new meaning. You may be uncomfortable at first when you realize you don't represent here your group or city or area, but all of Alcoholics Anonymous. You and you alone are the custodian of the Legacies, the Concepts, the General Service Office, and the whole bit. Have a really good Conference!

Gordon Patrick, vice-chairperson, General Service Board

Keynote

Participation: The Key to Recovery

Participation means being involved, not only in service work, as we are all privileged to be this week, but also in our group, our job, our family, and as we recover more, in our community.

A couple of years ago, I decided to try to get my own group to participate more, and it has turned out to be a fantastic experience. We set up temporary sponsors and then a lot of committees, so everyone would have a job to do. Our committees include: preparing for meetings; greeters; birthdays; cleanup and closing up; literature; Grapevine; room and equipment upkeep; "Sunshine"; sponsorship; newcomers' Step meetings; newcomers' orientation meetings; and finance.

We elected committee chairpersons, and they selected their

own committees to make sure that every person in our group had an opportunity to participate. In orientation meetings, middle and older members talk about the Fellowship and its program. This has taught members *what* they belong to, as we study the history of A.A. and allow participation from the grass roots. Now, when members are asked to contribute money, they know why, and what they are contributing to. This started as an experiment but has become a natural part of our group; even some older members think it must have always been like this.

I have been fortunate. A long time ago, someone said to me, "Don't gyp yourself in A.A. Get what is coming to you." I took this to heart and went from Recovery to Unity, and then into Service. Because of a lack of sponsorship, many people get into service before they have recovered or know anything about unity. I believe this lack of sponsorship is probably the weakest part of A.A. worldwide today.

I started to apply the Traditions in my own life when I had recovered as much as I could and needed further spiritual growth. I found that my group was the most important thing to me. I was told that I could become a leader as a trusted servant only, that my group and I could be autonomous, that I could not only carry a message, but also receive the message of tenderness and love, and that I could be a member of my group by doing these simple things.

I was taught how to be self-supporting financially, emotionally, and spiritually. I learned about service boards, committees, outside issues, and public controversy. Finally, I learned about anonymity, which is simply the ability to forget about something good you have done, and then go out and do something else.

I would like to throw out a challenge. First, to the delegates: Don't take yourselves too seriously; learn how to participate; and do your homework, as it is a little difficult to lead people if you don't know where you are leading them. To the staff: Please keep up your dedication and love in your participation, not only in getting these Conferences ready, but in all your endeavors throughout the years. And to the board: As we participate, let's always remember that we do not represent areas or regions, but A.A. worldwide.

Cec Corrigan, regional trustee (Western Canada)

Groups and members — spring 1980

	Groups	Members
United States	20,359	387,875
Canada	3,349	56,672
Overseas	14,016	362,772
Treatment facilities	1,156 ¹	23,956 ¹
Correctional facilities	1,084 ¹	35,336 ¹
Lone Members		760
Internationalists		800
	39,964	868,171 ²

¹ U.S. and Canada only.

² Including nonreported members it is estimated that there are more than 1,000,000 members worldwide.

'The ability to withstand mistakes'

My sponsor described me, early in my sobriety, as "stark raving sober." I had been active in service for about ten years when I came to the 1979 Conference overprepared and anxious.

A couple of attitudes inhibited me. I viewed the staff members and the trustees as being superior. But now I've had the opportunity to attend A.A. meetings with some of them. The good news is that staff members and Class B trustees are, first and foremost, drunks. They earned their stripes the same way you and I did. The other thing that inhibited me was the tremendous fear of making a mistake. I think the greatest ability the Fellowship as a whole has is the ability to withstand mistakes. Our safety doesn't come from making perfect decisions; our safety comes from being a group conscience. If something gets done less than perfectly, there will be another Conference, another committee, another person who will change it if it has to be changed.

We have come to work together as brothers and sisters. We are one; our roles are the same; our primary purpose is the same; we are peers. I come here with greater comfort, joy, and appreciation because I respect you, my brothers and sisters.

Bob Bisanz (Southern Minnesota), area delegate chairperson

Delegates meeting

Concerns of 91 areas shared informally

Presentations on the Traditions (by Dave Buckley, Colorado) and anonymity (by Elma Stone, Eastern Missouri) were given at the yearly off-the-record delegates meeting, Tuesday night, April 22. Since other Conference members are not present at this meeting, it is not a part of "official" Conference business. Bob Bisanz, area delegate chairperson, presided and reported that delegates took full advantage of this time to get to know one another and share their areas' concerns.

Jacqueline Jones (Kentucky) was elected delegate chairperson to take office immediately at the close of the 1980 Conference meeting. Irving Poissant (Arizona) is the new alternate chairperson.

A proposal that the Conference night off be changed from Friday to Wednesday was brought to the Conference as a whole for discussion. (No action was taken.)

Archives filmstrip previewed

Fernand Ippersiel, chairperson of the trustees' Archives Committee, prefaced the Wednesday-evening showing of the filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" by saying: "I wonder what Bill W., our co-founder, would tell us tonight if he was here trying to solve some of A.A.'s problems.

"The November 1978 Grapevine reprinted an article by Bill about acceptance. In this article, first published in March 1962, Bill says: 'Therefore, our very first problem is to accept our present circumstances as they are, ourselves as we are, and the people about us *as they are*.'

"I think the idea of this archives filmstrip is a way of trying to understand more deeply some of our principles, like acceptance," Fernand said. "And I believe it's important that we return to the reality of A.A.'s history and *not* to some kind of *myth* that might direct us somewhere else, far away from the essentials."

The new filmstrip was created to keep the record straight by giving a portrait of A.A. from its earliest days. It shares with A.A.'s everywhere archival material that until now could be seen only by those members who could visit the archives (located at the General Service Office in New York).

The first part of the filmstrip focuses on A.A.'s first 15 years, with pictures of co-founders Bill W. and Dr. Bob, along with those of nonalcoholic friends who were there with help and support at turning points for the Fellowship. The second part updates the story with photos and text about places and events involved in the spread of the message through the Third Legacy, Service.

Sharing session

How well is our Conference structure working?

For once, the Conference sharing session centered on specific topics. Two had already been considered by the 1979 Conference, but it was later suggested that they be discussed further in 1980. The third suggested topic has been brought up periodically over the years. All three fell logically under one heading, since all concerned Conference structure.

1 "Reconsider the possibility of having 75% of the General Service Conference votes in the hands of the delegates."

A 1979 Advisory Action had termed 75% "an unrealistic figure" and recommended that the delegate percentage never fall below 66-2/3%. As one delegate pointed out in the 1980 discussion, the current figure is 67.4%. Many delegates had taken the question to their areas, and only two reported any firm local opinion favoring the change. Most found "no burning desire to change it." The sense of the meeting, favoring the present ratio, was forecast in comments such as:

"If it works, don't change it." "I don't believe that we ever could come into a situation where we would have all delegates opposed to the remainder of the Conference." "I presented this item to my district committee, and their response was: 'Oh-oh—somebody doesn't trust somebody. You better find out about it.' When I came here Sunday night, I felt the warmth and loving in the room that I thought I would feel." "Everybody here seems to be working for the good of A.A. as a whole, and I don't believe that changing the percentage figure would make any difference." "We need to trust our trusted servants just as we are trusted."

2 "Discuss the role of the general service trustees and how they are elected."

The 1979 Conference, after listening to two presentations on the topic, had shown no inclination to change from the present system, in which general service trustee candidates come from the New York metropolitan area, have been serving as A.A.W.S. or Grapevine directors, and are named by the trustees' Nominating Committee. In reconsidering the topic, 1980 Conference members were chiefly concerned with hearing details on the work done by these trustees. It became apparent that "in town" trustees really do need to be in town quite often. For instance, one serves as chairperson of a board committee that meets monthly; another is consulted on financial matters almost every week, devoting about two hours each time. Again, a sense of the meeting indicated satisfaction with current procedures.

3 "The delegate term should be extended from two to three years."

A sense of the meeting favored retention of the two-year term, which is in gear with the rotation system of the whole Conference structure, beginning with G.S.R.'s. One delegate had personal experience to share: He attended his first Conference meeting as an alternate, was then elected delegate, had nearly completed service at his third Conference—and found that more than enough!

If the sense of the meeting on any of those three points had indicated a desire for change, the suggestion would have been forwarded to the 1981 Conference, via the appropriate committee, for its action. This was explained before the sharing session, on Thursday evening. That morning, the Conference had approved the recommendation of its Agenda Committee (see p. 46) that the 1981 theme be built around Fellowship self-inventory, focusing on the Conference.

Conference sidelights

The ages of 1980 area delegates averaged 54 years and ranged from 36 to 72. The average length of sobriety was 12½ years; the range, from six to 32. This year, on a 1979 Conference recommendation, delegates were also asked how long they had been involved in A.A. service work. Answers ranged from four years to 32, averaging out at 12. . . . While the delegates were hard at work, their spouses were almost as busy enjoying themselves, thanks to the Hospitality Committee, a volunteer group of local A.A. and Al-Anon members. Sightseeing tours



went from the top of the Empire State Building to Macy's basement—now, to the delight of the visitors, metamorphosed into a picturesque street of shops. Luncheon on Thursday was at the midtown Manhattan home of Mary Bragg, chairperson of the committee. A thank-you note described it as "a beautiful ending for a happy week." But there was more to come: a boat trip around Manhattan and a visit at Stepping Stones, home of Lois and Bill Wilson. Delegates joined their spouses on the latter, Saturday afternoon, when the 1980 Conference meeting was over.

Closing brunch

'Decisions based on spiritual principles'

Delicious eggs, bacon, and sausage are only extras at any Conference closing brunch. A mixture of laughter and tears, thank-yous and goodbyes, provided the substance this year, as three trustees said their farewells.

After opening remarks by Class A trustee Gordon Patrick, who presided, outgoing delegate chairperson Bob Bisanz (Southern Minnesota) brought a laugh by describing the Conference as "long periods of boredom punctuated by moments of terror," and spoke of how impressed he was with the contributions of everyone in the room. Jackie Jones (Kentucky), incoming delegate chairperson, urged her fellow Panel 30 delegates to give next year's new delegates the same warm welcome she received from Panel 29.

Bob Pearson brought greetings from board chairperson Milton Maxwell, who, Bob said, had followed the progress of the Conference with great interest. Bob expressed thanks to all the G.S.O. employees whose behind-the-scenes work made the Conference possible, and mentioned especially Donna Berkowitz, Adeline Wilmot, Ann Couig, and Tony Osnato. He thanked Sarah Price, Conference secretary, and other staff members for their hard work.

Commenting on the atmosphere of the Conference, Bob said: "This was an outstanding Conference because of the feeling of unity among the people who are here in different roles. There was a real dissipation of any feeling of 'them and us.' What came out, after discussion, were decisions that were based on basics, on spiritual principles."

The talks by the three rotating trustees, as well as recollections of past Conferences by "Dr. Jack" Norris, are summarized here. (Dr. John Bealer, also rotating off the board, was not able to attend.)

'Let's keep A.A. alive'

Cec Corrigan, retiring as Western Canada regional trustee, recalled, "I was told at my first meeting, 'Cec, not only do we want you, but we love you and need you.' That was the first time anyone had wanted me around in a long time.

"I got into service work early in my A.A. life because I had a car. I was the G.S.R. for almost three years. Then I found out that the group was supposed to pay my expenses, and when I told them about this—they elected another G.S.R.

"I've been privileged to serve in every capacity. I was on Panel 8 as a delegate. My name came up as a trustee nominee, not once, but five times! Finally, I did get to be a trustee, and I'll be ever grateful.

"At my first International Convention, in Long Beach, they said, 'Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends'; in Toronto, they said, 'I Am Responsible'; and in Miami, 'Walk in Unity.' At Denver, it was 'Let It Begin With Me,' and I realized that everything I have to do had to begin with me.

"Many years ago, I started reading the Big Book every morning. I read other things, too. I even read the Bible—I know it isn't Conference-approved literature, but I read it anyway. We never know what a day will bring, but if we start off with reading about spiritual principles, we'll be ready for it.

"Let's keep A.A. alive, no matter what it costs us, in money or in time—because it's so beautiful, and there's so much work to be done out there."

'Service is gratitude made visible'

Another regional trustee, Don Nicolson (West Central U.S.), said, "I like to go to meetings, because I just love the effect it produces. The same way with service. When I started in service, I didn't know what it was all about. But you taught me that people can do only that which they have learned, and that much of the learning is in the doing. You also taught me that I can't think myself into right living, but that, through the practice of the Twelve Steps, I can live myself into right thinking.

"I think this morning of those unsung heroes, the nonalcoholic trustees, and I wonder if we all realize how much they have given to this Fellowship. What is it that makes these people outstanding? I think it's the way they give; they give of themselves, for our benefit, and I'm grateful.

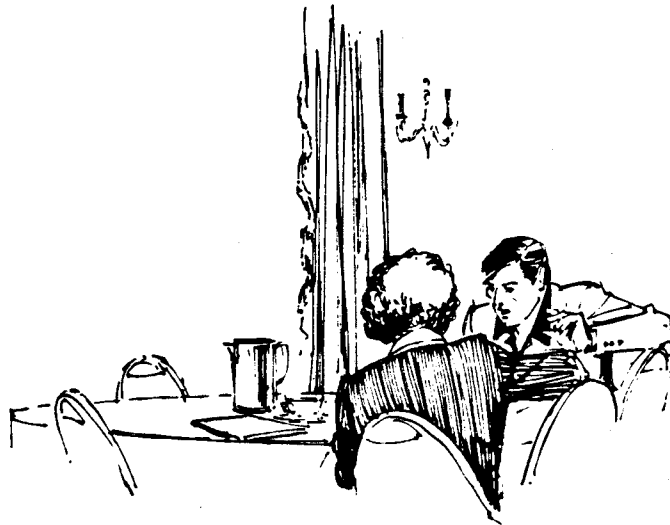
"What do we mean by love in A.A.? I found an answer through reading, and I want to quote from Anne Morrow Lindbergh: 'Love is a force that enables us to give other things. It is the motivating power. It is not a result; it is a cause. It is valueless unless we can give something else because of it.'

"Service to me is gratitude made visible. Thanks to each and every one of you; you've reinforced my commitment to giving through the practice of love and service."

'It's a learning process'

Introduced by Gordon Patrick as "a displaced leprechaun, New York cut," general service trustee Ed Small began by saying that he would talk "from the top of my head and the bottom of my heart.

"I spent an inordinate amount of time when I first came on the board worrying about my contribution. I was terribly worried about not being wise when I got up on the floor of the Conference. It took me a while to realize that I was part of a process in A.A., and that by *being* here, I was making a brilliant contribution. Right up to the last presentation at this Conference, I was getting insights into things I didn't know



until now. It's a learning process. Most of us read the background material before we come here; still, we change our minds as the process goes on around us and brings us to the right conclusions for A.A.

"In the Fellowship, we learn about putting principles before personalities. It's almost impossible to do, but God knows, we try; we chip away at it day by day.

"Service work in A.A. has given me the opportunity to become the man I always wanted to be when I was drinking."

'A prayer that has been answered'

John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, M.D., chairperson emeritus of the General Service Board, was invited to contribute the long view, from his years of service as a trustee (1951-1978). "You've really lived up to the theme of this Conference—participation," he said. "It's thrilled me to see how much participation there has been this week. And because we have all participated, I think there are few people in this room who aren't content with what we've done. What we try to achieve, according to the Concepts, is 'substantial unanimity,' and when we don't achieve that, we don't go away satisfied. One of the highlights of this week is that we *have* achieved this substantial unanimity.

"One of the thrilling things to me over the years has been that one or two who didn't agree with the trend of the thinking have spoken their piece and gotten their way—not *their* way, then, but the Conference's way. So long as we do this in the Conference, we won't go wrong."

Dr. Jack went on to speak of the early days of A.A., beginning with the first orders for the Big Book that came in to the Newark office when Ruth Hock was Bill W.'s secretary. He shared other recollections of Bill and of Dr. Bob.

Dr. Jack ended with the Prayer of St. Francis, "which I think of as an A.A. prayer, because for those of us who have been able to come this far—to do Twelfth Step work, to become a part of service—it's a prayer that has been answered. 'Lord, make me an instrument of Thy peace. . . .'"

Wholehearted Participation by Conference Members Creates Effective Discussions

The "Right of Decision"

The first presentation/discussion, taking place on Monday morning, was moderated by Sam Smith, Southeast U.S. regional trustee. Recalling the Conference theme, it pointed out the close linkage between Concepts Three and Four.

'The principle of mutual trust'

I would think that all of the new delegates are full of the expectation that in the next few days, issues of great magnitude and importance to the Fellowship will be discussed, debated, and voted on. More probably, what will happen this year is what happened last year: We will spend most of our time sitting quietly, listening to presentations and discussions, examining all sides of the topics, and then using our good conscience to come to a group decision.

Delegates are here only for a short time, and the decision-making process for them is limited; but others at this Conference are charged with using the "Right of Decision" as often as necessary in order to keep the Fellowship moving smoothly and carrying the message. These people are, of course, the staff members of the General Service Office, the directors, and the board.

Not all of us agree all of the time, but decisions do have to be made. If a decision is made that one or more of us cannot accept, what do we do? I would think that if the decision came from the staff or the board, they would have examined the issue from all sides. Certainly, the answer would have been arrived at very carefully.

If we don't agree and want to do something about it, how is this accomplished? Bill's discussion of the Third Concept says that we are primarily world servants of Alcoholics Anonymous and only in a secondary sense do we represent an area. This is sometimes hard to accept; but when we do, then, clearly, we can allow other people to use the "Right of Decision." All of us love the Fellowship, sometimes so much that we smother ideas, motivations, innovations, and new concepts. We want to protect "what we have" and our Legacies so much that we become wary and sometimes distrustful of other people we put in office.

The "Right of Decision" should never be made an excuse for failure to render proper reports of all significant actions taken. It ought never be used as a reason for constantly exceeding a clearly defined authority, nor as an excuse for persistently failing to consult with others.

"Our entire A.A. program rests squarely upon the principle of mutual trust. We trust God, we trust A.A., and we trust each other. Therefore, we cannot do less than trust our leaders in service."

That paragraph from the chapter on the Third Concept shows us what we must pass on to any who will listen. Remember how we were when we came to A.A.—afraid, nervous, unsure, depressed, and defeated. Remember the feeling we received from the first people we met—friendly, loving, sympathetic, compassionate, strong, and sure-handed. How quickly we gave them our trust and implicit confidence that they could help us recover from alcoholism. We didn't argue or question

them; we just let them do for us what we couldn't do for ourselves.

A.A. has survived, not because of any great decisions or contributions that I may personally make, but because of the good and loving people who are our trusted servants.

Jack Ford (British Columbia/Yukon)

'What is best for A.A.?'

When I first came to A.A., I felt overwhelmed and slightly resentful when told that only *I* could decide whether or not I was an alcoholic. I've been making decisions ever since.

Certainly, I was given much support and a lot of direction by my sponsor, who introduced me to the Steps. I was also exposed to the accumulated sober experiences of the members of my group. But it was made very clear that the actual decisions applying to my life and circumstances could be made only by me.

Those of us attracted to the service of A.A. reflect on "What is best for the Fellowship?" And it is this frame of reference that will support our decisions this week.

When I make a decision regarding my own sobriety, I am responsible to the entire Fellowship. Where do I get the direction and facts that support my decisions?

From this Conference—from your sharing with me the knowledge and guidance that flow from your unique A.A. experience and service responsibility, be it as trustee, director, delegate, or other staff member. Our communication this week will enhance and expand my own knowledge that comes from my own day-to-day experiences at G.S.O.

The concept of "trusted servant" has very real implications and applications, which I try to bring to my decisions in each day's work. At an early Conference, Bill spoke about the trusted servant as "not a 'trusted housemaid,' but a person who is capable of taking those decisions in your behalf that he thinks you would take if you had all the facts about a situation."

These days, my work includes serving as editor of *Box 4-5-9* and coordinator of Regional Forums. Both of these projects have been authorized by the General Service Conference and are planned, in the A.A. way, by committees—4-5-9 by its Editorial Committee, and Forums by regional trustees and area delegates.

We can count on change—circumstances arise that force a change of plans. The sudden death of a good A.A. friend occurs just before press time, necessitating altering or dropping articles planned for 4-5-9; audiovisual equipment fails, and we're unable to show a filmstrip at a Forum; or three delegates volunteer to speak on the same subject. This trusted servant makes a decision based on what seems best under the circumstances. So much for the over simplistic approach that "the General Service Office and staff make no decisions." We do not make the sort of decisions that some members think we do, but we do make decisions—based on our particular service responsibilities, in order to function, in order to implement the decisions of this Conference.

By no means have the results of all my decisions pleased everyone, including myself. But the fact that I have been wrong, or have displeased another member, and am still willing to learn and to "press on" is one of the greatest testimonies to the A.A. way of life that I have experienced.

Exercising the "Right of Decision" has practical and spiritual results. I am free to do my part to help because you trust me to do it. I am free to trust you because you trust me, and I am free to consider, not "What is best for *me*?" but "What is best for A.A.?"

Vincina McCarthy, group services coordinator

Strike a balance

The Third Concept allows each of the elements of A.A. world service (the groups, the Conference, the trustees, A.A.W.S., the Grapevine, the staffs, and the committees) to decide how to interpret and apply their own authority and responsibility.

Under the Third Concept, we are confident that our trusted servants will exercise the "Right of Decision" faithfully, but we caution them against abuse of the right. The "Right of Decision" is a principle that will achieve, at all levels of A.A., a balance between ultimate authority and delegated responsibility.

What can we do to attain this balance? First, we can encourage our trusted servants to exercise their "Right of Decision." Second, we can recognize that the "Right of Decision" implies an obligation of responsible review.

Each decision generates a reaction: acceptance, rejection, or something in between. To preserve the "Right of Decision," we must guard against irresponsible reaction.

Decisions that are vital to A.A. *must* be reviewed before they become effective; decisions that are important but not vital to A.A. *may* be reviewed before they become effective; and decisions that are neither vital nor important to A.A. need not be reviewed *until* they have become effective.

Any decision that affects a fundamental principle of A.A. is vital to A.A. This includes any decision involving the Conference Charter, the certificates of incorporation of the three A.A. corporations, the bylaws of the General Service Board, and the Twelve Concepts. It also includes any other significant decision that has to do with the preservation of the Fellowship.

The trusted servants of A.A. may examine every such decision in the light of their own judgment and conscience, and ask whether they would have made the same decision. If the answer is no, they must offer their own views and, within reason, try to induce the acceptance of their own views.

We Conference members *may* review, without being *obliged* to do so, any decision which does not affect a fundamental principle of A.A., but which, because of its importance, has been reported to us or should have been reported to us. There are many ways to serve A.A. The decision of another trusted servant may not be our way, but we should not oppose it merely because we would have acted differently. The test is whether the decision is a reasonable exercise of the maker's discretion.

If it is, we should not interfere with the decision.

Most decisions are not irrevocable. If they cause any damage, it is rarely irreparable. There is seldom a need to overrule the decision of a trusted servant until the decision is tried and found wanting. The Third Concept reminds us that "there will always be plenty of ultimate authority to correct inefficiency, ineffectiveness, or abuse."

Where decisions are vital to A.A., let us not agree for the sake of being agreeable; where decisions are not vital to A.A., let us not disagree for the sake of being disagreeable; and to borrow from a favorite prayer of ours, let us please find the wisdom to know the difference.

Michael Alexander, Class A trustee

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topic:
8. 9 (p. 46), 43 (p. 48)

Literature Task Force

A Floor Action of the 1979 Conference recommended "that a study committee composed of delegates, trustees, and staff be appointed to study the advisability of, and the procedures for, having literature and service material distributed by G.S.O. Conference-approved."

After almost a year's study, the Literature Task Force presented its report on Tuesday morning. Dan Byrne (Iowa), chairperson of the Conference Literature Committee, moderated; his fellow task force members made up the panel. Only one hour had been allotted for the report and the following discussion, but so many Conference members lined up at the floor microphones that the session ran overtime. The issues proved so complex that the Literature Task Force was asked to meet again and clarify its recommendations. The following revised report was presented to the Conference for discussion and vote on Thursday morning.

Reexamine the Conference-approval system

1 The following pamphlets, leaflets, and flyers be approved with their present content: "Where Do I Go From Here?"; "Circles of Love and Service"; "Your A.A. G.S.O."; "A.A. in Your Community"; "G.S.R."; "A.A. at a Glance"; "Self-Supporting? The 60-30-10 Plan"; "The A.A. Member"; "If You Are a Professional"; "Inside A.A."

2 The pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" be referred to the trustees' Public Information Committee with the recommendation that the word "usually" (p. 7, paragraph 4) be deleted (therefore, returning it to its original form).

4 All future A.A. pamphlets, leaflets, and flyers be Conference-approved.

5 Any new pamphlet, leaflet, or flyer be mailed to all Conference members in unedited manuscript form prior to the Conference, for their information, in order that they may vote in an informed manner.

6 Any factual or statistical information may be updated

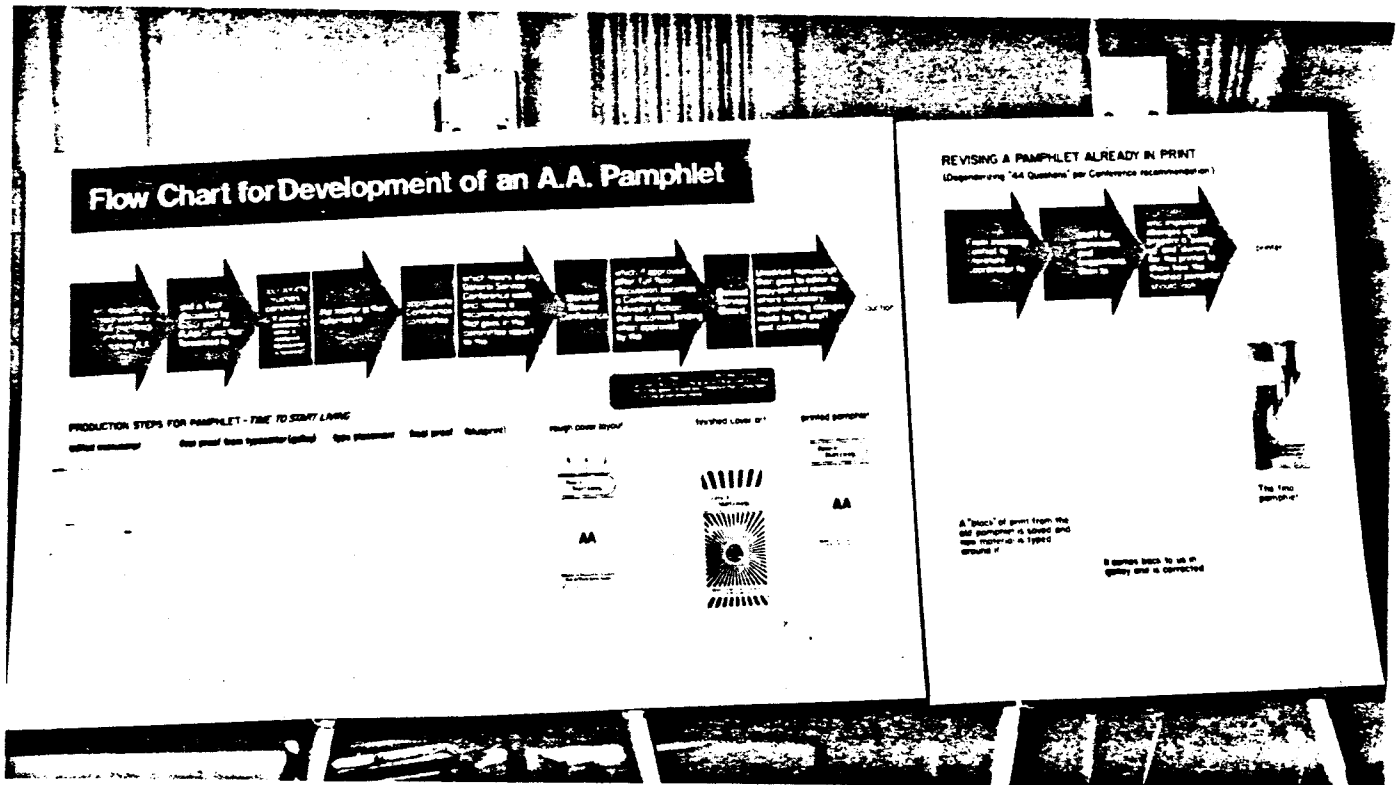
whenever practical without having to go through the process of Conference action, i.e., whenever inventory runs low, new survey completed, etc. In addition, minor copy cuts to make room for new material added to publications may be made when necessary.

7 Since A.A. Guidelines are a reflection of collective experience which is shared through G.S.O., relating to specialized topics not necessarily relevant to all groups or A.A. members generally (i.e., armed forces, clubs, answering services, occupa-

tional programs), the A.A. Guidelines may be produced or revised when new information or other contingencies arise, at the discretion of the G.S.O. staff without Conference approval.

8 The Conference-approved seal may be positioned or placed wherever practical on a piece of literature.

Advisory Actions related to foregoing report:
7-10 (p. 46), 13b, 14 (p. 46), 43 (p. 48)



World Service Meeting

The rotation method used for delegates to the biennial World Service Meeting is similar to the Conference panel system. For the 1980 Meeting, U.S./Canada is represented by Virginia Hallman, East Central U.S. regional trustee, who also attended as a delegate in 1978, and by Stan Cameron, trustee-at-large/Canada, who serves as a W.S.M. delegate for the first time. Virginia presented this report Tuesday afternoon.

A new structure for worldwide A.A.?

Since 1972, World Service Meetings have been held biennially, alternating between New York and overseas locations. Each country having an A.A. service board or conference is invited to send two delegates, elected for rotating terms. (Countries in Central America get together and send "zone" delegates.) This eligibility requirement is necessary so that the delegates actually represent somebody. The disadvantage is that the countries where A.A. needs the most help (i.e., where a service structure has not yet developed) are not present.

At the Fifth W.S.M., in Helsinki, Finland, in 1978, the delegates "took their own inventory." As a result, the following part [condensed here] of the report of the Policy/Admissions/Finance Committee was adopted as a recommendation of the W.S.M.:

"All members agreed that the concept of a worldwide A.A. body was essential. It was felt, however, that further benefit to A.A. as a whole in participating countries could be achieved by additional delegate reporting and activity between W.S.M.'s.

"The W.S.M. should fulfill its purpose of achieving worldwide A.A. unity and common policies among all countries. It was proposed that this subject be taken by the delegates to this Meeting to their respective national conferences or boards and discussed in depth, and that this subject be a prominent one on the agenda for the 1980 Meeting.

"A specific solution might be a reorganization of the W.S.M. to provide for regional service assemblies along language or geographical lines. All countries in a region would participate in these regional service assemblies, discussing their problems and getting a group conscience. Then, each region could elect

two delegates to a newly constituted W.S.M. This would result in fewer delegates participating, but they would be better prepared to consider matters relating to A.A. policies worldwide. This would also reduce the cost, because the size would be reduced."

In response to this recommendation, I brought these matters before the General Service Board at its last meeting, and made the following points:

- 1 There is no doubt about the value of a meeting to share A.A. experience worldwide.
- 2 The only question is how the W.S.M. can be improved.
- 3 The regional service assemblies have already begun. Two were held last year, one for European countries and one for Central and South America. Both were open to *any* country—whether it had developed a service structure or not—and both were well attended.
- 4 The remaining question, then, is whether the World Service Meeting should be reorganized to provide delegates from *regions* rather than individual countries, with fewer delegates participating. (As I see it, this would not affect U.S./Canada in any case. We are already operating, in effect, as a region.)
- 5 I saw great advantages to representation from individual countries, and that would be lost if we were to go to regional representation. I also fear that the proposed restructuring of the W.S.M. may be a move in the direction of changing it to some sort of "superbody" with power and authority. I oppose this kind of thinking. I feel the Meeting in its present form abounds in love and open sharing.

The General Service Board approved those conclusions and recommendations, and also approved my bringing this matter to your attention at this Conference.

Virginia Hallman, W.S.M. delegate (U.S./Canada)

Advisory Action related to foregoing report: 3 (p. 46)

Reaching the alcoholic by working with nonalcoholics and A.A. members working in the alcoholism field

Because the recent proliferation of treatment centers for alcoholics has presented such a challenge—both unsettling and encouraging—to so many A.A. groups, this topic aroused wide interest. Terry Leach, delegate from Northeastern Ohio, presided over the Tuesday-afternoon session.

'A.A. and professionals need each other'

I have been personally involved with Connecticut C.P.C. since it was established in September 1975. I was the first chairperson, and for the first four months, I was the entire committee, touring G.S.R. meetings and meetings of other area committees. A special organizational meeting was held in January 1976, and we hammered together an area C.P.C. Committee structure that is still intact.

The committee has a chairperson and a co-chairperson elected by the area committee, two voting members elected from each district, and one voting member each from the area Institutions and Public Information Committees. It is supported financially by the area committee. At that first meeting, we also

formulated and adopted a statement of purpose:

"This C.P.C. Committee has for its purpose the responsibility to members of Alcoholics Anonymous and to those in the professional community to suggest such policies and recommend such activities that may help (1) further A.A.'s primary purpose of carrying the message to the sick alcoholic by sharing information about the A.A. program with those professional groups and individuals who have contact with the alcoholic; (2) foster mutual understanding and cooperation between the A.A. Fellowship and others concerned with the problem of alcoholism and help for the alcoholic; (3) increase awareness of A.A. members on ways that A.A. may cooperate with everyone while affiliating with no one."

Here are some of the areas in which the committee has been most active: holding workshops and seminars at the district level, both for Fellowship orientation and for community professionals; mailings to police chiefs, lawyers, general practitioners, members of the clergy, and social workers; making one-to-one contacts with treatment and other medical facilities (convalescent homes were particularly interested); making presentations at in-service meetings in hospitals. One district has been quite active in working with lay-ministry and seminarian groups.

There seems to be a never-ending question about C.P.C.'s particular function and responsibility. The G.S.O. Guidelines are both specific and helpful: There must be understanding and coordination between C.P.C. and institutions and public information committees. However, I believe that more help and direction can and should be developed by G.S.O. staff and Conference committees, through workshop outlines and materials, C.P.C. presentation materials, newsletters to area C.P.C. committees, and more sharing of ideas and information among area committees.

Second, I think we should put more emphasis on the idea that A.A. and professionals need each other. As younger and generally better-informed alcoholics come into A.A. and as more and more professionals and paraprofessionals enter the field, we must develop better, more constructive ways of cooperating with those outside A.A. and helping those who are sent to us by the professional.

John A. Callaghan (Connecticut)

Reaching the alcoholic by . . . Working with occupational programs

I work with employers—industry, companies, business—to develop occupational alcoholism programs, because I believe more alcoholics can be helped more quickly in this way, with less effort. I am basically lazy, and besides that, I don't like to waste money—my ancestors were Scottish. I believe there is just more bang for a buck working with the employed alcoholic.

For A.A. twelfth-steppers, company programs provide many sick alcoholics who will be more responsive to the A.A. recovery program than alcoholics who are not working. If you are looking for pigeons, the workplace provides a big pigeon loft, readily accessible.

I believe strongly in occupational alcoholism programs because

(1) most alcoholics are employed; (2) most alcoholics (untreated ones) don't know that they are alcoholic—or deny it, influenced by the stigma and misinformation about the disease; (3) occupational programs provide the best means for stigma removal; (4) the employer is the best “bottom raiser” to motivate alcoholics into treatment (A.A. is an essential ingredient in any treatment) before the damage is too great.

The employer can remove the stigma by regarding the employee simply as a sick person; can overcome denial by facing the alcoholic with the reality of poor work; can motivate for treatment by the offer of help; and can improve treatment by influencing treaters.

Information and training programs would not be credible without A.A. members' input. A.A. members at work demonstrate that recovery is possible—the program works! A.A. members who are professionals provide understanding, skill, and wisdom. A.A. members twelfth-step fellow employees, or those referred to A.A. by employers. And A.A. service work—committees on public information or cooperation with the professional community—is extremely helpful.

A successful occupational program is a management—not a medical or counseling—responsibility. It must have top-management leadership and support all the way. Supervisor-training and employee-information programs are essential. All management procedure should be monitored to ensure that the company policy is implemented. If the employees are unionized, then the union leaders should be involved.

I have seen A.A. members cooperate in occupational programs by (1) presenting public information meetings for industrial relations/personnel supervisors to remove the stigma, myths, and misconceptions; (2) twelfth-stepping fellow employees referred to A.A.; (3) simply being sober A.A. members at work—nothing is more attractive; (4) being active in C.P.C. (cooperation with the professional community), carrying the message to occupational physicians and nurses; (5) as union members, twelfth-stepping union brothers and sisters—or, as members of A.A. committees, working with union officers.

Occupational programs provide great opportunities for A.A. members to carry the message.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson, trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community

...Working with treatment facilities

I am a member of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities. After last year's Conference, I returned to Oklahoma City with a burning curiosity to find out how our treatment centers stacked up with those in the eastern states. I live in the center of our state, where there are three major treatment facilities.

Before I approached the facilities, I found these three were graduating 1,500 to 2,000 patients each year, and A.A. in their immediate areas was not getting that many new members. Our figures proved to us that we were losing far, far too many to that deep chasm between the facility and A.A.

I arranged a meeting with a counselor from Central State Hos-

pital. I told him, “I want to offer A.A.'s services in whatever way we can help. We do not want to tell you how to run your facility. We only want to talk with your patient before he is released, one drunk to another.” This counselor thought the idea was great and welcomed us with open arms. I presented the plan we came up with to the other major facilities, one of which eagerly accepted.

Our programs in the two facilities are basically the same. Once each week at Central State Hospital, the aftercare counselor has a meeting of all patients who are to be released within the next week. He talks to them about their continuing program, and it certainly is heavy with A.A. Then, he introduces one or two A.A. members, who make short talks stressing the importance of A.A. to continuing sobriety. To make the transition easier and more enjoyable, we provide each patient with a temporary contact (not a sponsor, for we think each should choose his own), and we try to interview each one individually.

Most of the class will come forward. We take the name, address, phone number, and date of release. Then, we tell the patient we will have a temporary contact call him the day he gets home—not asking, but *telling* him the contact will be by at 7:00 or 7:30 p.m. to take him to a meeting that first night home. We further say that one or two meetings a week won't cut the mustard, and we suggest 90 meetings in 90 days.

We then consult the A.A. directory for a contact in each patient's hometown, and ask these A.A.'s if they will be sure to follow through on the newly released patients. Always, they are delighted to cooperate. We have made long-distance calls to as far away as Wyoming and Mississippi.

For nearby Central State Hospital, we keep a team of four people active in our “bridging the gap” program, and for Valley Hope, 70 miles from Oklahoma City, we use a team of 16 good, active A.A. members on a rotating basis. At Valley Hope, we hold a night meeting for the entire patient body; an A.A. talks for 30 minutes, stressing the importance of A.A. to his continuing sobriety. Then, he dismisses all but those who are to leave within the next week, and does the individual interviews.

While statistics are hard to come by in such a program, the feedback we have been able to get is all good. On follow-ups, we hear these new people are still going to meetings. The treatment facilities are delighted with the results. The patients are pleased to know we care. The temporary contacts are willing and eager to follow through. And we who go to these treatment facilities are grateful for the opportunity to give away, so we may keep, what was so freely given to us.

LeRoy Belt (Oklahoma)

...Working with medical and nursing schools

In the Washington area, there are over 50 hospitals with their own or cooperating medical and nursing schools, and working with them has been slow and cautious. A.A. members like me have had to remember, “Let's be friendly with our friends.”

Most of the work in this area has been and is being done by the P.I. and C.P.C. Committees. Our past Northeast regional trustee was and is still very active in working with the schools.

In one medical school, there are panels of doctors who are members of A.A.; they answer such questions as "How did alcoholism affect you, and what did you do about it?" In other schools, members of the C.P.C. Committee or other A.A.'s have been called in to answer the same questions.

There is a standing practice in this area for the students to go or be taken to A.A. meetings as part of their training. This practice has led a few students, as well as a few doctors and nurses, to become members of the Fellowship of A.A.

The new member who has been a patient is encouraged, after a reasonable length of time, to go back to the doctors and nurses to let them know what a recovering alcoholic looks like, and to offer assistance in helping other alcoholics. This assistance is usually in the form of literature, as well as talking to a person the doctors and nurses may refer to the A.A. member. These efforts have led to excellent cooperation with medical and nursing schools, through the requests of the doctors and nurses.

For such work, newcomers need good sponsorship. Sometimes, the new person wants to recruit all of the drinking friends, or tell the doctors and nurses how help *should* have been given.

Years ago, I remember being asked by one of my sponsors to go with him. I thought I was going on a Twelfth Step call, but I learned that when I went to a hospital, I was not necessarily going to talk to a patient. The hospital had medical and nursing schools attached to it, and the purpose of the visit was to let doctors, nurses, and staff, as well as those in training, know that there was help available for the alcoholic after the alcoholic left the hospital.

My sponsor told his story, including his many hospitalizations and how he was introduced to A.A. This lead was the shortest I had ever heard him give; the discussion period lasted more than twice as long. I remember the head of the hospital telling those who had to go back to duty to go; but if they were interested, he was recording the entire proceedings and they were welcome to listen later. That was my first experience with a member of A.A. cooperating with the professional community.

Nowhere have I mentioned the A.A. members who are employed in the alcoholism field. Now, this part becomes a little difficult for me. My sponsors had given me most of my experience by moving me slowly through the group jobs, hospital duty, institutional visits, sponsorship, central office work, and the understanding that I might be the only Big Book a person might see. My sponsors had told me that if I decided to go into the field, I was to have at least three years since my last drink, have good A.A. sobriety, and make sure my background was related to that part of the field I wanted to enter.

Jim Cooney (District of Columbia)

Following the presentations, Conference members divided into ten workshop sections, to answer related questions by sharing varied area experiences.

'An extension of Twelfth Step work'

1 "Do A.A.'s in your area meet with the administrators of outside agencies that work with alcoholics, in order to learn their

policies and, keeping our Traditions in mind, to explain how A.A. can cooperate with their efforts?"

All areas indicated that they did. Most agreed that, though problems continue to arise, they can be solved—and that much more can be done.

Because of changes in administrators and rotation of A.A. service workers, continuing education of both is necessary. Agencies, not always familiar with A.A., become cooperative when made aware of our Traditions. We ourselves need to understand the Traditions thoroughly in order to communicate them to others.

2a "Have misunderstandings come about in your area between outside agencies and A.A.'s?"

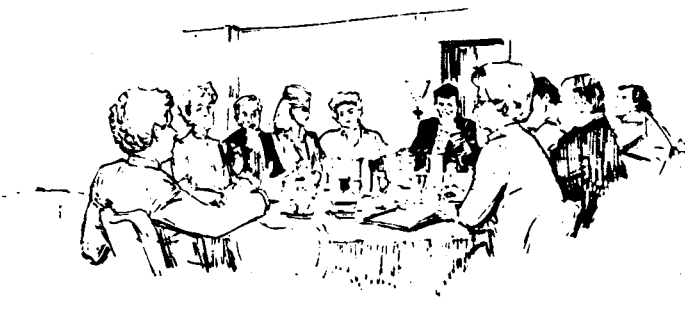
All areas answered yes.

2b "If so, how has communication between outside agencies and A.A.'s been improved? Please explain."

Through C.P.C. meetings, A.A.'s learn about agencies' policies and better ways of communicating with administrators. (Misunderstandings are often caused by uninformed members.) Improvement occurs when A.A.'s make personal contact with administrators and — very important — stay out of the affairs of outside agencies.

A heavy influx of newcomers sent from a treatment center could be dealt with by arranging car pools to take some of them to other meetings in the area.

Most areas have found it useful to stress to both outside agencies and A.A.'s the value of working with committees, rather than with individuals.



3. "What are A.A.'s in your area doing to reach the newcomers in treatment facilities and to help bridge the gap between treatment programs and the A.A. group?"

Suggestions included: (a) "Open the door" through group meetings at treatment facilities; (b) set up aftercare sponsorship (temporary sponsors and volunteers who go to treatment facilities and take people to outside meetings, and arrange to meet newcomers upon their release); (c) leave lists of meetings and temporary sponsors with outside agencies; (d) encourage A.A. members to attend meetings held in facilities; (e) let A.A. members who are treatment center "graduates" return and help patients see that the A.A. program does work.

4 "What is being done in your area to inform the Fellowship

of the importance of working with the nonalcoholics who work with alcoholics?"

Working with these nonalcoholics is an extension of Twelfth Step work. We can stress that fact in workshops, service talks, newsletters, and district and group meetings.

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topic: 16-23 (pp. 46-47), 44 (p. 48), 62-66 (p. 49), 72 (p. 49)

Participation through self-support

A workshop on Wednesday afternoon considered another aspect of the Conference theme—a principle that is vital to the health of every A.A. group.

Putting Tradition Seven into action

1 "If the facility in which an A.A. group meets cannot accept rent (such as a Federal or state building), what would you suggest be done in accordance with our Tradition of self-support?"

Find ways, direct or indirect, to contribute to the facility, for example: Provide A.A. literature or Grapevine subscriptions free of charge; contribute to relief, patient, endowment, or building funds; contribute to a community effort of interest to the facility; donate equipment or furnishings.

2 "To what extent should A.A. rely on fund-raising events to support group services? Can such reliance be contrary to our self-support Tradition? (Examples: intergroup dances, social functions, raffles, bake sales, car washes.)"

The Tradition of self-support through our own *contributions* should apply. It is better to rely as little as possible on fund raising. Dinner dances and other social functions seem more commonly acceptable when put on by central/intergroup offices than by individual groups. Avoid gambling.

3 "How are expenses for service workers at all levels of service met in your area?"

Through group contributions to area and other service committees, or directly to the person incurring the expense. Groups at all levels should be made aware of the expenses of service workers—no one should be excluded from service because of finances. Some service workers' expenses come out of their own pockets, and contributions seldom cover all expenses.

4 "While recognizing the Tradition of group autonomy, what are your experiences with the following?

"(a) What are appropriate group expenses? (For example, some groups put on social functions with group contributions.)"

It was felt that basic and appropriate group expenses are: rent (including janitorial services and utilities); literature; coffee and refreshments; direct service-work expenses; contributions to intergroups, area assemblies, and G.S.O. (many groups are using the 60-30-10 Plan). Two workshops felt social functions should be financed separately.

"(b) What is a realistic 'prudent reserve' for a group?"

Most felt one to three months' operating expenses was an adequate reserve. One workshop recommended establishing a budget to determine a prudent reserve.

Participation: equal voice—equal responsibility

In these presentations, on Thursday afternoon, exploration of the Conference theme turned from the Traditions to the Concepts, to see how these guides for service apply at three levels. The moderator was Ian McKenzie, delegate from Western Pennsylvania.

Group perspective

Many times at area committee meetings, we get bogged down in housekeeping chores; so we have been working very hard in the past few years to help groups form steering committees, and to explain the necessity of steering committees for continuity within the group. We encourage groups to elect treasurers to serve for two years and other members of the committee to serve staggered terms, such as 12, 18, and 24 months.

How often we lament that new people are not interested in service any longer or that we cannot find a G.S.R. What about the secretary who has a relapse? The treasurer who absconds with the cash? The coffee-maker who doesn't arrive on time? What about the people dropped off at the door from the local treatment center? All these situations can and should be handled by a working steering committee, with a clearly defined voice and a sense of responsibility to enable it to make a decision, when necessary, for the good of the group as a whole.

Application of the Concepts at the group level will not be easy and requires careful preparation and education of all group members. One of the most important messages to carry is pride in the home group, the excitement of accomplishment when we see our group growing and alive with turned-on members and a good recovery rate among the new people. Do we allow all members to have a voice in group affairs? Or do we find one or two of us hovering over all activities? Do we give responsibility to new people in direct proportion to their sobriety and capabilities, while stressing the fact that one position is of no greater importance than another? When we reach this point in our growth, the true nature of delegated authority, ultimate authority, and final authority can be explored at the group level without fear of lack of understanding, or the use of that now-dreaded word "politics."

At times, the very essence of group conscience is misunderstood and misinterpreted, to the detriment of newly sober members and the group as a whole. Unless a steering committee can use its delegated authority, the principles set down in Tradition Two and Concept Ten will be largely ignored. Committee members should feel free to exercise the "Right of Decision." They should be ready to report to the group on each decision and should feel some assurance that it will not be necessary to air the whole problem before members who are in the early stages of recovery.

In all actions that do not require immediate disposition, the entire membership should be able to hear the committee's recommendations and feel free to express opinions. The pleas of the minority should be heard and reheard. In fact, a vote

cannot and should not be taken without substantial unanimity among the members who feel that this group is indeed their home group. Unless these issues are well defined ahead of time, every doubtful situation will cause personal clashes, confusion, and ineffectiveness in the structure of the group. This, in turn, will affect the health of the group as a whole, and with that, the recovery of the newly sober person in A.A.

Lois Jacobson (Northern Coastal California)

An area's view

Because A.A. is a fellowship, not an organization, participation needs to be motivated. This is done in our area by people who are enthusiastic, dedicated, and willing, and who set an example. It has been my privilege to see our area grow in participation from a one-afternoon quarterly service meeting to an entire weekend.

Our assembly is closed at election time, with an open sharing session. We encourage the various committees to be working committees and include general service representatives and district committee persons. The membership takes an active part in the delegate's preparation for the trip to New York, and the delegate is sent uncommitted. Past delegates have important experiences to share, and all past trusted servants are encouraged to stay active.

We use the suggested outlines from the A.A. structure of service provided for us in "Twelve Concepts for World Service" and "The A.A. Service Manual."

I was invited to attend my first area assembly 15 years ago. I was the only woman present, and the election of the delegate did not take long. Walking out the door, I thought, "Is this all there is beyond the A.A. group?" I started to get busy with my sponsor and got myself into service.

With many dedicated, loving A.A. servants, our area started to grow. We enjoy 17 districts today. Many have the suggested district meetings. We use the communication tools we are given through general service. We have an annual area convention a little different from other areas'. Each group makes a contribution to the convention fund, and we have no registration fee.

We have no actual authority—the conscience of the area is respected. We rotate our leadership, giving all an opportunity to serve. Concept Four tells us that "the preservation of the principle of participation in our service structure is . . . a matter of the highest importance" to A.A.'s future.

Through the acceptance of responsibility and participation in service, we can, as an area, find growing maturity. Maturity means the selection of a course of action considering A.A. as a whole and the ability to stick to the job of service until it is finished, to face unpleasantness, frustrations, discomfort, and defeat without complaint or collapse, to live up to our responsibilities and be dependable, and to make a decision and stand by it. Participation is the continuing key to happy sobriety and unity that makes the "we" of our program work for all of us.

Mickey Boynton (Alabama/Northwest Florida)

Conference perspective

I am a Conference member because I am a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board. I also serve as a member of the General Service Board's Finance and Conference Committees. However, my constituency as a voting member of the Conference is not the Grapevine or either of those two committees. Although I can present the Grapevine's point of view and respond to questions about the Grapevine, my function as a Conference member is wider than that. I have a "nonspecialized" voice.

As we know, final authority for all service comes from the A.A. group. Suppose, however, that groups tried to select articles for the Grapevine written by their members, and then sent delegates to the Conference with manuscripts in hand. The delegates would properly feel that they were messengers and errand boys and girls, rather than trusted servants of their areas.

As pointed out in the Fourth Concept, there is a practical reason for not giving delegates absolute voting authority, since they are really not a congress. Delegates function for a few days each year and lack experience with many of the problems of management of the Fellowship or the Fellowship's magazine. On the other hand, I have little knowledge of some of the special concerns of groups through other parts of this country and Canada.

My role as a Conference member is equal to that of a trustee, a staff member, or a delegate. My voice and my responsibility must be equal to theirs. However, as Bill said, referring to us who have been appointed in our relationship with you who have been elected, "They know that the delegates are their linkage to A.A. as a whole. They also very well know that if you don't like what they do, you can go home and cut off area support."

Again, the Fourth Concept points out that the preservation of the principle of participation is a matter of highest importance. Bill Wilson says, "Experience suggests . . . that some of each new generation of delegates and trustees will inevitably try to weaken, modify, or toss out the principle of corporate 'participation.' Every year, a few delegates will question the 'right' of the corporate directors, the staffs, and even the trustees to vote in Conference."

Bill also said in the Fourth Concept: "Perhaps someone will object that, on close votes in the Conference, the combined trustee and service worker ballots may decide a particular question." Bill then goes on to wonder, "But why not?" Here, I think, is the core of the issue. The Fourth Concept states: "Certainly, our trustees and service workers are no less conscientious, experienced, and wise than the delegates. Is there any good reason why their votes are undesirable? Clearly, there is none."

The Fellowship of A.A. uses me, a trusted servant, as a Conference member. A servant must not be undercut in carrying out his task, and the principle of having a voice equal to that responsibility is essential. This, by itself, does not confer the blessing of wisdom or even that of ability, but there seems to be no other way to provide the Fellowship with the fruits of a Conference conscience unless it is allowed to emerge from the full discussion of *all* participants acting responsibly. And in the end, of course, the most important qualification we bring

is that of being sober alcoholics. There is no higher rank in our Fellowship.

Don Daly, Grapevine Corporate Board



Relocation of the Conference

This special report, presented on Thursday afternoon, took the long view, offering Conference members material for thought—though not for immediate action, as the report itself indicates.

Advantages of suburban conference centers

The Conference Charter specifies that the General Service Conference be held annually in New York “unless otherwise agreed upon.” The 1955 Conference was held in St. Louis in connection with the International Convention that year. With that exception and five or six years when we met at other hotels in New York, the Conference has been held here at the Hotel Roosevelt.

The budgeted cost of the Conference has increased, particularly in recent years: 1954—\$18,500; 1960—\$26,000; 1970—\$33,800; 1975—\$71,000; 1979—\$120,000; 1980—\$134,000. The main factors have been huge increases in hotel-room rates, meals, and transportation costs—as well as general inflation.

At \$38 for a single room, we think we have a bargain rate here at the Roosevelt. (The average single rate in New York is now \$65.) We have already been advised, however, that our special rate will be increased to \$50 for a single for the 1981 Conference. With the anticipated inflation rate in meals and air fares as well, we are budgeting the 1981 Conference at \$150,000.

When the World Service Meeting was held in Helsinki, Finland, in 1978, the A.A. hosts over there arranged to hold it at a conference center on the outskirts of the city. Those who attended were unanimously enthusiastic. They were by themselves, without the confusion and distraction of other guests, and with the whole management of the conference center dedicat-

ed to their needs. The city of Helsinki—and the facilities of the Finnish General Service Office—were only a half hour's drive away, and bus service was provided.

Because of this positive experience, the 1980 World Service Meeting will also be held at a conference center—this time on the outskirts of New York, at Glen Cove, Long Island.

The General Service Conference may wish to consider meeting at a conference center on the outskirts of New York at some future date. At present, the cost there is roughly the same as at a midtown hotel, but conference centers may not be subject to the same wild inflation—especially if we lose our “special rate” treatment at the Roosevelt. The main advantages may not be so much economic as in the better environment of a conference center for our type of meeting: more privacy, service tailored to our needs, and a less hurried, more serene setting. For occasions in the city—such as the visit to G.S.O., the nights off, and the hospitality events for spouses—chartered bus service would be provided. Further, good, convenient public transportation is available.

No action is to be taken on this matter at this year's Conference. The 1981 Conference is scheduled to be held here at the Hotel Roosevelt.

Frank Mauser, administrative assistant, G.S.O.

1980 International Convention

With the big event only a little over two months away by Thursday of Conference week, members were already in the Convention mood, eager to hear more about the largest of all A.A. meetings.

‘The greatest you could imagine’

The Convention will open with a Mardi Gras spectacular unlike any opening dance at previous Conventions. We'll have more than 30 flags in the flag ceremony at the Big Meeting on Friday night, and there are more than 130 meetings, workshops, and panels included in the Convention program. On Saturday night, the Big Show includes the Olympic Marching Band, the Harmonicats, and the New Christie Minstrels. There will be shuttle bus service to all hotels.

The speakers at Friday's Big Meeting and the Sunday-morning Spiritual Meeting will include members from four countries—U.S., Canada, England, and South Africa.

All in all, we think this will be about the greatest A.A. Convention you could imagine, and we hope you, your family, and all your A.A. friends will be with us in New Orleans to celebrate the Fellowship's 45th anniversary.

*Cec Corrigan, chairperson,
trustees' Committee on the International Convention*

‘One grat, big bon pon roulet’

I'm standing up here to tell you how great the International Convention is going to be. Well, it's gonna be great. Thank you.

Guess I should tell you some more about this thing than that. Our delegates' luncheon will have Dr. Bob's son as its speaker, plus a lot of fun seeing old friends, meeting the bleeding deacons (delegates) who helped sober us up so they could dump this business of service on us.

The alkathon is getting lined up, and a solid 72-plus hours will be at your disposal during the Convention.

Our whole state is working hard—*hard*—to get things ready, and I should take a moment to thank our neighboring states of Mississippi, Texas, and Arkansas for the help they are giving us.

The New Orleans folks are really, really working. The floats are coming along well, and there will be doubloons and beads thrown, and one heck of a good dance and party after the parade. If you are young (at heart), you may try the Crawfish Crawl with those Alateens or Al-Anons or A.A.'s who are young. On Friday, Saturday, and Sunday, Louisiana's hospital-ity rooms in the Hyatt will be open during the day. Watch that coffee, though—that's what happened to my hair!

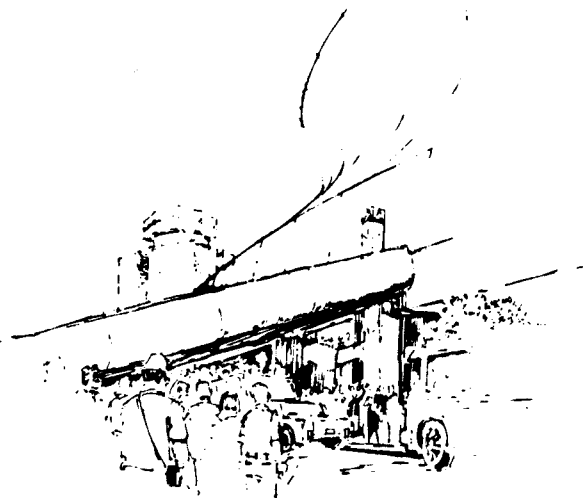
This wonderful experience has really pulled us Cajuns together. The hardest thing you are going to have to do is make all those decisions. "Boy, which meeting this morning? What restaurant shall we have lunch at? Where are the movies being shown? Where do you buy Dr. Bob's biography? Can you still see the artists in Jackson Square? Am I going to walk down Royal Street or Bourbon Street? What is Pat O'Brien's? Where do they have those marvelous antiques? Which hotel is having the breakfast for Lois?"

Saturday night will be special, with the Big Show. So will Sunday, with the Spiritual Meeting that closes the Convention. But you won't want to leave. So don't. Maybe stay an extra day or so to wind down and rest.

So I done tole you, we gonna have one grat, big *bon pon roulet*. Brought yourself to that New Orleans town. Pass yourself to that dere Superdoon, and we will alls be waiting for you, us.

Bill Geer (Louisiana), chairperson, Conference Committee on the 1980 International Convention

Board committee and staff reports on the Convention: pp. 37-38



Unstructured workshop

The ten sections of the workshop meeting on Friday afternoon had no assigned topic. Instead, each participant was invited to suggest some topic of broad concern not covered in the agenda of the Conference or its committees.

Both the moderator and the reporter of each workshop section noted the questions suggested by participants in their section (including their own entries). At the end of each discussion, the moderator asked for a "sense of the meeting," which was then recorded by the reporter.

Here is a sampling of the topics considered and the opinions expressed.

Practical ideas emerge in general sharing

Improving members' knowledge of A.A.—Most felt this is best done through individual sharing and good sponsorship. New literature isn't needed; what is on hand is sufficient.

Younger members—There is a trend toward younger members in all areas, and the youngest are about 17. Most do not stay solely in young people's groups, but turn toward long-established groups with older members, too.

Open discussion groups or meetings—They take various forms, depending largely on who comes and who speaks. In many areas, A.A., Al-Anon, and Alateen all use these meetings to share. In others, an open discussion is limited in topic to recovery in A.A. and the A.A. Traditions.

Sponsorship—Always important in recovery, for both group and individual, it is especially important for new people from treatment centers, who may look for a *trained* person or may be slow to recognize their own needs. Some groups assign temporary sponsors. Often, there is a shortage of solidly sober people as sponsors. Get people with five to seven years' sobriety to serve as temporary sponsors to keep them active.

Area structure—The importance of alternates was stressed. An alternate area chairperson might: visit some groups as a service representative; prepare agendas with host committees; act as a service trainer in workshops; work with the chairperson on nominating and share overall duties of that office. . . . It was suggested that G.S.R.'s or their alternates attend three meetings before being eligible to vote, and that either the G.S.R. or the alternate vote— not both. . . . To fill vacancies for area officers, a definite procedure should be worked out. . . . To avoid overlap between area committee and central office, each should be familiar with what the other is doing, as suggested in Guidelines and "The A.A. Service Manual." Liaison can bring about better communication (i.e., a representative of each attends meetings of the other). . . . Although structure is vital, it is a means to an end, not an end in itself.

Grapevine—Some service alternates at area or district level could act as Grapevine representatives. The area coordinator could be responsible for districts. A GvR in every group would stimulate interest in the Grapevine.

Conference—Some delegates discuss agenda items at area assemblies. . . . Communication between past and present delegates might eliminate repeated Ask-It Basket questions. A get-

together at regional level before the Conference to review questions might be helpful. At the Conference, a better method might be found to save time in responding to questions.

Filmstrips—One workshop suggested that “P.O. Box 459” and “Circles of Love and Service” be captioned for the deaf.

Cooperation with the professional community—To improve the understanding of A.A. by physicians, the following suggestions were made: Encourage local C.P.C. committees in efforts with hospital administrators, doctors, nurses, student nurses, and medical students; sponsor your doctor, lawyer, or spiritual adviser; take professional people to meetings when possible. . . . To accommodate the influx of patients from nearby treatment centers into small groups, the following suggestions were made: Allow patients to come, but have them understand that the meeting goes on as usual, with time for questions later; spend the first 15 minutes on the First Step and A.A. basics, then return to the regular meeting format; hold a beginners meeting first; take a meeting to the facility. It is important to let treatment centers know that nonalcoholics are welcome at open meetings, but closed meetings are for alcoholics only.

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topics: younger members—52-53 (p. 48); sponsorship—23b (p. 47); area structure—56-61 (pp. 48-49); Grapevine—29-32 (p. 47); Conference—11-15 (p. 46), 42-44 (p. 48), 54 (p. 48); C.P.C.—16-22 (pp. 46-47)

Participation: Service and Recovery

In the last presentation/discussion session of the 1980 meeting, late Friday afternoon, the Conference theme was regarded in the light of the Three Legacies. Ken Winegarner, delegate from Southeastern Michigan, moderated.

How groups can become stronger and better

The group is the center of the A.A. Fellowship, and will remain healthy and vital if its members follow the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. If the group is solid, the sobriety of the members will be solid, and the newcomer will sense this.

The basic message of A.A., as embodied in the Twelve Steps, makes the program work, and the group must reflect this dedication and commitment. It is up to us as individuals to make sure our group does reflect all that is good of the Fellowship. Whatever I do in my group has an effect. If I am careless with A.A. Traditions, the group is careless. If I shun Twelfth Step calls, the group is not reaching its collective hand out to those who need help. Once again, I'm reminded of an early member's saying “Unity begins with you.”

In order to understand and improve the function and purpose of our groups, a group inventory seems essential. The group is the means for transmitting personal recovery, so its quality will always be important. It is imperative we make time to take these fearless and continuing group inventories.

It is important to review how we in the group think about the basics of A.A., and how we propose to put into action our primary purpose. Are we carrying the message in every reasonable way we can think of? Are we reaching out to the com-

munity with ample information about what A.A. is—and what A.A. is not? Are we committed to sponsorship? Do we give the newcomer telephone numbers and encouragement?

We here today have a special message to share with the newcomer—the tremendous benefits we have enjoyed in our individual sobriety due to our service involvement in A.A. Setting up service workshops devoted to the group and group activities is a method of instructing A.A. members about the purpose and function of groups.

The repetition of basics is sometimes forgotten these days in our efforts to brighten up or modernize. Let's not forget, every time the door opens and a new member comes in, he or she has never heard the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous read, or felt the newfound love of its membership. It may be 1980, but our common illness, alcoholism, is the same as it was in 1935.

Terry Schemel (Washington)

Active cooperation keeps an area vital

Our First Tradition says: “Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity.” Unity means coöperation, and cooperation means working together.

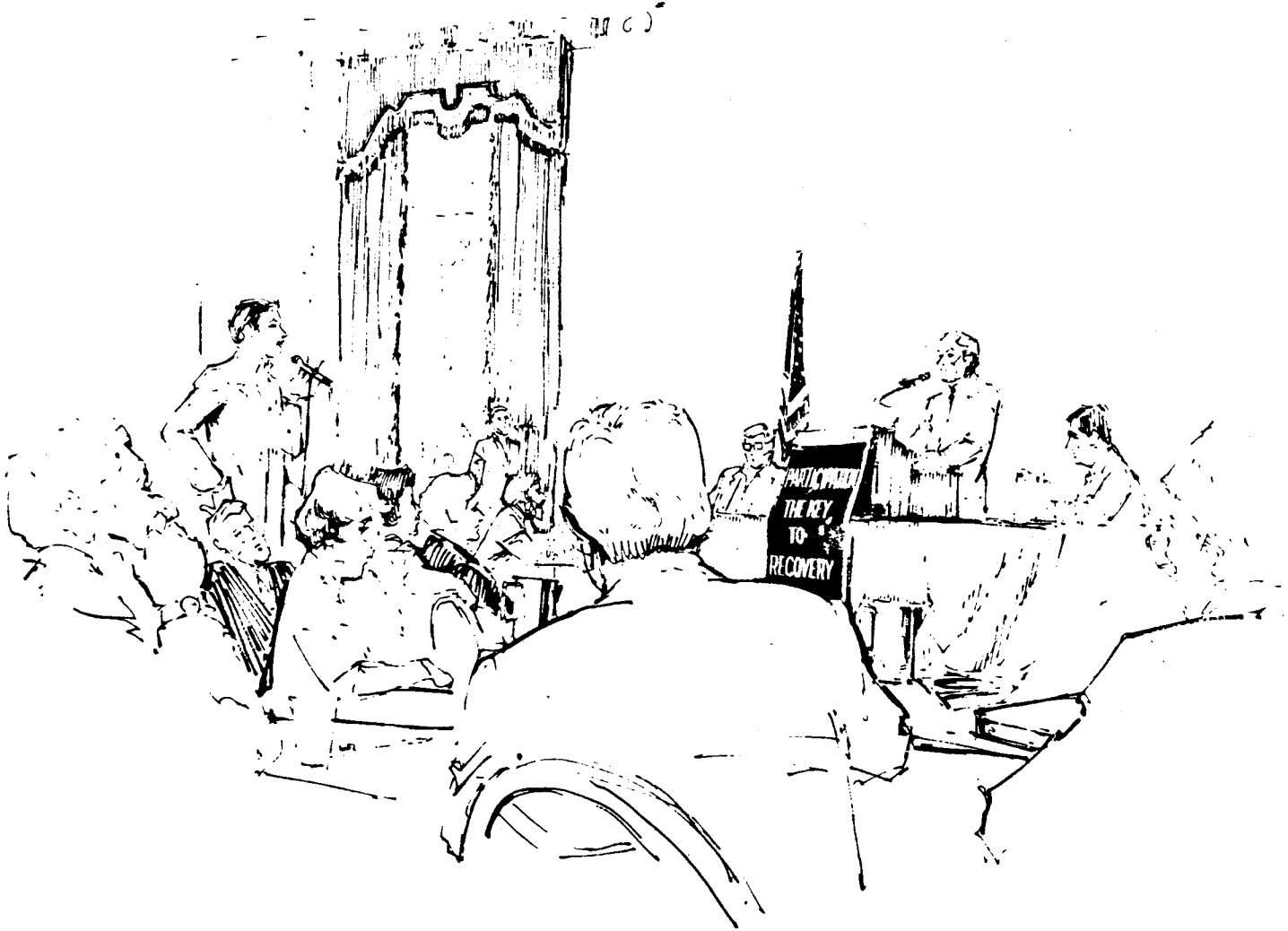
In Southeastern Quebec, we are structured according to “The A.A. Service Manual,” with some 165 groups spread over close to 100,000 square miles and served by 12 districts. All groups have G.S.R.'s, and most hold monthly business meetings. In my opinion, this is where the action starts—at the group level. Well-informed G.S.R.'s will participate actively at their monthly district meetings and at the area assembly.

Because of the great distance, we have only one assembly meeting a year, but we hold four area committee meetings and one gratitude dinner. All area meetings are well attended, and we try to prepare agendas that encourage lively participation. In the past year, we have initiated two other activities: a simultaneous meeting for members involved in public information programs, and a “school” for G.S.R.'s, scheduled during the same weekend as an area committee meeting.

Cooperation among A.A. servants at all levels in the area is in good health, because good cooperation exists among the area, the province, and G.S.O.

All four areas in the Province of Quebec are sharing their hope, strength, love, and “fire” in *le Comité Provincial*. The chairperson, the delegate, and the alternate delegate of each area are members of this committee and are responsible for several activities, such as *La Vigne A.A.* (our magazine), the Bilingual Conference, the cassettes, and the Literature Committee. We have at least four meetings a year, usually for a whole day.

I would also like to mention here another very important board, *le Conseil des Publications Françaises*. This French Literature Board has the following composition: the Eastern Canada trustee, the four delegates from Quebec, and four members of the Literature Committee. Its objective is to set policies for and oversee the operation of the Literature Committee (which continues to control selection of translators, review of translations, and printing and distribution of A.A. Conference-ap-



proved literature in French). While the Literature Committee is responsible to the Literature Board, the board, in turn, is responsible to the Provincial Committee.

Though the service structure is a little different in our province, mainly because we have over 6,000,000 French people, which makes our province predominantly French, we still need to maintain a close relationship with A.A.'s in the U.S. and elsewhere in the world. To illustrate the kind of open relationship that exists between G.S.O. and the Province of Quebec, last August we invited G.S.O. people to Montreal to discuss matters related to the French Literature Board. The visit was so fruitful that we agreed to schedule a yearly visit and meeting of the French Literature Board with two or three G.S.O. staff members.

Laurent Biron (Southeastern Quebec)

Our Traditions safeguard A.A. unity

"The unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most cherished quality our Society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. We stay whole, or A.A. dies. Without

unity, the heart of A.A. would cease to beat; our world arteries would no longer carry the life-giving grace of God; His gift to us would be spent aimlessly. Back again in their caves, alcoholics would reproach us and say, 'What a great thing A.A. might have been!'"

What is this unity that we cling to so desperately? Why is it so important? What makes it work?

A.A. unity is a singleness of purpose born out of the loneliness and despair of alcoholism. This common, fragile thread of alcoholism that initially bound us together and (out of desperation and in spite of ourselves) our need to discover other common elements in this A.A. phenomenon led us into a new realm. So there is now more than one common thread; it is more like a strong, reinforced cable—called love.

The importance of our A.A. unity has been manifested time and time again since the beginning of our Fellowship. It has allowed us to survive and to carry a single message around the world. It has no apparent limits if we remain vigilant.

Although our unity was not easy to come by, our founders and their successors and supporters (A.A. and non-A.A.) never

lost sight of our primary purpose: the need for a unified society that had but one common goal, and no others that could erode our foundation. Our Twelve Traditions emerged to solidify this foundation. They are a loose tie that binds us together, gently and yet firmly, to remind us forever why our Fellowship exists.

My mother used to say when she feared for my well-being, "Remember, there is safety in numbers." While our sheer numbers may not be so important, our "safety" from insanity and death and the "safety" of those to come rest in great part in our preserving these Traditions, not only in our General Service Conference, area assemblies, and districts, but at the very heart of our Fellowship—the group and the individual A.A. member.

A.A. has come a long way in 45 years, and we have a long way to go. Perfect unity is not achievable. "We are not saints." But as long as we continue to listen to each other, as long as we continue to trust in a Higher Power as He expresses Himself through our group conscience, we will not have to go back to our caves, and alcoholics will say, "What a great thing A.A. continues to be!"

Dave Buckley (Colorado)

Four ways to help service structure grow

I think that Arkansas' growth in service structure can be attributed to four factors: (1) orderly, businesslike procedures, (2) communication, (3) two-day area meetings, and (4) written area structure.

The first step in any successful organizational effort is orderly business procedures. In Arkansas, we began passing out printed financial statements and minutes from the preceding meeting to all members present at the quarterly area assembly meetings. In doing this, we gave the G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s something to take back to their groups and districts. (A.A. members always want to know where and how the money was used.) The financial statement should include the name of

each group and the amount it contributed to the assembly. To establish communication, we started mailing the statements and minutes to all area officers, D.C.M.'s, and G.S.R.'s about a month before the meeting date. You cannot remind the groups too often of the dates of area assembly meetings. We found that the attendance and interest improved to the point that we could not complete our business in one Sunday-morning period of three hours.

As a result, we began holding two-day meetings. We use Saturday afternoon for registration, comments from area officers, meetings of permanent committees, workshops, and Ask-It-Basket with a panel consisting of present delegate and all past delegates. Then we break until 8:00 p.m., when we have an open A.A. meeting with guest speakers who are very knowledgeable in service work. This open meeting not only educates, but promotes interest in attending the entire two-day meeting. On Sunday morning, we try to have all the reports from the officers, permanent committees, and district committees and all formal business, so we are able to end the meeting about noon.

The written area structure was arrived at by appointing a committee of knowledgeable, dedicated, and dependable people. After much hard work, this committee arrived at a final form, which was presented to the assembly and given to all G.S.R.'s to take to their groups to be approved or disapproved and returned at the next assembly meeting for the formal vote. It was accepted without any changes. We then had the structure printed in booklet form and distributed it to all our groups. The area secretary also keeps a stock on hand for all new service people and other interested members. Of course, election procedure, responsibilities of the officers and members, and other related items came straight out of "The A.A. Service Manual." We just put it in a simple form and added a few things that applied to the Arkansas Area.

As a result of these actions, we have a good service structure in Arkansas and are capable of carrying the message more effectively.

Wayne Parks (Arkansas)

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alaska: A.A. growth happens in spite of our vast distances. Last year, we had our first assembly in the southeast. The mini-forum in September was a huge first. Our March assembly was hosted by Alaskans. Our delegate called me to say he was snowed in, so here I am. There is good public information via TV and radio. We have four intergroup offices—Juneau, Kenai Peninsula, Fairbanks, and Anchorage.—*Marjorie Farber*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Area assembly officers go anywhere, anytime to participate in a sharing session. This creates awareness of service, increases the number of G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s. We also hosted a Regional Forum. Committee officers who make the effort to help answer questions show the impor-

tance of service work. Our provincial Grapevine chairperson has increased the number of GvRs to second in Canada. We had "Dr. Jack" Norris address our assembly. Since then, when possible, we try to get someone from G.S.O. to attend.—*Jack Braybrook*

Arizona: Our membership is on the upswing. We have approximately 415 groups. One primary concern is a large influx of people from treatment centers who seem to miss the fundamentals of sponsorship, home groups, and responsibility. We sponsor the 23rd International Conference of Young People in Tucson, May 22-25. The area convention will be September 12-14 in Phoenix. Also, tentatively set for the first weekend

in October in Phoenix will be a Regional Forum, second to be held in the Pacific Region.—*Irving Poissant*

California (Mid-Southern): We feel that representatives at our assemblies should be well-informed, dedicated people, but we want more groups participating. We have monthly meetings in 18 districts. New G.S.R.'s get to participate by making presentations. We also have a "servathon" each year and a Conference-type "symposium of service." These are workshops. We have tremendous turnover in group secretaries, G.S.R.'s, and committee people. So rarely do delegates lack experience in some assembly office.—*Denver Colvin*

California (Northern Interior): Our area is quite large, about 600 miles long, 200 to 300 miles wide. We have grown in members and groups over the last six years. Our groups are getting more active. Attendance has increased at district meetings and assemblies. We initiated moving area committee meetings around the state four years ago. This seems to have generated more interest in service. We have approximately 300 groups registered. Our hope this year is to reach more groups with the service message. Contributions to our area committee remain consistent and so far sufficient for our needs.—*Naydene Barnes*

California (San Diego): A study group on "The A.A. Service Manual" started this year. Three or four new G.S.R.'s were one result. Growth in our area necessitated a second intergroup. A new C.P.C. committee plans to improve communications between professionals and our groups. Our area benefited from the 60-30-10 Plan. Income is adequate to cover expenses. Many well-attended meetings do not have a strong nucleus of members who regard the group as a home group. They do call themselves groups, but service does not prosper.—*Gary Ulrici*

Delaware: In 1979, we established districts for the first time, and now realize the advantages of better service structure. Seventy-four of 78 groups now have G.S.R.'s, and 65 participate in our assemblies. D.C.M.'s are communicating with the G.S.R.'s, by district, report area activities, and carry a report from the committee chairperson in a monthly news bulletin. One intergroup started a 15-minute weekly radio program, with two A.A.'s sharing.—*Debbie Harrington*

Georgia: We have 25 D.C.M.'s and over 300 G.S.R.'s. Our full-time state service office, centrally located, helps us communicate better as well as carry the message. We have three assemblies each year, with a statewide A.A. meeting one night. We plan three large A.A. meetings involving all Three Legacies in the next two years. D.C.M.'s will organize these. We hope this will interest many A.A.'s not yet in service.—*Joe Phelan*

Idaho: After planning, saving, fund-raising, hope, and prayer, we now have our own central office, in Boise. It offers 24-hour answering by A.A. members. This year we have split a district of over 40 groups into three, more manageable and responsive. Lines of communication are finally open, and are used from group to G.S.O. and back. We have learned a valuable lesson regarding suggestions in "The A.A. Service Manual": Life is much easier if we follow them.—*Pat Enright*

Illinois (Northern): We have a spring conference each year, which started in 1976. The host district changes annually, to help carry the message and create unity. In 1979, our P.I.C. did a good job with TV and radio spots, and our Institutions Committee worked with the facilities. Some redistricting was

done, so we have a better structure. Among my concerns are unity and cooperation. I hope we can increase attendance at assemblies.—*LaVerne ("Pete") Peters*

Indiana (Southern): We have 175 groups in 12 districts with nearly 3,000 members. Our two delegate areas are both served by one state committee. It meets five times a year. Each October, the assembly elects a delegate—Northern or Southern, in alternate years. Funds for the state committee come from group contributions (many now use the 60-30-10 Plan) and our state convention. This past year, Indiana hosted the East Central Regional Conference for the first time, supported so well by our membership that the state committee contributed nearly \$4,000 to G.S.O. from conference proceeds.—*Ralph Richards*

Kansas: A women's group has been started at the state prison. In the last two years, the number of A.A. members at Fort Leavenworth has gone from 50 to over 140. Three other institutions in the west of the area have similar experiences. Outside metropolitan limits, I see a lot of work done by our P.I.C., especially in Wichita. In Kansas City, our central office is also very active in P.I. But I am concerned about the lack of interest that the more than 60 A.A. groups in Greater K.C. show in their office and what it is trying to do to help the still-sick alcoholic.—*Larry Trager*

Kentucky: We are experiencing the same rapid growth as the rest of the nation and have recently redistricted our more populated areas, making a total of 16 districts. Three intergroup offices serve our state. State committee quarterly meetings are held in towns throughout the state, with workshops on service the previous day. The 1980, 29th State Conference in Louisville recently hosted 1,600 members. We are working hard to strengthen and improve our service structure. We are functioning well with the Traditions of A.A. and continually extend a loving hand to the suffering alcoholic.—*Jackie Jones*

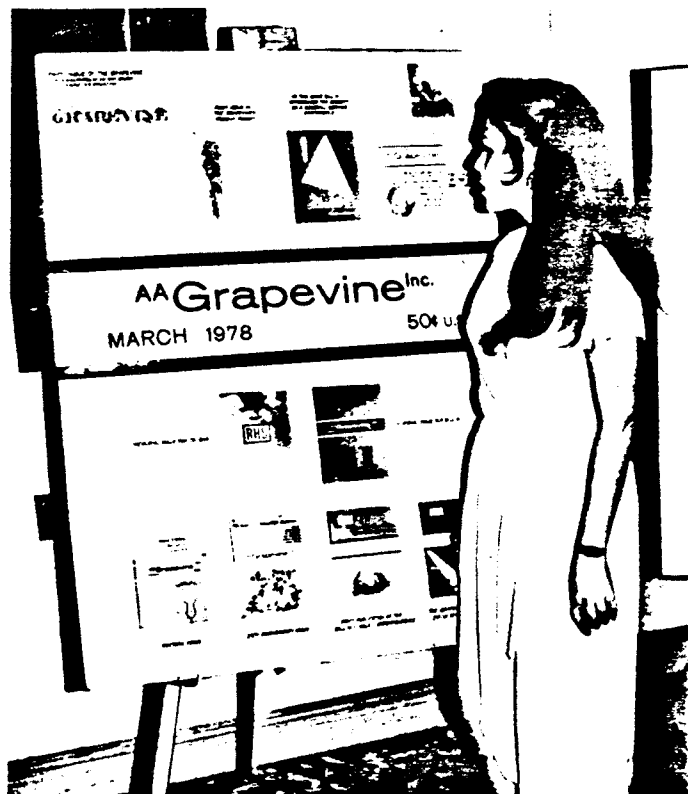
Maine: In this large, rural area, A.A. is undergoing a boom. The service structure is at times hard pressed to maintain a cohesive areawide program. Hospitals, veterans' facilities, detox and rehab programs, local jails, prisons, and prerelease centers receive the A.A. message. The advent of long-term, in-house rehab centers caused much local interest in alcoholism, with positive benefits. We have public information (P.I.) and C.P.C. committees, and GvRs. We also support the area picnic, *The Boomerang* (a monthly newsletter), and soon, the third Maine Area Round-up.—*Frank L. Anderson*

Manitoba: I represent about 140 groups, 3,000 members. Our area committee has 12 districts. In a few years, we have reactivated committees, such as hospitals and P.I., and organized programs of action, involving more people. Stress has been placed on cooperation with intergroups, central offices, and groups. Third Legacy workers take part in intergroup workshops and conferences, and vice versa. Some D.C.M.'s put on their own workshops. One big concern is distance. Some groups in the northern section are 100 miles or more apart. This makes district meetings or workshops difficult.—*E. Patrick Walters*

Maryland: My sponsor was very active in general service, dragging me along until I thought HOW stood for "Hang On to Winners." The only person from my district, I was "selected" D.C.M. In 1979, I declared I was willing, and won the delegate seat. Service work is not popular, which I know surprises you all. But, with the service activity of D.C. and Maryland thrown

into my own recovery program, I survived. When our intergroup was chartered in 1972, I was on the steering committee. This qualifies me to be a good coffee-maker!—*Sunny Nisewaner*

Massachusetts (Western): In 1978, we developed five districts with 100 groups. Our service entities are very active. The Grapevine Committee has 35 GvRs; P.I.C. fills speaking engage-



A display board in the main meeting room shows notable Grapevine issues, from the first to March 1978—first to reach 100,000 circulation. Naomi Strassberg (nonalcoholic) is GV editorial secretary.

ments in schools, and has a weekly radio program on three stations; C.P.C. is finally progressing. The Institutions Committee carries the message to 15 facilities. Service sponsorship shows results. We send minutes of service meetings to all area groups every month. So groups are well informed.—*Gerry Page*

Michigan (Western): Every month our G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s have separate meetings, potluck at noon, and then a combined meeting. Morning meetings are workshops on service. Afternoons, we have committee reports and discussion. I think sometimes we forget how it was when we first got into service work. So workshops are very helpful to the new person.—*Ernest (Ern) Manzano*

Minnesota (Northern): Through the use of "Building a Service Structure—One Region's Experience," we have seen a rising interest in gratitude, unity, and service. One result is movement of many groups in urban areas toward autonomy, making them less reliant on Alano Societies, and resulting in members' assuming responsibilities to a group, and a better financial picture for groups and the Alano Societies, so groups are better able to finance attendance of their G.S.R.'s and P.I. and institutional people at service activities. We urge all persons in service to see

that their expenses are covered by groups, districts, and assemblies.—*Don Mellem*

Mississippi: Formerly, quarterly meetings were in Jackson, centrally located. This resulted in the same attendance, newcomers not being overabundant. Three years ago, the ever-increasing costs of coffee and meeting rooms caused us to seek other means. We now hold meetings at the same time as other A.A. functions, avoiding the cost of additional rooms. Meetings held in various sections attract members who have not been attending. They now do, and get interested in service. We now have to deal with excess funds in the state treasury.—*Bill Carroll*

Montana: After a few years, I wanted more than just going to meetings. I started a group in 1971. My position was G.S.R. for four years; then D.C.M. The district has 22 groups, is 250 miles wide, 150 long. We now have several district meetings a year, and a secretary. The communications gap is bridged, and the groups help smaller groups get started. During the next two years, I would like to help educate my area in better unity and service.—*Perry Rodreick*

Nebraska: Our group count and individual membership have increased 250 percent in six years. Workshops have been added to our area committee meetings. District mini-conferences and workshops are helpful in communications, and our area Grapevine chairperson has generated enthusiasm for the GvR concept. We alternate area committee meeting sites. We hope to promote areawide involvement and statewide representation. Recently, we focused on institutions, P.I., and C.P.C. committees. Chairpersons of each vote in the area committee.—*Les Leuthaeuser*

New Brunswick / Prince Edward Island: A few years ago, a committee system was introduced at the area level dealing with public information, institutions, literature, finance, and Conference. Filled with members from each district, they meet at the assembly in workshops. Recommendations of committees form the basis of action by all groups in the assembly. The result has been more interest in all these services. Contributions to G.S.O. have shown steady per-capita gains because of awareness of this need. The Regional Forum in Moncton in May will give impetus to service work.—*Ken Fraser*

New Hampshire: Four years ago, we had 103 groups; now, we have 146. We have two meetings a week in the state hospital and state prison, one at the V.A. hospital, and five in county jails. We also have five answering services. The biggest problem districts have with such services is volunteers to do the twelfth-stepping. Last year, a workshop was held with one area committee meeting. The topics were elections of area committee officers, duties of each, and the Third Legacy procedure. —*James Nutting*

New Jersey (Southern): Our area is served by three intergroups. Our committee meetings are at one central point, but assemblies are rotated. Districts take turns hosting and providing a buffet. Historically, our groups have not paid costs of their G.S.R.'s or D.C.M.'s. Answering services, P.I.C., literature, institutions, C.P.C., meeting lists, newsletters, and bookers' meetings are all handled at the intergroup level in our area. Each intergroup has a liaison to our assembly with voting status. Our alternate delegate is liaison to the intergroups.—*Nancy McComas*

New Mexico: The most exciting thing in our area recently was a Regional Forum. It was well received and well attended. Meeting so many people from G.S.O., plus delegates and visitors from other areas, and being able to share thoughts and aspirations are a delight. We hope to accomplish better communication between groups and area committee people. We also plan to try for knowledgeable and service-minded people (from which to draw group servants) by encouraging newcomers to accept service as a part of happy sobriety.—*Bruce H. Irwin*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): About five years ago, our area restructured. Since then, we have had growth in numbers, new groups, and service. Our institutions committee was one man until three years ago. Today, there are representatives from all districts, and all facilities have some A.A. coverage. Formed two years ago, our P.I. Committee furnishes talks in schools and radio spots. In October, we host the Northeast Regional Convention in Lake Placid, N.Y. Our annual "Day of Sharing" (mini-forum) is a one-day conference patterned after Regional Forums. It helps get new G.S.R.'s involved.—*Bob Adams*

New York (Western): Our first black delegate has been followed by our first female, who is married to a past delegate. One of our biggest problems has been retention of G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, and committee officers in service. Redistricting has been done, and emphasis last year was placed on the committee-member position. A "buddy system" with the University of Buffalo Medical School involves medical students' being taken to open A.A. meetings. Speakers from alcoholism agencies have talked at C.P.C. meetings, and an annual "day of sharing" is held with local councils on alcoholism.—*Joanne McCartin*

North Dakota: Highlights for us have been getting G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s more involved. We have been having them lead workshops at our assemblies with topics they pick. We will combine duties of the GvR and G.S.R. We send minutes of the assembly meetings to them for their groups. In the past, we have not had enough for D.C.M.'s to do. In the two-day assembly, G.S.R.'s have workshops, and we go over the agenda the first day. If there is any change, people have a chance to talk it over before acting on it.—*Freddie Marchand*

Ohio (Northwestern) / Michigan (Southeastern): We invite all members to the assembly, and attendance runs as high as 90. We are starting a new C.P.C. Committee, with a past delegate as chairperson. We also got a P.O. box number to eliminate mailing problems. We have a new service, "the Box 4-5-9 reader." We appoint a G.S.R. to read Box 4-5-9 and report at the next assembly new or interesting items. An article on visiting shut-ins led us to put this into our structure.—*Gerry McAvoy*

Ohio (Southwestern) / Kentucky (Northern): While I was D.C.M., we began monthly meetings of G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s. Later, I was area secretary with contact with about 150 people after each assembly. We have six assemblies a year. We have a yearly boat ride so people can share with each other. Profit goes to G.S.O. This year, we will present the Twelve Concepts at our committee meetings and assemblies, one per month. Our groups cooperate well with a detox and rehab center.—*Bob Campbell*

Ontario (Western): We have 16 districts with 350 groups. Our C.P.C. Committee went into effect January 1. To get more

people involved, our area is divided into north and south, and all subcommittees have two chairpersons. The P.I.C. has four workshops in 1980 for anyone interested. One district had a roundup attended by 275 people. The theme was "A.A. Cooperating With Community Services," with speakers from medicine, government, and industry. It was well received by the news media. Seven districts hold weekend conventions.—*B. M. (Murphy) Outhwaite*

Oregon: We have over 200 groups. At our last assembly, we restructured into 18 districts. This added D.C.M.'s, G.S.R.'s, and alternates, getting more people involved. Our committee added a C.P.C. chairperson, causing P.I. and C.P.C. committees to start in many districts. We added an archives custodian. In various districts, we have had service workshops, with the area chairperson and me available. Oregon will send the delegate and chairperson to the Pacific Regional Forum and service assemblies. We host the Pacific Northwest Conference this year. Districts have opened intergroup/central offices or committees throughout our area.—*Jack Denby*

Puerto Rico: Our area committee decided to give an "A.A. Service Manual" to each of our 82 groups, hoping groups study and discuss it at closed meetings, if they desire. This way, members would become more conscious of A.A. structure and be stimulated into more A.A. service. A central office was inaugurated in January. Groups are very optimistic this time that it will work out fine, even though the intergroup office that was servicing local groups years before folded up.—*Felix J. Martinez*

Quebec (Northwestern): Seven districts comprising 232 groups make up our area. Ninety-five percent of the groups are French-speaking; others, English-speaking and Indian. We have six district P.I.C.'s with 30 active members. Four institutions committees with 50 members sponsor 22 groups in correctional facilities. There are also three hospital groups. During the last two years, we have held 32 seminars on Traditions and audiovisual sessions on structure. In March, we started a G.S.R. school in each district.—*Raymond Coutellier*

Quebec (Southwestern): In our metropolitan area of more than 400 groups, we spread our G.S.R. school courses over four weeks. Our curriculum includes "The Member and the Group," "The Role and Responsibilities of the G.S.R.," "Tools of the G.S.R. and Their Utilization," and "The A.A. Structure," with the filmstrips. Classes are in French and English. First part of each is a 45-minute presentation; then there is sharing by the students. This will become a permanent activity in our 24 districts.—*Denis Longtin*

Rhode Island: We had 16 new groups start last year. All districts have a monthly meeting, each with at least one area officer present, plus the D.C.M. P.I. activity has increased, with speakers and booths at college programs. Cooperation with the professional community (C.P.C.) is increasing its sponsor-guide activity this year, cooperating with Brown University Medical School. It will bring students to open A.A. meetings as part of their studies in alcoholism. This program already works with Newport General Hospital Nursing School. Service schools are very helpful.—*John R. Salasses*

Saskatchewan: By phone one evening, from Prince Albert, someone asked who was the D.C.M. for our district. I told him there was "no such animal." He replied that there would be, and I'd be it. A man from Ile à la Crosse, about 100 miles

north, had asked me to start a group. That summer, we drove up every week (sometimes only myself) to keep the group alive. The local people are shy and quiet. It takes time to win their confidence and trust. The next winter, a group started in Buffalo Narrows. Now there are 15 local groups in the north.—*Tom McDonald*

South Carolina: We stress the benefits of quality sobriety obtained through service. We now have an area newsletter. Input from the groups improves with each issue. This year, we hope to get most groups subscribing in bulk to *Box 4-5-9*. There is confusion about the 60-30-10 Plan, concern it may lower contributions to G.S.O. and the state committee. We continue to aim for the "Penny-a-Day" as a minimum. Members want to know more about our "Twelve Concepts, for World Service" and the Warranties of our charter.—*Roger G. Stevens*

South Dakota: Although we have no room for an A.A. member on Mt. Rushmore, I believe we can use some of the principles those great men used, such as "unity through diversity." In A.A., we use "Live and Let Live." In my area, P.I., C.P.C., and working with courts are our current activities. In some counties, there is great cooperation with court systems. It helps the offender and gets the family involved in a recovery program. Some areas have good cooperation with schools. They reach the child, and then the home problem. We also have an employer P.I. program, and results are good.—*Douglas Beck*

Tennessee: After redistricting, we have 26 districts. Groups pay D.C.M. expenses to the assembly. Location of quarterly assemblies is rotated, generating interest in smaller districts. Our state Institutions Committee has been divided into correctional and treatment units. We started a delegate-D.C.M. sharing session at our assembly, a vital communication link. Our alternate gives a report to our assembly of new literature and films available from G.S.O. We publish a state directory every two years.—*Charles Ealy*

Texas (Northwestern): Our area never had a structure. I got concerned about this, and others were also. This year, we borrowed one from a neighboring area to study. Using "The A.A. Service Manual" as a guide, we hope to adopt our own in May. We will have a workshop with the assembly. Everyone felt we had started the structuring at the last assembly, as we

did elect a secretary and treasurer to relieve the load of the delegate. This will give D.C.M.'s more responsibility. One old-timer says: "Use them or lose them."—*Lorin Pigg*

Texas (Southwestern): This area had only eight districts just over six years ago. Now, there are over 200 groups in 24 districts, holding monthly or quarterly G.S.R. meetings. Four years ago, the area committee initiated area service committees. A committee that has had success is the Spanish/Bilingual Groups Committee. A monthly intergroup workshop has helped many groups, even extended activities south of the border. It is now putting together the eighth Hispanic convention of the U.S., Canada, and Puerto Rico, to be held in San Antonio.—*Raul Marin*

Vermont: We had 14 new groups in Vermont last year, but more significant was the increase in number of meetings, maybe caused by the infiltration of "flatlanders" from contiguous states who felt the need for Step meetings, Big Book meetings, daytime get-togethers, and occasional closed meetings. This enriched A.A. in the state. Until recently, it was rare to hear reference to joining a group, but this is changing. Also, more members volunteer to speak in treatment and correctional centers and furnish interim sponsorship.—*Betty Daniels*

Wisconsin (Northern) / Michigan (Upper Peninsula): My sponsor took me to meetings all over the state and got me involved in A.A. service. I became our G.S.R. and, after three years' sobriety, D.C.M. I wish everyone would get involved in a group, even if it's just cleaning up a meeting room. That's where it all starts. We have two area conferences each year, one in the spring, one in the fall. Many of our seven districts have workshops on service. Some groups are now involved in correctional institutions, treatment programs, and halfway houses.—*Dick Hahn*

Wyoming: A.A. is growing in our area. New groups are starting and older ones growing, as is our service structure. We have an active Institutions Committee. Our area committee has sent a one-year Grapevine subscription to each county jail in the state. We also plan to place a Big Book in each. One of our largest districts recently held its first district meeting in years, with nearly all G.S.R.'s present. They elected a new D.C.M.—*Carl Budd*

Wanted: Information and Opinions

Conference members wishing to bring up questions of general A.A. concern were invited to write them down and slip them (unsigned) into the Ask-It Basket. At four sessions, experience and information were shared. Here are some of the questions and answers.

Areas

Q Do area committees set policy for their area?

A The area group conscience sets policy for the area, usually through the area committee.

Q What makes a good area agenda?

A There are many suggestions in "The A.A. Service Manual." Workshops on service and A.A. history are helpful.

Q Should areas have a set of bylaws?

A In the state of New York, bylaws are required in order to obtain a tax-exempt status for an organization.

Q What can be done in regard to this situation? A.A. members claiming to be G.S.R.'s attend no general service meetings except that meeting at which area officers and the delegate are being elected; their primary purpose in attending is to cast a ballot, and then they are not seen again. (There is no way to verify their eligibility.)

A In one area, there is a date in September by which each district must furnish information to the area secretary regarding the names and addresses of G.S.R.'s. If this information does not come to the area secretary, then the group will not have a vote. Usually, any such decision is left up to the local assembly.

Q What are the feelings of this Conference about past delegates' voting at area assemblies?

A "The A.A. Service Manual" suggests a voice but no vote for past delegates. In a few areas, the same rule applies for current delegates.

Q It is known that redistricting begins with the district to be subdivided, subject to assembly approval. Can the assembly, by its own action, redistrict where there is an obvious need but some reluctance on the part of the district involved?

A When redistricting, the groups' approval is essential. The proposed redistricting should be approved by the area assembly.

Central offices

Q Are central office and intergroup the same thing? If not, please explain.

A Central office and intergroup office both mean a local A.A. office. However, intergroup sometimes means the body of people who decide policy for a central office, with one representative from each group.

Q My area (Puerto Rico) is composed of about 80 A.A. groups scattered around 35 towns. About 20 are in the metropolitan area (San Juan). Should the central office be structured to serve all groups in any area (P.R. specifically) where there is a general service area committee?

Q Our central office has about the same service structure as our general service area committee. Can the central office take over all committees from area general service? If it can, what would be the area committee's responsibilities?

A There was much sharing on these questions. Groups in metropolitan areas sometimes experience dissension between area committees and central offices regarding service responsibilities. However, most delegates agreed that it was helpful to have one person from the central office steering committee at area committee meetings, and vice versa. Usually, this person would attend in a liaison capacity, without a vote.

Q Could the area committee contribute from its own funds to maintain central office expenses?

A It is best for central offices to be self-supporting. However, the disposition of area funds is a matter of area autonomy.

Conferences and conventions

Q How many areas pay their delegates' expenses, or part of them, to the International Convention?

A Approximately 24.

Q Would there be any possibility of Canada's hosting the next International Convention, in 1985? If not, when could we anticipate such a happening?

A It is up to the Conference.

Directories

Q Would it be possible to list area and state committee officers' names, addresses, and phone numbers in A.A. directories?

Examples: chairperson, secretary, treasurer, literature chairperson, P.I. chairperson.

A Yes, it is possible. However, it would pose some difficulty, and would require a lot of changes and a lot of additional work.

Finance

Q The 60-30-10 Plan answers the question of distribution of funds where an intergroup or a central office is involved. How about a suggested distribution of funds where there is no intergroup/central office?

A The Conference Finance Committee will explore this question at the 1981 Conference.

Q How is the district committee to be funded within the framework of the 60-30-10 Plan?

A The Conference, in recommending that emphasis be placed on the 60-30-10 pamphlet, recognized that each area is completely autonomous in its application. The pamphlet is only a suggestion.

Q What is the cost of service to A.A. groups per year? The *Conference Report* used to give this amount. Can we have this done again?

A It was felt that this statistical figure was not of the greatest interest to the Fellowship.

Q There is no limit on A.A. group or A.A. intergroup contributions to G.S.O. Right?

A Right.

Q Could we change the "Penny a Day" pamphlet to "Two Pennies a Day" for contributions from each member to G.S.O., if it doesn't cost too much to change?

A The "Penny a Day" pamphlet was discontinued a couple of years ago.

Q Full credit for interest earned on prepaid subscription funds is not recorded on the Grapevine books, thus understating the Grapevine income. Why isn't it recorded?

A Current procedure is primarily the result of a 1977 Conference Advisory Action, recommending that both A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., transfer substantially all of their annual excess of income to the Reserve Fund. Since the Grapevine's annual net income did include interest earned on the deferred subscription monies, it did not seem to make any sense to credit it in the Grapevine accounts in the first instance and then concurrently transfer it back to the Reserve Fund.

General Service Board

Q Who devised the ridiculously complicated system for election

of regional trustees? What year? Why not let the Conference as a whole vote on trustees? Don't you trust us?

A Bill W., along with an early general manager and early staff members, wrote the election process. It's the Third Legacy procedure.

Q What are our chances of ever having an alcoholic chairperson of the board?

A It is entirely up to the Conference. There is an alcoholic chairperson of the board in Great Britain, but it is generally felt that this would not be a good idea for our board.

General Service Conference

Q Who determines whether there is a need for additional delegate areas? What is the process used for approval or disapproval? Who makes the decision?

A The Conference Policy/Admissions Committee sends an "application for additional delegate" to the area making the request. The form is filled out and returned and becomes an agenda item for the Policy/Admissions Committee of the next Conference. By considering the information in the application, the Conference determines whether or not an additional delegate is needed.

Q Can the groups be furnished with early copies of preliminary agenda topics to allow ample time for discussion, so that the G.S.R. may attend the area pre-Conference workshop better-informed?

A The Conference agenda is not final until the General Service Board meets during the first weekend in February. Agenda topics and workshop questions can be sent out roughly two weeks later.

Q We seem to have a hard time getting a response to the workshop questions as they are worded. Would it be possible to have the questions be "yes/no" or multiple choice in order to encourage participation by all members?

A It was that way before, but was changed to encourage more sharing.

Q Why is there duplication of mail and literature? For instance, I received the 1979 Ask-It Basket and Advisory Actions in the mail, and these are in the 1979 *Final Conference Report*. Delegates monthly letter: received two for November 1979 and three for December 1979, plus one service manual and one "Twelve Concepts"—and I was an alternate delegate.

A Because of space limitations, the Ask-It Basket section in the

Final Conference Report has to omit some of the material included in the mailed Ask-It Basket record. Advisory Actions, though they do appear in full in the report, are mailed first in order to let the Fellowship know the recommendations of the Conference as soon as possible. If you are getting duplicate mailings, please advise G.S.O. Duplication may result when group or area service jobs change.

General Service Office

Q Could we add the Twelve Concepts booklet to the new G.S.R. Kit?

A Most felt this would be very helpful; however, the issue of additional postage was brought up. G.S.O. will consider this suggestion.

Q Edwin Kurtz was given permission to use the archives in writing a history of A.A. for his doctoral thesis in history. This turned out to be a book entitled "Not-God," published by Hazelden. Was it known at the time permission was granted that a book would be written and published? If not, would that have affected granting his use of the archives?

A At the time he came to G.S.O. and expressed his interest, we did not know his work was going to be published. If he had said he wanted to write a book, he would have been given permission, because that is the purpose of the archives. Kurtz was the first person to use the archives for research purposes. Our Archives Department is open to anyone.

Q Why are the computer group sheets so often not up-to-date?

A We are trying to improve them. However, it is a difficult task, because there's a lot of material to be put on the sheets. G.S.O. receives approximately 400 changes per week from individual groups and 2,000 returns from each G.S.O. mailing. Of the annual mailing of group printouts to the delegates, 15% were not returned.

Q We have the film "A.A.—An Inside View" on a long-term lease. Why not the films "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" on the same or similar terms?

A Two areas wrote requesting "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" on a long-term lease. We have had two new prints made, and those who wish to have one may be given it.

Grapevine

Q What are the duties of a GvR (Grapevine representative)?

A To carry the message about the Grapevine. Flyers from the Grapevine are available upon request explaining the role of the GvR.

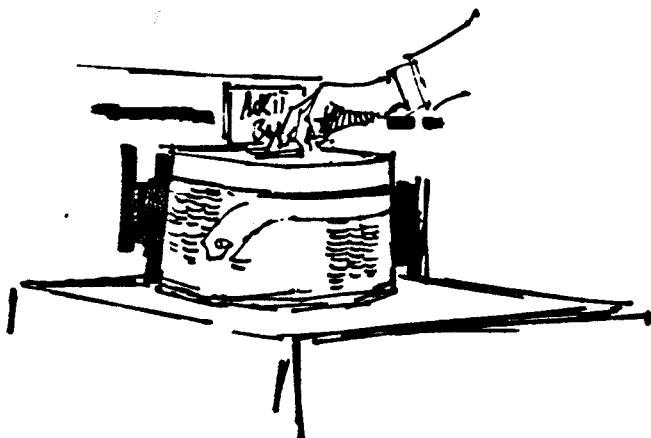
Group affairs

Q What about gay groups' stamping their group names on a pro magazine which is a gay magazine?

A This procedure tends to imply affiliation. To avoid confusion, it's suggested that this not be done.

Q What is the opinion of the delegates regarding an A.A. member's having membership and/or voting rights in more than one group?

A While some delegates felt it okay to belong to more than one



group, most felt that members should vote in their home group only, in keeping with the concept of one voice—one vote.

Q Can A.A. members who own a piece of land rent part of it to their A.A. groups so the groups can construct a locale for their meetings? Would this violate A.A. Traditions?

A A.A. members as individuals may rent to anyone they choose. However, A.A. groups traditionally do not own property.

Q A "closed" group listed with G.S.O. wants to use group contributions to have a Christmas party and invite non-A.A.'s to attend.

A Many delegates said that it was common practice in their areas to use collected monies for this purpose; others felt it was inappropriate; most agreed it was a matter of group autonomy.

Q Members of an A.A. group who are frequent "slippers" insist on sharing meetings and continuing in group office, often with the odor of alcohol on their breath. Will someone please offer a solution to this continuing problem?

A This is a matter to be handled through the group conscience. Usually, group officers are replaced if they have had a slip.

Q The alumni of a large treatment center, all A.A.'s, having refurbished this facility, now invest excessive time and energy in fund-raising with a view of continuing to build a large wing. How can these ex-patients be made more aware that their present sobriety is a result of their introduction to A.A.'s Twelve Steps while in this facility and not due to the facility itself?

A While there is no reason why A.A. members as individuals cannot participate in fund-raising activities for a treatment facility from which they have graduated, some delegates suggested that sponsorship into A.A. service and A.A. group activity in a positive manner would take care of any problems resulting from a newcomer's excessive involvement with a facility.

Q What do you feel about having business cards printed reading (1) "Alcoholics Anonymous," with member's name, or (2) circle with triangle, with member's name?

A Mixed feelings were expressed on this practice. Many delegates felt it was not in the spirit of A.A. Others felt it a helpful Twelfth Step tool.

Q How do you deal with people addicted to drugs other than alcohol who use up meeting time?

A Traditionally, we discuss our problems with alcohol at our meetings. If some wish to share about other problems, it is suggested that they share with their sponsors, or with others after the meeting.

Q Many longtime A.A. members are made uncomfortable by, or are even totally opposed to, the rapidly growing custom of hand-holding during the recitation of the Lord's Prayer at the conclusion of meetings. As so many of those popularizing this custom are "A.A. members at large," individual group conscience does not seem to be the course to take in resolving this developing problem. Any suggestions?

A Those who would like to hold hands do, and those who don't, just don't. It is kind of ritualistic.

Q Should A.A. members employed in the alcoholism field be involved—hold office, attend, or participate—in A.A. group meetings held in their treatment units or hospitals?

A It is suggested that these A.A. members keep their two roles separate, and not participate in any way with the A.A. group

meetings held in their treatment units or hospitals.

Q What offices may A.A.'s employed in the alcoholism field hold in their local groups?

A They may hold any office in their home groups.

Q Should a G.S.R. be paid gas mileage in attending various conferences?

A It is entirely up to the group conscience as far as the expenses are concerned.

Q Realizing that there is controversy regarding *all* raffles, but speaking only about literature raffles, I wonder why G.S.O. has not made a definitive statement against Hazelden (or other) literature's being promoted at A.A. meetings. Doesn't having this literature available constitute endorsement?

A What the group chooses to buy is up to its members. The best way to get an alcoholic to read something is to forbid him to read it.

Q Do I as an A.A. member have the right to ask a non-A.A. to leave a closed A.A. meeting?

A Yes. I have exercised that right myself and asked people to leave a closed meeting.

Q Could a group sponsor another group, especially in helping it financially until it gets on its feet?

A Yes. It is done frequently.

Q A flyer for an anniversary party (a fund-raiser) in a clubhouse was put in the Ask-It Basket with the question: "Is this a violation of Tradition Six?" The speaker was referred to in the flyer as a regional trustee, using first name and last initial, and the flyer said, "See your G.S.R. for tickets," which were \$9 each. **A** The clubhouse in question was built for the purpose of housing A.A. groups. While it is always better to separate the club from the group, this is sometimes difficult. It would be better not to use the area service structure for selling tickets to fund-raising events for clubs.

Literature

Q Could subject be reconsidered regarding the Big Book's being made available in paperback?

A This could be reconsidered. However, at the 1976 Conference, A.A.W.S. gave a complete presentation on the feasibility and cost of printing the Big Book in paperback. The paperback price at that time was between \$2 and \$3. The price of the Big Book in quantity is now below \$4 and is consistently being reduced, so that the price issue is less important. Also, the feeling has always been that a paperback edition would destroy the sentimental value of the book.

Q Can we eliminate the use of abbreviations in our books and pamphlets? G.S.R., D.C.M., P.I.C., etc.? I know it saves time and space, but I find it very confusing, and I am sure that many A.A.'s will agree with me, especially members who are new to service.

A There is a glossary of terms in "The A.A. Service Manual," explaining some of the abbreviations. G.S.O. will keep this suggestion in mind whenever possible.

Q Would it be possible to have a literature warehouse in Canada? Like Montreal, where they already have French literature?



A It certainly is possible to have a warehouse in Canada. G.S.O. is currently investigating the possibility of having one in the Toronto area.

Q Although previously discussed in Ask-It Basket, no answer seems to have been given to this: Any possibility of a "simulated" copy of the first edition of the Big Book? (If not possible through A.A.W.S., how about as a fund-raising project for the Grapevine?)

A This was proposed to the Conference in 1976. We did look into its feasibility, but 1977 Conference members voted against it because they did not want to damage the sentimental or monetary value of the actual first edition of the Big Book.

Q A.A. clubs and groups buy the Big Book at discounts. Should they charge the retail price and make a profit on the difference?

A Each area is autonomous. A.A.W.S., Inc., has no legal control over the resale price on the books it sells.

Q Has any thought been given to a biography of Bernard Smith? What does the Conference think of the idea?

A No thought has been given to such a biography. It might be a good idea to have some of his thoughts and writings available. We have not provided a pamphlet or leaflet, but we know he made great contributions to A.A., and we might take this into consideration. Refer to Archives Committee.

Q Is it possible to use bold print or some other method to indicate changes made when publishing a new edition of "The A.A. Service Manual"?

A Yes, it is possible to devise a method to indicate changes, and this question will be referred to the editor of the service manual when it comes up for reprint.

Q Is it possible to produce a cassette of someone discussing the Twelve Concepts? Something like our film "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," only in cassette form.

A Yes, but this would involve only one individual's interpretation.

Public information

Q In our area, some districts are asking A.A. members to write their stories for publication in the newspapers (no last names). Is this not the same as writing books on our life stories (except for money)?

A G.S.O. receives about 500 clippings from the clipping service each month. About 50 are from reporters who have attended A.A. conventions, and are reporting on the stories of alcoholism and recovery told there. No full names are given, and it is always gratifying to see the A.A. message carried through the media while honoring our Traditions.

Q Should P.I. booths be set up and manned by A.A.'s in public shopping malls?

A Yes, if it's in connection with a health fair. It would not be a good idea to set one up alone.

Q The pamphlets "Young People in A.A." and "Do You Think You're Different?" are quite popular with the young people in schools. Has there ever been any consideration given to including them in the P.I. Discount Package?

A Yes. "Too Young?" has recently been added to the P.I. Discount Package. G.S.O. tries to select a variety of pamphlets to provide a broad view of our Fellowship.

Q Is the use of "free" public-service air time on TV and radio consistent with our policy of self-support?

A Yes, because public-service time has no monetary value. TV and radio stations are required by law to provide air time for public-service messages.

Twelve Traditions

Q Our group would like an interpretation of the word "organized" in "A.A. . . . ought never be organized . . ." Is this not in conflict with the developing importance of the interrelationship among districts, areas, and world general service?

A Suggestions are made, but it is up to each area to determine its special needs. Every group is autonomous. The Fellowship is a structure of service, as opposed to an organization of authority.

Miscellaneous

Q Would it be possible to know how many states or provinces have a service structure at that level? (State or provincial committee.)

A A show of hands indicated that most states and provinces have such a structure.

Q What is the possibility of including a workshop on "The A.A. Service Manual" in all Regional Forums hereafter, moderated by a member of the G.S.O. staff?

A The agenda for each Regional Forum is worked out by the area delegates, the regional trustee, and the G.S.O. staff member on the assignment.

Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board, and Trustees' Committees

G.S.O. and
G.S.B. reports

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary (such as the exception noted on p. 40), acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

General Service Board

Broad view inspires optimism on A.A.'s future

Trustees' report: Despite problems and challenges, I am optimistic about A.A.'s continued health in the foreseeable future. This is based on our unique problem-solving assets: the sound, life-changing recovery program, our protective Traditions, and our remarkable general service structure—all clarified and underscored by the Concepts.

Our Fellowship is growing rapidly. Every working day this past year, your General Service Office added an average of 15 new groups to its U.S./Canada directory lists. Demand for A.A. literature is also at an all-time high. We sold over 310,000 copies of the Big Book in 1979, 25.8% more than in 1978, which had been 25% more than in 1977. At this rate, the three-millionth copy will be distributed by late 1981. Contributions have also been increasing, both in number of groups contributing and in total amount.

Grapevine circulation hits the 125,000 mark this month. I think the most important factor in its growth is the editorial excellence of the magazine. I have been a subscriber for over 30 years and find it hard to understand why any A.A. would be without it.

Good thinking has come out of the General Service Sharing Sessions and the trustees' dinner meetings, both held during board weekends. At one dinner, there was discussion of an apparent trend toward rigidity within the Fellowship, a demand for rules and regulations, and an expectation that they should somehow be enforced. It was pointed out that this is getting far away from Bill's and Dr. Bob's concept of an extremely loose, open fellowship governed by spiritual principles.

I attend all Regional Forums. Every Forum has ended with increased mutual trust.

A.A. overseas must be experienced to be understood. Since visiting Iceland to share in the 25th anniversary of A.A.'s beginning there, I have been interested in that fascinating land. In a population of only 250,000, they now have over 50 groups, have organized a service board and conference and a small G.S.O.—and are sending delegates for the first time to the World Service Meeting.

In the U.S. and Canada, there are now nearly 900 French-speaking and over 300 Spanish-speaking groups. Your G.S.O. has made a considerable effort to provide exactly the same services to these groups as to English-speaking groups.

Work has gone forward all year at both board and office levels on A.A.'s 45th Anniversary International Convention, in New Orleans in July.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., chairperson

A.A. World Services, Inc.

Contribution rise reduces literature prices

Directors' report: Here are some of the actions taken during 1979.

Chicago warehouse—We approved the recommendation for an additional warehousing operation to serve the Midwest area, due to increased activity there.

Filmstrip—We approved the proposal from a subcommittee of the Archives Committee for the expenditure of up to \$2,000 for a script and storyboard for a possible filmstrip depicting 45 years of A.A.

Central and South American zonal service meeting—We approved the proposal to send Beth Kuhlmann and Mary Ellen Welsh, as her interpreter, to represent G.S.O. at a zonal service meeting in Bogotá, Colombia, in November. This meeting was a result of a recommendation of the World Service Meeting in Helsinki—that nations get together in the years between W.S.M.'s to discuss their common problems and to help nations that are not sufficiently developed to send W.S.M. representatives. Delegates from ten countries attended.

Reprint policy—We approved four points to clarify what is involved when A.A.W.S. grants permission to quote or reprint A.A. copyrighted material.

- 1 A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all literature published by A.A.W.S. The Steps and Traditions are part of this material.
- 2 In order to meet their responsibility to protect A.A.'s copyrights, the directors of A.A.W.S. are required either to grant or to withhold legal permission to reprint or quote our Twelve Steps or any other copyrighted material.
- 3 Following the wishes of A.A.'s co-founders that our recovery program be shared as widely as possible, the directors of A.A.W.S. have adopted a policy of being as generous and nondiscriminatory as possible.
- 4 By granting permission to reprint or quote A.A. literature, including the Twelve Steps, A.A.W.S. does not and cannot control individual treatment of our Steps or other material. It should, therefore, be clearly understood that granting permission to reprint or quote does not imply approval of the interpretation.

Publishing—Sales for 1979 totaled \$3,274,500, an increase of \$577,800 over 1978. In order to help defray costs of other services that contributions could not meet, A.A.W.S. transferred approximately \$360,000 to the General Fund. In 1979, the distribution of all books, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items reached 6,609,000 units. Free literature sent to serve groups and to inform the general public about A.A. amounted to 724,000 pieces; inventory value, \$42,500.

Further reduction in cost of literature—In recognition of the increase in group contributions, we agreed that a 6% reduction be granted within the Fellowship on all literature orders for \$25 or more, with no reduction outside the Fellowship. This went into effect February 1, 1980.

Book sales to outside agencies—A letter outlining a policy governing this matter was sent to all intergroups and central offices. A few such offices have been supplying A.A. literature in large quantity to outside agencies at or below group prices. If this continues, the price structure will need to be reexamined.

Big Book tapes—We approved the price of \$25. We sought legal counsel on royalties and were advised that, as tapes were not covered in the original contract between Bill W. and the board, there is no legal obligation. However, a moral obligation seemed to exist. Lois Wilson was consulted, and she chooses to forgo any royalties for one year and then review the matter.

Literature overseas—We transferred reprint permissions held by the Australian G.S.O. to the new Australian General Service Board, at the latter's request. We granted that board's request to provide it with a year's supply of literature at inventory value, totaling \$11,400, which it will repay within a year. We granted a request from the Literature Committee of Tokyo A.A. Group to help finance the printing of 2,000 copies of the Big Book in Japanese, at an amount not to exceed \$13,700 U.S., with the inventory remaining the property of A.A.W.S. until this sum is paid. We granted a request from the General Service Board in Norway to help finance retranslation, printing, and distribution of the third edition of the Big Book at a cost to A.A.W.S. of about \$20,000. A.A.W.S. will retain title to the inventory until this sum has been repaid.

Martin Le Boutillier, chairperson

Archives

New filmstrip makes A.A. history visible

Trustees' committee: A half-hour tape, "Voices of Our Co-Founders," was prepared by the Archives Department for production and distribution by A.A.W.S. It features two of Dr. Bob's talks: at the First International Convention, in Cleveland (1950); and in Detroit (1948). Also heard on this cassette is Bill W.: reading parts of Chapter Five of the Big Book (1963); discussing A.A.'s Three Legacies (1951); and talking at the New York Intergroup dinner (1963).

The confidentiality of all Conference tapes was reaffirmed, including opening and closing sessions. No retaping of these will be permitted. The Saturday brunch talks given by the rotating trustees will continue to be made available to delegates requesting them.

A 30-minute sound filmstrip, "Markings on the Journey," has been prepared for presentation to the 30th Conference. Using materials from the archives, it shows people, events, and other elements involved in the historical development of A.A.

Fernand Ippersiel, chairperson

Staff report: The Archives Department comprises an archivist, two assistants, and a tour-conductor/cataloguer.

Tours—Over 1,300 visitors were conducted through G.S.O. last year. Another 385 came on open-house day! The tour has been redesigned to encompass all the departments, and many more archives items are available for viewing.

Filmstrip—As a special contribution to our 45th anniversary celebration in New Orleans this year, this department has cooperated in the creation of "Markings on the Journey." Several new photos recently acquired will be seen for the first time in the filmstrip. If it is approved by the 1980 Conference, the first

public showing will be at the International Convention in July.

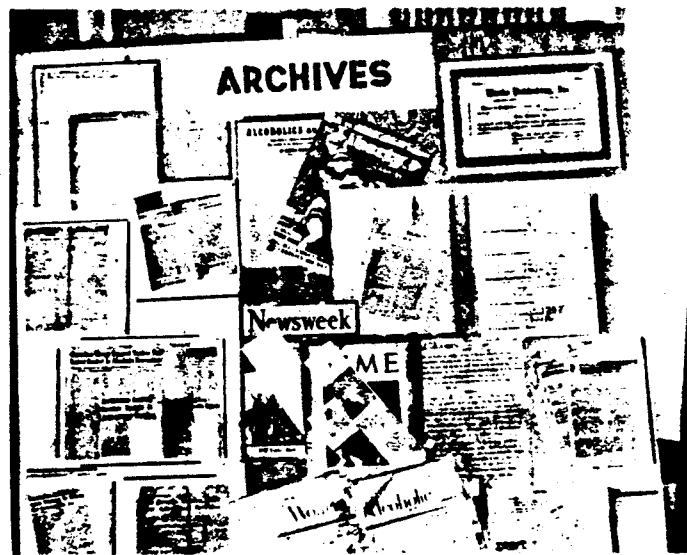
Bill Wilson tape collection—Over 100 of Bill's talks, delivered on about 70 occasions, have been retaped onto a standard format: 7-inch reel, reel-to-reel. These have been coded, and a volunteer expert has compiled a book index. We continue to seek copies of Bill's talks from other collections. There may be a total of 150 in our tape library when completed.

Scrapbook rehabilitation—We have seven large scrapbooks of news clippings (1939-1947) restored by encapsulation: an eighth is in preparation. By the end of the year, two more will be completed, representing a decade of news coverage of A.A.

Handbook—As a service to those areas establishing archival centers, we have prepared a handbook of experience. We are presently corresponding with centers in 30 states, Canadian provinces, and overseas countries.

Oldtimers—Many early members and nonalcoholic friends of A.A. have taken leave of us within the past year: Sackville M. in Ireland; Jack MacG. in Scotland; Cebra G., long a resident of France; Ernie G., early Toledo member; Henrietta Seiberling; Archibald Roosevelt; Austin MacCormick; and Niles Peebles, former trustee, who had also worked at G.S.O. Our oral-history project actively grew, and we added over 30 tapes to our tape collection. We also received two tape collections donated by local members.

Nell Wing, archivist



Conference

'What's on Your Mind?' suggested for 1981

Trustees' committee: The purpose of this committee is to review ways and means of improving the General Service Conference. It also considers suggested Conference themes and agenda topics. The committee reviewed suggested 1980 themes and recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee three from which to make a final choice.

Evaluations of the 1979 Conference questionnaire and post-Conference G.S.O. sharing session were also reviewed. There is a need for Conference members with varying service roles to share their feelings about the Conference informally.

All agenda topics submitted were discussed and referred to the appropriate Conference committee, presentation/discussion, workshop, or Ask-It Basket session. A list of Conference members to participate in sessions of those types was drawn up and approved.

Many items periodically suggested for discussion involve the Conference structure. So it was suggested that the sharing session at the 1980 Conference center on "How Well Is Our Conference Structure Working?" If a clear sense of the session indicates that action should be taken, the item(s) will be referred to the proper 1981 Conference committee. No Advisory Action to change the Conference structure will be made in 1980.

The committee also discussed the possibility of scheduling "What's on Your Mind?" sessions, or sharing sessions, at the 1981 Conference, and reducing Ask-It Basket time. This item has been referred to the Conference Agenda Committee.

George Dorsey, chairperson

Staff report: The purpose of the General Service Conference is to assume the responsibility of leadership once held by the founders of A.A. and, through its structure, to carry the A.A. message. It is also a policy-making body that expresses the group conscience of the Fellowship.

The Conference coordinator is a point of contact among all Conference members (Panel 29 and 30 delegates, trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. and GV staffs) and all members of area general service committees. We now have on our mailing list: 770 past delegates, 2,025 district committee members, 90 area committee chairpersons, 86 area committee secretaries, and 76 area committee treasurers.

We receive minutes of most area assemblies and committee meetings, which are circulated among the G.S.O. and GV staffs. This communication is helpful to us all, as it is the best way to keep up with A.A. activities around the country.

All A.A.'s are encouraged to send in suggestions for the Conference agenda, usually through the delegates. Suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval. Afterward, they are shared with everyone by way of the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda mailed to the delegates in January.

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collection of items for the Conference theme and Conference agenda.
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- 3 Monthly letters and advance correspondence with all delegates in preparation for the Conference.
- 4 Working with the general manager, the office manager, and the staff in planning and coordination of the Conference.
- 5 Scheduling and routing of all reports and other material

for Conference Manuals, Early Bird edition of Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*.

6 Preparation of Conference Advisory Actions and summaries of Ask-It Basket questions.

7 Reviewing minutes, reports, and all communications received from area committees and district committee members.

Sarah Price

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Groups urged to welcome treatment 'graduates'

Trustees' committee: Under the guidance of this committee, A.A. put on two workshops at the Annual Forum of the National Council on Alcoholism, in Washington, D.C., April 27-May 2, 1979. One was "For A.A. Members Working in the Alcoholism Field"; the other, "How A.A. Cooperates With Medical and Nursing Schools."

At the Association of Labor Management Administrators and Counselors on Alcoholism (A.L.M.A.C.A.) Conference in Detroit, Mich., October 1-5, 1979, our chairperson presented the question "A.A.—Complementary or Competitive With Occupational Program Consultants?"

A committee member, Dr. John Bealer, represented the General Service Board at the World Health Organization's Expert Committee on Problems Related to Alcohol Consumption, in Geneva, Switzerland, November 20-26, 1979.

After reviewing the pamphlet "A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee," the committee agreed that it was too long and contained out-of-date information. It was recommended that the pamphlet be discontinued.

It was recommended that our newsletter for the professional community, *About A.A.*, be published three times a year and might include the experience of treatment programs where there is successful cooperation between A.A. and professional staffs.

Considering ways to inform A.A. members of the need to accept people from treatment centers into A.A. groups, we recommended that:

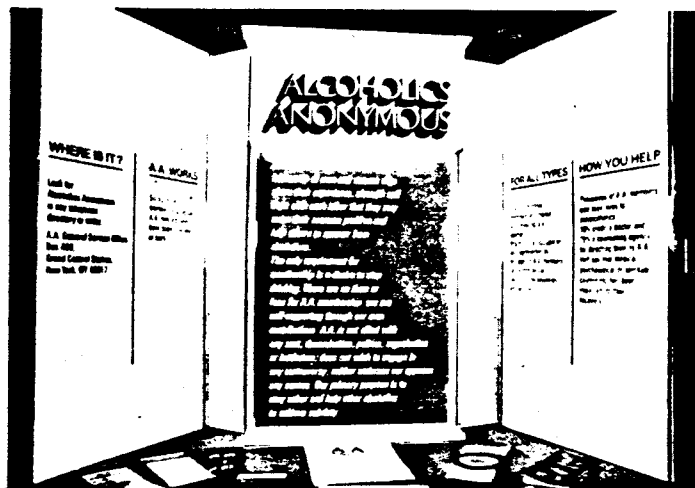
- Box 4-5-9 carry a story on the need for C.P.C. work, with emphasis on bridging the gap between treatment facilities and A.A. groups. (This appeared in the February-March 1980 issue.)
- The International Convention include a C.P.C. workshop, with successful area (or local) C.P.C. committee members invited to share their experiences.
- Emphasis on C.P.C. work be included in the agenda of the 1980 General Service Conference.
- The *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* include more information about cooperation with the professional community.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

Staff report: The committee and the staff try to further A.A.'s primary purpose through sharing information about A.A. with professionals who have contact with alcoholics.

Staff, committee, and board members have participated in:

- Women in Crisis Conference
- Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Rutgers University
- Summer School of Alcohol Studies, University of Utah
- Meetings of Advisory Council, National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.)
- 30th Annual Meeting of Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America (A.D.P.A.)
- National Association of Alcoholism Counselors Conference
- Meeting of Committee of Public Health, Medical Society of the County of New York, and New York Academy of Medicine
- Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse
- Meeting of the International Maritime Union



Our professional exhibit was shown at 23 meetings of national or regional organizations in 1979. As a result, we received 1,916 requests for additional information, and there was a significant increase in the *About A.A.* mailing list.

A paper on "Suggestions for Working With the Hearing-Impaired Alcoholic" was sent to some 85 agencies for the deaf that had indicated they wanted to receive the results of the survey within the Fellowship re the deaf alcoholic.

Letters announcing the availability of the new pamphlet "Time to Start Living" were sent to the National Council on the Aging, H.E.W. Administration on Aging, N.C.A. Blue Ribbon Study Commission on Alcoholism and the Aging, and National Clearinghouse on Alcohol Information. Complimentary copies of the pamphlet were enclosed.

As recommended by the 1979 Conference, the film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" is now being distributed to those with an expressed direct interest in helping the sick alcoholic, such as treatment programs and professional groups.

Lois Fisher

Correctional Facilities

More Twelfth Step visits and letters needed

Trustees' committee: We reviewed the contents of the Institutions Discount Packages and added to each, with no cost

increase, copies of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and the flyers "A.A. at a Glance" and "Where Do I Go From Here?"

We recommended that A.A.W.S. consider an introductory discount price for small quantities of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," as a discount on this pamphlet would make it more easily available to institutions committees and "inside" groups. The committee discussed the feasibility of a filmstrip based on the pamphlet, and recommended that we do not proceed with it at this time.

We recommended that a film or filmstrip be considered to show how the service structure of A.A. may be utilized to encourage members on the "outside" to do Twelfth Step work in correctional facilities.

We are sharing ideas on how to improve the *Institutions Bulletin*, and having a joint meeting with the Committee on Treatment Facilities on the goals of this bulletin. It was suggested that chairpersons and secretaries of the two committees have a joint meeting during Conference week.

We discussed how to stimulate more interest and participation by A.A. members in the Institutions Correspondence Service. Much of the correspondence is being done by institutions committees in their local areas.

The advisability of local areas' following the General Service Board procedure of separating its Institutions Committee into two committees—on Correctional Facilities and on Treatment Facilities—was discussed, along with the subject of group autonomy involved in such a decision. Areas that have separate correctional and treatment facilities committees find they have an additional way to get A.A. members involved in service work.

W. J. Estelle Jr., chairperson

Staff report: "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" was made available in mid-August at 25¢ per copy. Copies of this pamphlet were mailed with the October issue of the *Institutions Bulletin*.

To stimulate more participation in the Institutions Correspondence Service, these measures were suggested: an article in *Box 4-5-9* listing the number of members participating, according to states; use of the theme of the 1975 Denver Convention, "Let It Begin With Me"; contacts with prerelease sponsors; and an increase in correctional facilities workshops.

We hope to have more individual sharing of experience, strength, and hope between inmates and outside institution committee members.

The film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" is now available to correctional facilities, free of charge; a new procedure manual facilitates ordering. There are nine prints available of that film, four of "Bill's Own Story," and three of "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions." Because of problems with customs, films for Canadian correctional facilities will be handled by Association Industrial Films of Toronto, Ont.

We did a mail survey in the U.S. and Canada covering 25 institutions where we know there have been A.A. groups from time to time. This was done to obtain a history of groups in facilities for the archives.

The *Institutions Bulletin* will be printed on paper of a different color, and the type will be blue and of a different size.

Curtis Monahan

Finance

Good news—A.A. growth; bad news—inflation

Trustees' committee: Because G.S.O. was becoming increasingly dependent on literature income for its operations, previous Conferences asked the board to take action to broaden the base of group support. In anticipation of an increase in group support, the prices of the *Big Book* and the other books were lowered, bulk discounts were liberalized, and a greater quantity of literature was distributed gratis. To make this policy work, and further reduce literature prices, the groups had to make that extra effort to participate more fully in the cost of general services in order to help defray the loss in literature income.

When the groups are properly informed, they will respond—and they did respond! Contributions from A.A. groups and members in 1979 finished up \$158,200 (14.6%) over 1978. And even the percentage of groups contributing showed a gain. All of this allowed a further reduction in the cost of literature to the Fellowship. As of February 1, 1980, a 6% discount on all literature orders in excess of \$25 became available on sales to A.A.'s.

If we can get more groups to join us in our efforts to broaden the base of group support, we should be able to look forward to future additional reductions in literature prices.

Literature sales continue to reflect A.A. growth and activity. Sales for 1979, totaling \$3,262,800, showed a gain of 21% (\$566,000) over 1978 sales. Total G.S.O. income—representing publishing gross profit, contributions from A.A. groups and members, and interest generated by cash flow—was \$3,174,400, an increase of \$460,200 over 1978. G.S.O. expenses for 1979 increased by \$219,200 (8.5%) over 1978. The major variations in expenses were primarily as budgeted and were basically due to inflation and, of course, to the growth of the Fellowship.

To sum up: The operating deficit of the General Service Board General Fund, representing a contribution shortfall plus the other expenses of the board, was met by the net income from the publishing operation, which totaled \$849,700, leaving a net G.S.O. income in the amount of \$585,500, compared with \$344,600 for 1978. After satisfying operating requirements, the balance of the net income was transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund per prior Conference action.

The committee reviewed and approved the 1980 G.S.O. budget, a prudent one, allowing for increases in both income and expense. Sales income, adjusted to reflect the 6% discount, has been budgeted to show an increase of 9%. Contributions are expected to increase by 10%. Total G.S.O. income from all operations is budgeted to show an increase of 6.3%. Expenses are projected to be over 1979 by 17.5%. However, the elimination of certain nonrecurring items reduces the budgeted increase of operating expenses to 12.9%.

Income from Grapevine operations totaled \$689,100, an increase of \$80,800 over 1978, and \$34,200 over budget. Reflecting inflated printing and operating costs, expenses increased by \$136,300—\$77,200 over budget. A net income of \$4,000 had been budgeted for 1979; there was an actual loss of \$39,000. Interest earned on the investment of deferred subscription income was transferred from the General Service Board Reserve Fund to offset that loss.

The 1980 Grapevine budget was approved by the committee, which accepted the recommendation of a \$1-per-year subscription price increase effective June 1, 1980. This increase is expected to offset an otherwise projected deficit amounting to \$47,400 and, instead, to result in a net income of \$9,600.

All in all, it was a good year, and we are more than holding our own in spite of severe inflationary pressures and, happily, continuing Fellowship growth.

Frank Smeal, chairperson, board treasurer

See pp. 50-55 for detailed financial information.

General Service Sharing Session

Anonymity, self-support, C.P.C. examined

Trustees' report: The General Service Sharing Session serves as a forum for all trustees, directors, committee people, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members to discuss A.A. matters of general concern and interest to the Fellowship at large.

In July, anonymity was discussed, after three excellent presentations. The subject concerns us all and puzzles many of us. The consensus seemed to be that we try to move away from technicalities and strict, legalistic approaches, and emphasize instead the concept of anonymity and the reasons for it. It was pointed out that, rather than argue fine points of interpretation, we should concentrate on using common sense and emphasize the importance of anonymity for A.A. strength—past, present, and future. Because of rotation among service workers in A.A., there is need for continuing discussion and education on anonymity.

In October, we considered "Self-Support—What Does It Mean?" Presentations were given on these topics: the overall policy of self-support; how A.A.-related expenses of regional trustees are met by A.A.'s in one region; and the meaning of self-support at the group level.

As usual in A.A., there seem to be no hard-and-fast rules. Everyone agreed that A.A. groups ought to be self-supporting; if a group meets in a facility that cannot accept rent, the group can make a contribution in kind, it was suggested. Should group funds be used to support "drunk farms" and other alcoholism treatment centers? It was pointed out that this is not in keeping with our Sixth Tradition.

In February, under the broad topic of "Cooperation Without Affiliation," we addressed the subject of "bridging the gap" between the alcoholism treatment facility and A.A. in the community. We heard presentations on what professional administrators and staff can do to facilitate this process, and on how

A.A. can fulfill its primary purpose through cooperation with the professional community.

One treatment facility has formed a committee composed of facility "graduates" active in A.A. in their community. They meet with the staff of the facility; "sponsor" staff members; show our film "A.A.—An Inside View"; take staff to open A.A. meetings; and provide examples of the First and Second Steps of the A.A. program. At the group level in many areas, the situation is more complicated. Some hostility still exists toward people in the professional community. The following suggestions were made:

- 1 Sponsor your doctor.
- 2 Sponsor a counselor.
- 3 Invite professionals to A.A. meetings.
- 4 Establish local C.P.C. committees.
- 5 Explain the difference between cooperation and affiliation—study Traditions.
- 6 Keep an open mind.
- 7 Talk about interim sponsorship at beginners meetings and during the break at A.A. meetings.
- 8 Hold open A.A. meetings in hospitals and other treatment facilities to make it easy for staff to attend.
- 9 Include "graduates" on C.P.C. committees.
- 10 Do not give advice on medication prescribed by doctors.
- 11 Sponsor young people into C.P.C. work.

Several people stressed the power of example as one of our most potent tools, both with new A.A. members and with professionals. Our literature was cited as another effective tool. We must make it clear that C.P.C. is not only allowed but encouraged as a means of fulfilling our primary purpose.

Don Nicolson, chairperson

Group services coordinator

Equal services regardless of tongues

Staff report: The primary responsibility of this coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole, supervising production of all service material.

Handbooks and kits—There are three New Group Handbooks: (1) New Group Handbook; (2) New Correctional Facilities Group Handbook; (3) New Treatment Facilities Group Handbook.

New groups in the United States and Canada receive a Group Handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, and a complimentary supply of literature. These new groups are also placed on our mailing lists to receive *Box 4-5-9* and the appropriate regional A.A. directory when issued. We have developed similar services for French- and Spanish-speaking groups in the U.S./Canada structure. Within the past year, we have developed a French G.S.R. Kit, which accompanies the French Group Handbook, and French literature. Spanish-speaking groups receive complimentary literature and their own Group Handbook.

Guidelines—As the need arises, they are updated to keep up with current trends. There are now 13: Armed Services; Central or Intergroup Offices; Clubs; Conferences and Conventions;

Cooperating With Court, A.S.A.P. and Similar Programs; Institutions Committees; Public Information; Relationship Between A.A. and Al-Anon; On Occupational Programs (formerly On Industry Programs); On Current Usage of the A.A. Directories (U.S. and Canada); For A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field; Forming Local Committees on Cooperation with the Professional Community; A.A. Answering Services.

Service material—We have a list of A.A. members who wish to exchange tapes or who may wish to correspond. We also have listings of Loners, Internationalists, armed services groups, etc. Within the past year, we have developed a service piece containing suggestions for carrying the A.A. message to hearing-impaired alcoholics. Other service material includes: fellowships similar to A.A.; overseas G.S.O.'s; central offices in U.S. and Canada; books and pamphlets in languages other than English (Foreign Literature Order Form, Spanish Order Form); suggested topics for discussion meetings; conducting workshops and sharing sessions.

Box 4-5-9—About 55,000 copies of *Box 4-5-9* are mailed bi-monthly, including some 44,000 in English and the balance in French and Spanish. As editor of *Box 4-5-9*, the service coordinator gathers all material for each issue (two months in advance) and is responsible for coordinating each issue with the Editorial Committee.

Films—Two 16mm color films are available: "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions." They are distributed to regular A.A. and Al-Anon groups (1974 Conference action) at \$35 per week, and free of charge to A.A. groups in institutions.

Filmstrips—"P.O. Box 459" and "Circles of Love and Service" may be purchased at \$6.50 each for group meetings, assemblies, and conventions.

Vincina McCarthy

International

A.A. travelers can help spread the message

Trustees' committee: Among our five members, two are trustees currently serving as delegates to the World Service Meeting. We explore ways in which the General Service Board and/or Office may assist in the growth of A.A. worldwide, with particular attention given to countries where there is no A.A. service structure.

A questionnaire was completed, to be given to traveling A.A.'s visiting overseas countries, so they can forward up-to-date records and information on contacts as they visit these countries—especially countries without a general service board or office.

It was suggested that a sentence be added to the *International A.A. Directory* to this effect: "Information about A.A. is available at American embassies."

We also suggested that there be an information booth at our International Convention to help members gather information about overseas A.A. activities, and that we explore the possibility of distributing the *International A.A. Directory* there.

The committee discussed how we can help small areas without a service structure (having groups or Loners only) translate and reproduce A.A. Conference-approved literature, e.g., in Swahili, Arabic, Persian, and Greek. We thought it best to have literature translated by A.A.'s. If necessary, it could be done by non-A.A.'s, but *all* translations should be checked by A.A.'s, if possible. The committee agreed that countries should show initiative before such a project is started, and that translations should be done on a volunteer basis rather than on a pay basis. However, the latter could be explored.

We discussed the relationship of central offices/intergroups to national service structures overseas, and suggested that a workshop or presentation on the topic be on the agenda of the Sixth World Service Meeting.

Regarding a recommendation from the Fifth World Service Meeting that the W.S.M. be restructured to better fulfill its objectives, we felt that existing regional service meetings between W.S.M.'s should be continued, and extension of the regional idea should also be encouraged.

Virginia Hallman, chairperson

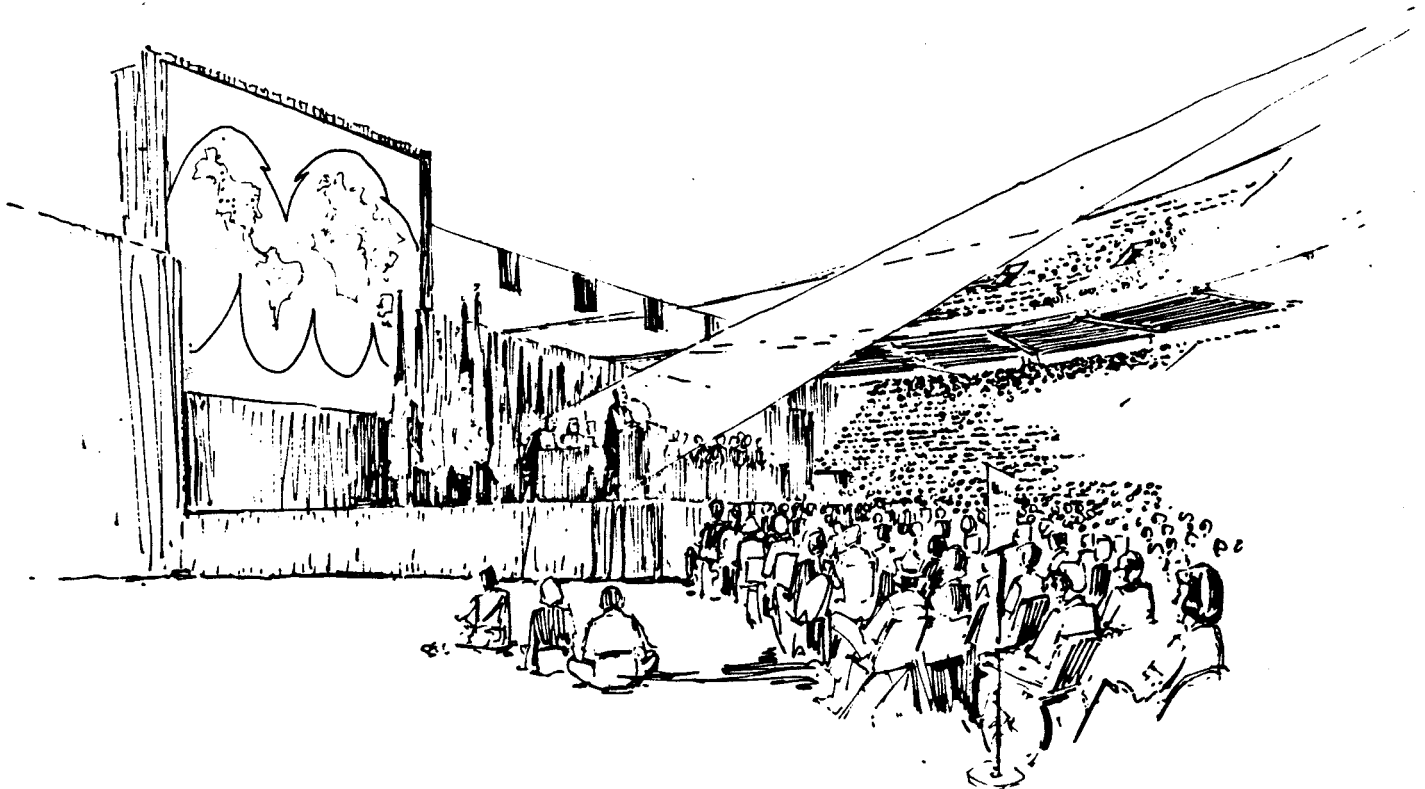
International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

Speeding Convention plans; new Forum ideas

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—During the past year, the committee recommended that:

- 1 Three additions be made to the list of workshop topics: "Archives"; "Deaf Alcoholics"; "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Medical and Nursing Schools."
- 2 A section of the Superdome be roped off for deaf alcoholics, so that the Big Meetings may be signed for them, and that this information be published in *Box 4-5-9*.
- 3 The services of Murphy Associates be employed to handle public information for the 1980 Convention.
- 4 A booth be set up at the 1980 Convention to assist Conventioneers who do not speak English.
- 5 State and regional convention committees be requested to reschedule their 1980 events so they don't take place between May 1 and August 19 and thereby affect attendance at the New Orleans Convention—and vice versa—and that this recommendation be published in *Box 4-5-9*.
- 6 Hospitality suites conducted by agencies outside of A.A. not be listed in our A.A. Directory of Hospitality Suites at the 1980 Convention.
- 7 The sponsors of the Gay Hospitality Center at the Convention be requested not to schedule any events in time slots that would compete with the Convention program.
- 8 A luncheon be scheduled at the Convention to include past and present World Service Meeting delegates.
- 9 The following procedure for state, provincial, and regional alkathons be used:



- Alkathons of states and provinces with one, two, or three area delegates will last 90 minutes; of those with four, two hours; of California, with five, two and a half hours.
- If there is more than one delegate, each chooses one speaker from the area, and the delegates then determine which speaker will chair. If there is one delegate, he or she selects two speakers and a chairperson.
- Regional trustees each select three speakers from the region for the two-hour regional alkathons, and the trustee will preside.
- All speakers must be registered for the Convention.

10 The 1980 Conference Committee on the International Convention be asked to reconsider the recommendation of the 1979 Conference that simultaneous translations be provided free.

Regional Forums—Since the concept was developed in 1975, 14 Regional Forums have been held. Since last year's Conference, three regions have hosted Forums, and Alaska hosted a mini-forum in combination with its state conference. Our committee has discussed each of these Forums, all well-received and considered informative.

We have also reviewed suggestions for improving future Regional Forums and have recommended that: (1) Forum participants be informed of issues and problems within the Fellowship; (2) workshop moderators be responsible for keeping discussion productive; (3) staff secretary work closely with regional trustee and delegates in planning Forum agenda.

Our committee also reaffirmed a previous recommendation that A.A. talks not be scheduled at Regional Forums, because Forums have a special service purpose—to improve communication within the Fellowship.

Box 4-5-9 keeps the Fellowship informed of upcoming Regional Forums. Here is the schedule:

1980		
May 16-18	Eastern Canada	Moncton, N.B.
September 26-28	Pacific U.S.	Phoenix, Ariz.
December	Southeast	Atlanta, Ga.
1981		
March	West Central	
May	Northeast	
September	East Central	Ohio
December	Southwest (?)	
1982		
March	Eastern Canada	Montreal, Que.

Cec Corrigan, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention—A.A.'s 45th anniversary will be celebrated this year with an International Convention in New Orleans, La., July 3-6. The theme is "The Joy of Living," and A.A.'s from more than 30 countries will gather to celebrate sobriety.

The staff secretary coordinates the activities of the many Convention committees—the trustees' committee, the Conference committee, the Host Committee, and the G.S.O. Planning Committee, as well as the Al-Anon Planning Committee—and serves as secretary to the A.A. committees.

All major events will be held in the Superdome arena; panels and workshops, in large rooms in the quadrants of the Superdome; alkathons, day and night in hotel ballrooms.

The welcoming Mardi Gras Ball will be held Thursday evening,

July 3, in the Rivergate Convention Center; the Crawfish Crawl (for young people), at the same time at the Marriott Hotel.

Al-Anon will be selling "Lois Remembers" in a booth at the Superdome, and A.A.W.S. will introduce Dr. Bob's biography, "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers." Commemorative bookplates will be available. At the Grapevine booth, the memorial issues for Dr. Bob (January 1951) and Bill W. (March 1971) will be given free as a bonus with each subscription ordered, and a packet of the two issues may also be purchased separately.

Betty Liddle

A.A. Regional Forums—Forums have been held by all regions; plans for the second and third rounds are under way. Regional Forums are held on invitation of the region, and plans are made with the regional trustee, delegates from areas in the region, and the G.S.O. staff. General Service Board personnel who have attended the Regional Forums have included: trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, and an A.A.W.S. director. Hotel, mail, and travel expenses of board personnel in attendance are paid by the board; expenses for service people in the region are the responsibility of either the individuals or the area committees.

The responsibilities of the coordinator are as follows:

- 1 Planning meetings with the regional trustee and delegates and the general manager of G.S.O.
- 2 Arrangements with host-city contact, who acts as the local liaison.
- 3 Arrangements with hotel and host city.
- 4 Travel and hotel arrangements for trustees and G.S.O. staff.
- 5 Regional mailings in connection with the Regional Forums to: area delegates, asking for their suggestions regarding agenda plans, with a follow-up letter about participation in the Forum; all G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, past/present delegates, past/present trustees, and central offices. Any A.A. member wishing to attend may request a registration/reservation form.
- 6 Display boards of sample literature and service material.
- 7 Reports of Regional Forums and mailing to all Forum participants, trustees, and current delegates.
- 8 All correspondence concerning Regional Forums.

Vincina McCarthy

Internationalists, Loners, LIMs

Sudden growth in long-distance sharing

Staff report: Our Internationalist membership grows aboard ships all over the world, from 590 a year ago to 800 as of March 1, 1980. These A.A.'s have started many groups in ports and 19 on their ships.

The most recent shipboard group is on the U.S.S. Yosemite,

and its founder writes: "When I was transferred to the Yosemite, I was welcomed with a comradeship that I never found in any fraternal organization. I cannot express what I feel for everybody in this outstanding Fellowship, but only echo the saying 'I have friends all over this Fellowship—I just have not met them all yet.'"

The Internationalist service assignment provides a way for seagoing A.A.'s to keep in touch with the A.A. program through correspondence with one another, with Lone Members, and with the staff member on this assignment. When Internationalists no longer go to sea, they may be added to the G.S.O. mailing list as Port Contacts if they wish. These contacts are scattered throughout the world, and many have started groups in various ports.

Loner membership also has grown, from 482 a year ago to 760 as of March 1, including Lone Members who speak English, Spanish, French, and German. Loners are A.A. members unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. They are encouraged to start groups when they meet other alcoholics. Until then, Loners stay sober through reading A.A. literature and sharing via correspondence and tapes.

We have Loners in many areas overseas, including: Yugoslavia, Taiwan, U.S.S.R. (Moscow), Saudi Arabia, locations throughout the continent of Africa, and even a lighthouse off the Irish coast.

Each new Internationalist or new Loner receives a literature package, the alternating bimonthly bulletins *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* and *Box 4-5-9*, a list of Loners and Internationalists, and a Grapevine subscription order form. A Loner receives the A.A. directory in which he or she will be listed; an Internationalist, all four directories.

Housebound A.A.'s are called LIMs; we have over 30 on the G.S.O. mailing list. They also receive *L.I.M.* and the Loner list, so they may share by correspondence.

Our Loner Sponsors, now numbering 1,250 — 250 more than a year ago — like to correspond and share their experience, strength, hope, and group activities with Lone Members.

Recently, the Belgian-Flemish Loner-Sponsor Group wrote G.S.O., "We are looking out for Flemish and Dutch Loners all over the world, so we have regular written contact with them."

Lyla Bonney

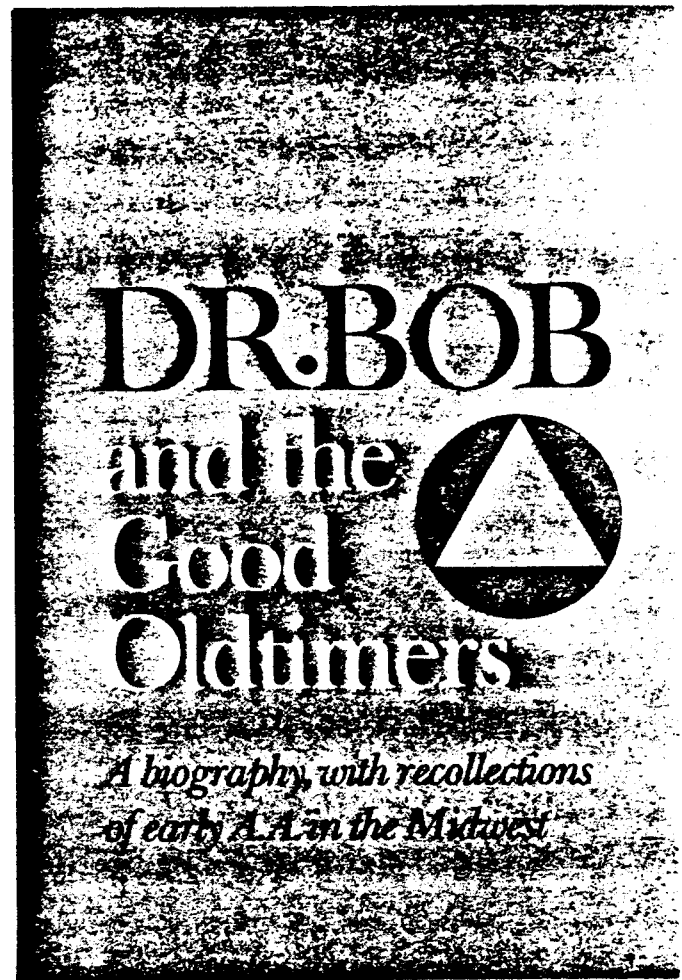
Literature

Dr. Bob biography about to go on the press

Trustees' committee: In cooperation with the Conference Literature Committee, we have worked on the following:

Literature projects

- "Time to Start Living": stories of those who came to A.A. in their later years; published September 1979; 31,000 copies sold by March 1. This pamphlet was also printed in a large-type version for those with vision problems.



Advance copies of our new book were available in June for Founders Day weekend in Akron, where A.A. started. Then, the book went on sale at the International Convention in New Orleans in July.

- "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers": in production at Conference time. The Conference committee approved the manuscript by mail poll.
- Bill W. biography: illness of the writer caused delay in production of this book. We anticipate completion in 1981.
- "A Newcomer Asks": The committee recommended we adopt the text of this pamphlet approved by the Conference in Great Britain, provided we were granted permission to make minor word changes. Approval was obtained, and minor re-writing completed.

Audiovisual projects

- "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View": After all improvements suggested by the 1979 Conference were completed, 250 prints of the film were obtained and made available for a week's use and on open-ended long-term leases within A.A. and to those in a position to help the still-suffering alcoholic.
- "Alcoholics Anonymous": Tapes of the book were completed in December 1979. Copies sold as of March 1: 121.

- For "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, we approved new copy based on Conference recommendations against (1) listing alcohol-and-pill groups and family groups and (2) naming a group after a person or after the facility in which it meets.

- We considered a suggestion to publish a short, simple, illustrated recovery pamphlet for the hearing-impaired alcoholic, and recommended that this be prepared with guidance from experts in the field of deafness.

- A suggestion to do a pamphlet for those who have slipped and are returning to A.A. was not accepted, because much of our literature speaks to this.

Samuel Smith, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment involves preparation, production, editorial supervision, and distribution of publications and audiovisual materials in coordination with other staff members, and work with the group services coordinator on all service material.

Our eight periodical bulletins have a combined circulation of 76,172, as follows:

	Mailing list	Issues per year
Box 4-5-9 (English)	44,372	6
Box 4-5-9 (French) ¹	1,900	6
Box 4-5-9 (Spanish)	9,700	6
Loners-Internationalists Meeting	2,800	6
P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin	2,750	3
Institutions Bulletin	5,350	3
Quarterly Report	3,900	3 ²
About A.A.	5,400	3
Total	76,172	36

The literature coordinator works closely with editors on updating and revising old pamphlets and with writers, artists, editors, and printers in the preparation of new pamphlets, displays, leaflets, and other service material.

Special projects included working with experts from the National Association of the Deaf, which is presently reviewing some of our basic pamphlets of recovery to suggest how this material can be made more meaningful to the hearing-impaired alcoholic.

There is frequent correspondence with A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about A.A. literature. The literature coordinator sends a letter semiannually to all central offices, intergroup committees, and literature distribution centers in the U.S. and Canada and overseas to keep them informed of anything new in the area of A.A. literature, periodical publications, and audiovisual materials.

Helen Turnquest

¹ Now translated and printed by the French Literature Service in Montreal, Que., in cooperation with this office.

² The *Final Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.

Nominating

Election procedure for trustees restudied

Trustees' committee: The 1979 Conference asked that the method of electing trustees-at-large/U.S. and Canada be reviewed. A subcommittee formed for this purpose recommended no change in the procedure at this time and reconsideration of the question following the election of the trustee-at-large/U.S. in 1981.

We discussed advantages and disadvantages of the three-minute nomination speeches for regional trustee and trustee-at-large candidates given by delegates at the Conference. It was generally agreed that oral nominating speeches are helpful to voting members. Because many delegates simply read the information from the résumé sheet distributed to each voting member, we recommended that they be asked to give additional information about the candidates. It was also agreed that the speech be confined to two minutes.

The committee felt that, in the spirit of rotation, retired staff members of G.S.O. and the Grapevine would not be eligible for nomination as trustees or as directors of the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Boards. [This recommendation was not accepted; see Advisory Action 71, p. 49.]

Milton Maxwell's term as a Class A trustee will expire in 1980. However, according to the bylaws of the General Service Board, he is eligible to continue his tenure as chairperson of the board for six successive one-year terms. It is the committee's earnest wish that he continue for that entire period, or any portion he deems suitable. Milton expressed his gratitude and stated that he would serve for one more year and then inform the board of his plans.

We approved: Donald F. Daly (to replace Ed Small in August) as a general service trustee for the A.A. Grapevine board; all candidates for Class B regional trustee from the West Central U.S. and Western Canada Regions; William E. Flynn, M.D., as a Class A trustee to replace John D. Bealer, M.D.; LaVelle Clifford as an A.A.W.S. director to replace Don Nicolson after the April meeting.

We recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April, following presentation to the 1980 Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Gordon M. Patrick
W. J. ("Jim") Estelle Jr.	Frank P. Smeal
William E. Flynn, M.D.	Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.	

Class B

Stan N. Cameron	Ruth K. Hartshorn
LaVelle Clifford	Fernand Ippersiel
Jerry Danzig	Martin Le Boutillier
George E. Dorsey	John Ryall
Richard J. Driscoll	Edward J. Small ¹
Virginia Hallman	Samuel E. Smith

One regional trustee—Western Canada

One regional trustee—West Central U.S.

We approved the following as officers of the board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Gordon M. Patrick
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Michael Alexander
<i>Secretary</i>	Ruth K. Hartshorn
<i>Treasurer</i>	Frank P. Smeal
<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Dennis I. Manders
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Phyllis Masback

We recommended that this slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1980 Conference:

John Bragg	Martin Le Boutillier
LaVelle Clifford	Phyllis Masback
Jerry Danzig	Robert G. Pearson
George E. Dorsey	Jacquelyn Solomon ²
Louis Kraus	

We recommended to the Conference as Grapevine directors:

Stan N. Cameron	Mary Phelps
Jeanne L. Conway	John Ryall
Donald F. Daly	Edward J. Small ³
Retha Gresham	Lucy Warner
Virginia Hallman	John Williams

Edward Small, chairperson

- 1 To be replaced in August by Donald F. Daly
- 2 To be replaced in August by Virginia Turner
- 3 Serves until August 1980

Overseas, World Service Meeting

A.A.'s draw closer as the A.A. world widens

Staff report:

Overseas—A.A. membership exceeds 360,000, with more than 14,000 groups.

The staff member on the overseas assignment corresponds with

general service offices and literature distribution centers in foreign countries. There are 26 overseas G.S.O.'s and literature distribution centers, located in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Great Britain, Finland, France, West Germany, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, Ireland, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, and Switzerland.

Groups and individuals in those countries are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.'s. Our correspondence is mostly with the overseas G.S.O.'s and literature distribution centers. A.A. and its services are growing in overseas Spanish-speaking countries.

For countries having their own G.S.O.'s, we list only English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact the individual G.S.O.'s to get up-to-date information on groups.

We work closely with A.A.'s in other overseas countries to help them establish distribution centers, general service boards, and general service offices. Guidelines for setting up these entities are available from G.S.O.

To protect A.A.'s copyright, careful consideration is given to granting reprint permissions within the Fellowship. Translations from overseas countries are checked by bilingual A.A. members in the United States and Canada. No permission is needed simply to *translate* Conference-approved literature. But before the project of *printing* a translation begins, G.S.O. first explores the way the material will be financed and distributed, and it is then presented to A.A.W.S. for permission to reprint.

Here are some brief highlights: Australia's G.S.O. is working toward publishing four A.A. pamphlets in Serbo-Croatian and Greek, and some literature is also being translated into Latvian; A.A. members in Italy have completed the translation of the Big Book into their language; the Big Book in Japanese is available through G.S.O. and the A.A. Japan Service Office in Tokyo; in 1979, Iceland and Spain completed their national structures and now have General Service Boards and Offices; A.A.'s in Taiwan have started to translate the Big Book into Chinese.



World Service Meeting – Nineteen countries and 35 delegates will participate in the Sixth World Service Meeting, June 27-30, 1980, at the Harrison Conference Center, Glen Cove, N.Y. The W.S.M. meets every other year and alternates its sites between the U.S. and overseas. Countries attending the 1980 Meeting will present bids to host the 1982 Meeting.

Delegates to the W.S.M. should be legal residents and preferably citizens of the countries they serve. It is recommended that a country be represented either by two A.A.'s or by one A.A. and one non-A.A., with one of the two delegates being a member of the general service board or the national service committee and the other being a salaried or volunteer staff member. Delegates need to have a working knowledge of the English language, as the Meeting is conducted in English. Each serves four years, attending two W.S.M.'s. When countries develop national structures, they are qualified to send delegates.

Following a suggestion from the Fifth W.S.M. to have interim service meetings on a geographical basis, there was a European Service Meeting held in London, England, and a Latin American Service Meeting held in Bogotá, Colombia, in 1979.

A final report on the Sixth World Service Meeting will be available.

Beth Kuhlmann

Public Information

New TV spots, new workbook aid P.I. efforts

Trustees' committee: A news release covering the presentation of the two-millionth copy of the Big Book to then H.E.W. Secretary Joseph Califano by Lois Wilson was sent to major wire services and networks in the U.S. and Canada.

Changes were made in the pamphlets "Understanding Anonymity" and "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to reflect the majority opinion of the 1978 Conference that most A.A.'s use their first names only when speaking at non-A.A. meetings.

The new Public Information Workbook was completed and mailed to all public information committee chairpersons in the U.S. and Canada. Additional copies may be ordered at a cost of \$7.

The annual anonymity letter to media, now in memo form, was mailed in November to more than 465 newspapers and radio and TV stations. A parallel anonymity letter was sent to over 5,000 alcoholism treatment centers, detox centers, and rehabilitation facilities and agencies.

A questionnaire sent to local P.I. committees revealed that their greatest need was to get more A.A.'s interested in P.I. work. The results of the questionnaire were printed in the Winter/Spring 1979 issue of the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*.

In response to some of the problems identified by that survey, the committee plans working in the following areas: (1) Develop suggestions for local P.I. workshops; (2) help P.I. committees stimulate more enthusiasm for P.I. work; (3) provide ideas

on reaching large metropolitan newspapers; (4) generate ideas on how to work with the press (sponsor your reporter); (5) stimulate the exchange of ideas from local P.I. committees.

Projects in progress include the following:

- The committee has produced five new public-service TV spots, four 30 seconds long, the fifth one minute. We plan to release three late this spring and the remaining two at some later date, to keep our product fresh for broadcasters. One spot will have a Spanish sound track, as well as an English version; another, subtitles for the deaf. Comparable radio spots are being developed for late spring distribution.

- The committee has prepared a sample of a proposed flyer similar to "A.A. at a Glance," directed to young people ages ten to 18 and planned as a giveaway.

- A survey of the Fellowship, involving the United States and Canada, will be conducted again this year, with questionnaires to be distributed following approval by the Conference. These surveys have been conducted every three years since 1968. In 1977, we collected some 17,000 returns, from which we tabulated answers to basic questions about A.A., as well as valuable membership information.

Jerry Danzig, chairperson

Staff report: The new P.I. Workbooks were mailed to 375 P.I. committee chairpersons, free. P.I. committees, A.A. groups, contacts, and other interested A.A.'s have ordered additional copies. We have 460 P.I. contacts listed at G.S.O. Local committees' activities may be followed in the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, mailed three times a year.

We distributed over 100 TV spots (including some developed by Northern Florida) and close to 100 radio tapes to local committees. Their reports indicate that over 1,000,000 people were made aware of A.A. through committee members' talks in schools, churches, public meetings, and professional organizations. Over 250,000 copies of "A.A. at a Glance" were given to local P.I. committees, alcoholism agencies, and intergroup offices for information at non-A.A. meetings.

It takes three of us to cover P.I. work at G.S.O. In 1979, we answered close to 10,000 requests for information about A.A. from students, teachers, nurses, doctors, members of the clergy, family members, and the public media. We processed clippings of almost 5,000 newspaper stories about A.A. We wrote gratitude notes to newspaper people. We provided information about A.A. to many publications, such as *McCall's*, *International Scholastic Magazine*, and *Good Housekeeping*.

We wrote approximately 200 letters to delegates regarding anonymity breaks in their areas and, upon request from delegates, wrote to the members whose anonymity was broken. Several major breaks caused concern within the Fellowship.

We tabulated evaluation returns on the film "A.A.—An Inside View" monthly, and submitted a report to the Conference on these evaluations.

We cooperated with several major broadcast stations by taking producers, actors, and writers of radio and TV programs on alcoholism to local open A.A. meetings. We cooperated in a

school project with CBS by writing to over 50 P.I. committees about a TV show on a boy who drank too much.

Susan Daly

Staff coordinator

Staff activity links G.S.O. with local A.A.

Staff report: Eleven A.A.'s are G.S.O. staff members. Each has a specific assignment; some assignments are combined; and some involve responsibility for the preparation of special service bulletins. Work is apportioned as follows:

Conference	Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; <i>Final Conference Report</i> ; assistant, 1980 International Convention
Cooperation with the professional community	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation with the Professional Community; <i>About A.A.</i> ; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>
Correctional facilities	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; assistant, cooperation with the professional community and public information; <i>Institutions Bulletin</i> ; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>
Group correspondence	Secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees
Group services coordinator, A.A. Regional Forums	Co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; <i>Box 4-5-9</i>
Literature coordinator	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees
1980 International Convention	Co-secretary, trustees' International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee
Overseas, World Service Meeting, Spanish correspondence	Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, World Service Meeting; Spanish <i>Box 4-5-9</i>
Public information	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>
Staff coordinator	Assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Service Sharing Session; secretary, Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions; director, A.A.W.S.; <i>Quarterly Report</i>
Treatment facilities, Loners, Internationalists, LIMs	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; <i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i> ; <i>Institutions Bulletin</i>

During 1979, staff members answered over 20,000 letters individually. The staff coordinator makes sure mail is answered promptly without interruption during vacations, sickness, or absences, or when a staff member is involved with a special project. Most staff members also answer A.A. group mail from a specific region.

Invitations to A.A. conventions, assembly meetings, and get-togethers give the staff opportunities to meet A.A.'s all over the U.S. and Canada, to inform them about G.S.O. services, and most important, to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

In 1979, more than 1,320 visitors from all over the world came to visit G.S.O. and the Grapevine and tour all departments. These visits provide us with a wonderful chance to explain G.S.O.'s work and to learn about A.A. activities in the visitor's hometown or country.

The staff coordinator takes minutes of weekly staff meetings and circulates them to all concerned, including the general manager and all department heads. From time to time, as needed, a meeting is conducted by the group services coordinator. These meetings seek more and better ways of providing services to A.A. groups and members.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff vacations and scheduled trips, in order to assure that the office is covered at all times.

Phyllis Masback

Treatment Facilities

Year's work focuses on 'bridging the gap'

Trustees' committee: We have discussed ways to assist A.A. members in bridging the gap from treatment facilities into A.A. groups in the community. Also discussed were problems in communication between A.A. members and hospital administrators, and ways this situation could be improved.

The paper "Bridging the Gap," written by John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, M.D., was submitted to a medical journal, and we recommended sending a letter incorporating its ideas to administrators of hospitals and treatment facilities.

It was the sense of the committee that methods to increase the distribution of Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field be a topic for the joint meeting with the Conference committee in April. We felt that the new pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers" (replacing "A.A. in Hospitals") would answer questions from A.A.'s carrying the message into treatment facilities, and that new Guidelines for this purpose would be unnecessary.

The scope of the committee was discussed. A staff report had included a recommendation that the treatment facilities assignment handle all treatment facility correspondence and activity; this would expand the scope of the committee's activity and make it more helpful in bridging the gap. The committee supported that recommendation and also recommended that the clarification of scope be shared with the Conference committee in April.

Ruth Hartshorn, chairperson

Staff report: As of March 1, there were 1,325 treatment facility groups (in the U.S. and Canada) listed at G.S.O. These are the groups listed in the treatment facilities directory, and are *not* open to A.A.'s in the community. The message is carried to these newcomers by institution committee members, treatment facility committee members, and other local A.A.'s. That figure does not include the many regular A.A. groups that simply use meeting space in treatment facilities and *are* open to A.A.'s in the community.

The increase in groups over 1979 indicates that more alcoholics are being referred to A.A. from treatment facilities. Correspondence from groups meeting there fills the "in" box of this assignment. Questions most often asked include: How does an A.A. group stay within Traditions when meeting in a treatment facility? How do other A.A. groups meeting in such facilities set up sponsorship programs to help bridge the gap? How do A.A. group members coordinate their efforts with local and state hospital and institution or treatment facility committees?

Phone calls and letters indicated confusion in regard to the wording of the Treatment Center Group Information card. A new sheet is being developed to include more detailed information on the types of A.A. meetings held in the facility.

Because of correspondence that overlapped with the C.P.C. assignment, the treatment facilities assignment now receives all material dealing with treatment facility matters, whether from facility administrators or from local A.A.'s.

The flyer "Where Do I Go From Here?" continues to be in great demand. It tells a patient leaving a facility that A.A. on the "outside" is ready and willing to help. Available in amounts up to 500 at no charge, it provides a space for local A.A. contact information.

G.S.O. provides the following services to carry the message to those in treatment facilities:

- 1 Correspondence with the staff member on this assignment.
- 2 New groups— (a) adds new groups in treatment facilities to the mailing list; (b) sends Group Handbook and complimentary literature.
- 3 Directory—provides directory of *A.A. Groups in Treatment Facilities*, with updated issues when published.
- 4 Bulletins—each group in a treatment facility receives copies of *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly.
- 5 Literature—a discount package of A.A. literature is available to institutions committees and to groups in treatment facilities when ordered through the committee or the group.
- 6 Guidelines for Institutions Committees, which include suggestions for carrying the message into treatment facilities.
- 7 The filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service" and the 16mm films "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View," "Bill's Own Story," and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" are available on loan to A.A. groups in treatment facilities.
- 8 Experience is shared through correspondence and literature with local committees and A.A. groups in treatment facilities.

Lyla Bonney

Reports From the A.A. Grapevine

Circulation keeps rising; costs go up, too

Directors' report: The Grapevine has experienced another year of growth and problems stemming from growth. With the December 1979 issue, circulation reached 120,500—10.8% over 1978. At the current rate of increase, it is expected that circulation will be about 125,000 by Conference time — a 25% increase in two and a quarter years.

Miscellaneous-items sales reached an all-time high of \$122,000 in 1979, 29% over 1978 and 59% over 1976 — the year before the Grapevine-representative program came into effect. Because of GvRs, there is more awareness of the other items available from the Grapevine.

New items introduced in 1979 were prepaid gift certificates and a fourth printing of the book "AA Today." Both items were well received; gift certificate sales to date are \$6,000; "AA Today," \$21,000. Christmas gift subscriptions numbered over 4,000.

All the foregoing developments created a need for extra personnel and new procedures in the Accounting and Circulation Departments. This expense, not anticipated in the budget, was necessary to accommodate the increased work load.

Income from miscellaneous items formerly offset rising costs involved in printing and mailing the magazine; but inflation has had a drastic effect on paper costs and postage during the last few years. Even with climbing circulation and tremendous

increase in other sales, the Grapevine showed an operating loss of \$38,860 during 1979. So it has become necessary to increase subscription costs effective with the July 1980 issue, as follows: U.S. and Canada — one year, \$6, two years, \$10; other countries — one year, \$6.50, two years, \$11. (All subscriptions received by June 1, 1980, will be processed at the current rate.)

Because so many members have requested copies of the memorial issues of our co-founders, the Grapevine board approved reprinting these two issues. They will be offered as a packet for \$2. A gift of this packet will be given with all subscriptions sold at the International Convention in July. Another new item, a pocket planner calendar, companion piece to our wall calendar, will be offered this year, with the price set at \$2.

Edward Small, chairperson

Staff report: Good communications are vital in our recovery, beginning with that initial Twelfth Step call. The Grapevine, as a means of communication, represents the sober thinking and experience of A.A.'s around the world, from Loners to active oldtimers in big-city groups. The past year was the Grapevine's 36th, and an exciting one.

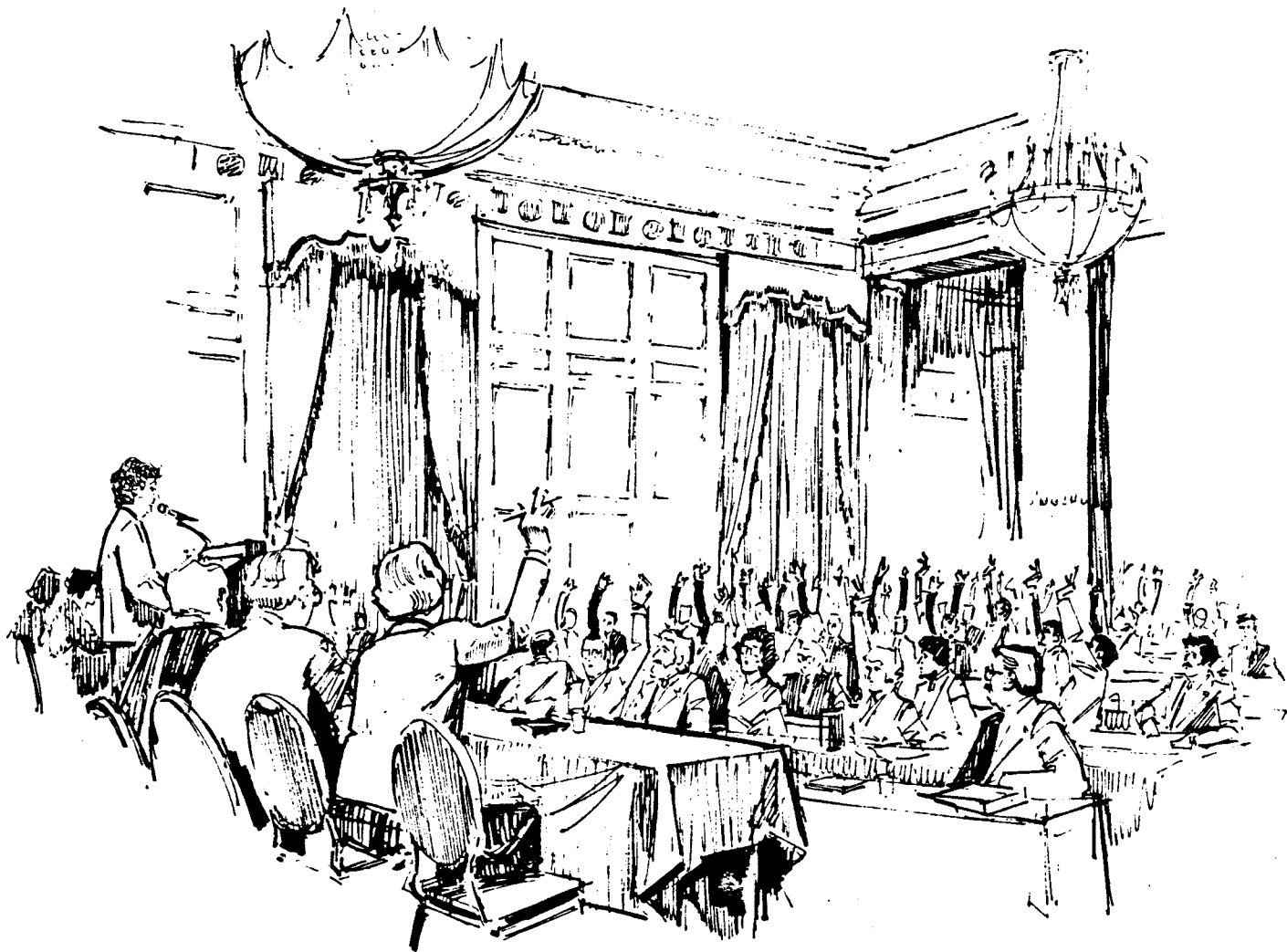
We try to cover as much territory as possible: articles on the Steps and Traditions; articles by and for newcomers; articles by prisoners, teenagers, and housewives, about going fishing sober, going broke, and going to meetings, about having a spiritual awakening while mowing the lawn, and about writing

a 90-page gratitude list. We've covered service work from coffee-maker to G.S.R., and the spiritual life from many angles.

Grapevine staff members and/or trustees serving on the Grapevine Corporate Board attended 11 area functions in 1979. In every instance, because of the love expressed for the maga-

zine—and in some isolated places, the dependence on it—we have been reminded of the tremendous responsibility we have to our Fellowship to do the best job we can, to have the very best issue possible, month after month.

Retha Gresham, managing editor



Participation by Members and Groups Opens the Way to Conference Actions

The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory (to the board) Actions, which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. In addition to the actions introduced on the floor before the whole Conference, others were based upon the reports of the Literature Task Force and the Conference committees. (Members and officers of the 1980 committees are listed on p. 56.)

Floor Actions

1 It was recommended that, since neither the Panel 29 delegate from Northeastern Quebec (Area 89) nor his alternate is able to attend this 30th Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference, the Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions recommends to this Conference that the area chairperson, Gabriel La Pointe, be allowed to be seated.

2 The pictures of Bill W. and Dr. Bob remain in the film "A.A.—An Inside View."

- 3 The World Service Meeting report be approved as read.
- 4 The archives filmstrip, "Markings on the Journey," be Conference-approved.
- 5 The 1981 General Service Conference be held from April 26 through May 2, 1981.
- 6 When G.S.O. and Grapevine offices are expanded, the offices be modernized and the appearance of the reception area and office as a whole be vastly improved.

Floor Action 3: report p. 12

Literature Task Force

- 7 It was recommended that the following pamphlets, leaflets, and flyers be approved with their present content: "Where Do I Go From Here?"; "Your A.A. G.S.O."; "G.S.R."; "Self-Supporting? The 60-30-10 Plan"; "Inside A.A."; "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls"; "Circles of Love and Service"; "A.A. in Your Community"; "A.A. at a Glance"; "The A.A. Member"; "If You Are a Professional."
- 8 Any factual or statistical information may be updated whenever practical without having to go through the process of Conference action, i.e., whenever inventory runs low, new survey completed, etc. In addition, minor copy cuts to make room for new material added to publications may be made when necessary.
- 9 Since A.A. Guidelines are a reflection of collective experience which is shared through G.S.O., relating to specialized topics not necessarily relevant to all groups or A.A. members generally (i.e., armed forces, clubs, answering services, occupational programs), the A.A. Guidelines may be produced or revised, when new information or other contingencies arise, at the discretion of the G.S.O. staff without Conference approval.
- 10 The Conference-approved seal may be positioned or placed wherever practical on a piece of literature so approved.

Literature Task Force report: p. 11
Presentations related to Advisory Actions 8, 9: p. 10

Agenda

- 11 It was recommended that the theme for the 1981 General Service Conference be built around "A.A. Takes Its Inventory—General Service Conference Structure."
- 12 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1981 Conference consist of five speakers—three delegates and two staff members (one G.S.O. and one GV)—and one leader. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting should be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.
- 13 The following presentation/discussion subjects be considered for the 1981 Conference: (a) "The Spiritual Meaning of Anonymity" (on opening day if feasible); (b) "Let's Examine Our Com-



mittee System"; (c) "Should Clubs Be Entitled to the A.A. Group Discount on Literature?"

- 14 At next year's Conference, we have two structured workshops, with one workshop topic to be "Let's Examine Our Committee System."
- 15 There be a "What's on Your Mind?" session or sharing session scheduled for the full Conference body, instead of a third workshop.

Report relating to Advisory Actions 13 (b), 14: p. 11
Workshop touching on Conference: p. 19

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- 16 It was recommended that, in keeping with our Eleventh and Twelfth Traditions, A.A. members who are requested to videotape talks and meetings preserve anonymity at the level of press, radio, film, and videotapes, realizing that anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. The committee further recommended that talks by A.A. members be given in person rather than videotaped, in view of the temptation for videotaping to place personalities before principles.
- 17 The pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate" be revised to include information in regard to the functions of area and local committees on cooperation with the professional community.
- 18 The recommendation of the 1976 General Service Conference in regard to A.A. members working in the field of alcoholism be reaffirmed. "That we, as A.A. members, give to A.A. members interested in working or volunteering in the alcoholism field the following suggestions: (a) Take advantage of the literature already in existence; (b) get adequate training; (c) have three to five years of good, stable sobriety; (d) get and keep a sponsor who does *not* work in the alcoholism field; (e) be thoroughly familiar with 'Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions'; (f) carefully consider whether or not you are suited to work in the field of alcoholism."
- 19 A renewed effort be made to inform A.A.'s working in the alcoholism field of our Twelve Traditions, and that they be thoroughly familiar with A.A. Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field.
- 20 A.A. continue to devote effort toward cooperation with the professional community. Recognizing that our Fellowship

is experiencing a rapid influx of new members, it was further recommended that A.A. groups remember their primary purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic by:

- a Providing greeters to welcome new members and visitors.
- b Emphasizing and accepting the responsibilities of sponsorship.
- c Taking group inventories periodically to determine if the group is fulfilling its primary purpose.

21 The pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous and the Medical Profession" be condensed and rewritten to reflect current information about A.A.

22 The topic "Is A.A. Devoting More Attention to Our Relationships Outside A.A. Than We Do to What Is Going On Inside A.A.?" be referred to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference for consideration as a workshop item at the 1981 General Service Conference.

Presentations related to cooperation with the professional community: p. 13. Workshops: pp. 15, 19

Correctional Facilities

23 It was recommended that, in helping the inmate "bridge the gap" between "inside" and "outside" A.A.:

- a Emphasis should be put on cooperation with the correctional facility administration and the judicial system.
- b More emphasis be put on prerelease sponsorship, utilizing *responsible* A.A. members and recovering ex-inmates where possible.

c The local institutions committees be used in referrals to A.A. groups.

24 A new pamphlet aimed at the dually addicted inmate not be considered at this time.

25 There is no need for a comic-strip-type pamphlet at this time.

26 The pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" be added to Institutions Discount Package Y.

Workshop touching on Advisory Action 23 (b): p. 19

Finance

27 It was recommended that the discontinuance of mailing contribution statements to Quebec, requested by Quebec delegates, be referred back to the 1981 Conference Committee on Finance for further study and consideration.

28 The Grapevine Corporate Board consider advising the Canadian subscribers that, when possible, U.S. funds should be used when purchasing a subscription.

Grapevine

29 It was recommended that shorter-term subscriptions for groups and treatment facilities not be considered at this time.

30 Delegates continue their efforts in using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.

31 Grapevine Conference Display Kits be made available to district GvRs at cost.

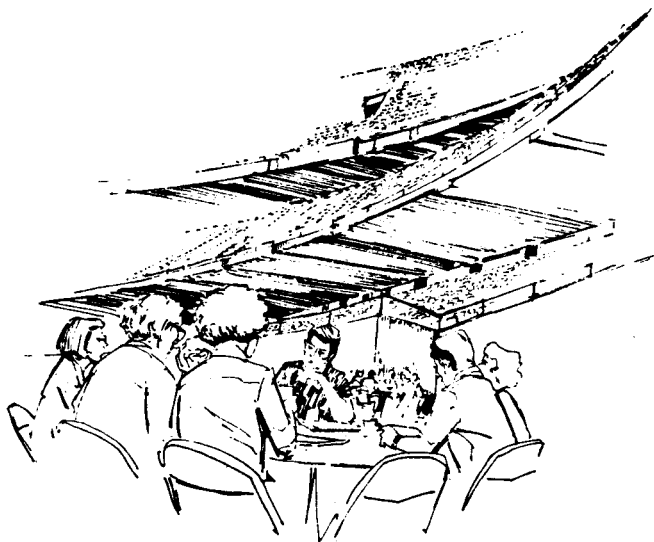
32 Groups make every effort to introduce newcomers to the Grapevine as one of our best tools in sobriety.

Workshop touching on the Grapevine: p. 19

1980 International Convention

33 It was recommended that simultaneous translations in French, Spanish, and German be provided at no charge for the Big Meeting on Friday night and the Spiritual Meeting on Sunday morning.

Convention reports: pp. 18, 37



Literature

34 It was recommended that the change in the title of the pamphlet for older people, from "Now It's Time to Start Living" to "Time to Start Living," be approved.

35 The unedited manuscript of "Dr. Bob and the Good Old-timers" be accepted.

36 The pamphlet from Great Britain entitled "A Newcomer Asks" be adopted and adapted.

37 The Responsibility Declaration not be changed.

38 The suggestion to add to the book "As Bill Sees It" a definition of the slogans not be accepted, because it was felt that the slogans may be defined in many different ways.

39 The suggestion of adding to the book "As Bill Sees It" a brief history not be accepted, since our history is contained in other literature.

40 The suggestion of adding to the book "As Bill Sees It" excerpts from the Grapevine and "The Best of Bill" not be accepted, since much of this material is already included.

41 The suggestion to produce a set of pamphlets on each Legacy not be accepted, since we have sufficient material at the present time.

The Conference agreed that A.A. has no need for a daily spiritual guidebook.

The following suggestions from the committee were rejected: that "As Bill Sees It" be redesigned in pocket-sized format and dated; and that, if additional pages are needed to complete the calendar year, excerpts from the Big Book—e.g., the promises (pages 83-84), "How It Works," "A Vision for You"—could be included.

Policy/Admissions

42 It was recommended that there be no changes in the 1981 Conference questionnaire.

43 The Conference reaffirm the importance of the committee system for accomplishing business charged to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference, as defined in Chapter 7 of our "A.A. Service Manual." The importance of clearly stated committee reports and recommendations was also stressed.

44 The Conference reaffirm the recommendation of the 1977 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, as follows: "In the interest of communication and cooperation, reports of trustees' committees on P.I., C.P.C., Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities be distributed to the delegate members of the corresponding Conference committees after each trustees' committee meeting."

Presentations related to Advisory Action 43: p. 10. Report: p. 11
Presentations related to Advisory Action 44: p. 13. Workshops: pp. 15, 19

Public Information

45 It was recommended that the film "A.A.—An Inside View" be released for general distribution.

46 When there is a television showing of "A.A.—An Inside View," the delegate be notified, if possible.

47 The 1980 A.A. membership survey be done.

48 TV spots #1, #3, #4, and #5 be accepted, and that spot #2 be sent back for revision, taking out some of the "lonely" words

and stressing more "drinking" words. The committee felt TV spots and radio spots should be made in both French and Spanish.

49 The trustees' P.I. Committee's explanation of why all spots should not be signed for the hearing-impaired be accepted (the reason being that some deal with telephone use). One TV spot has subtitles, and this is sufficient.

50 When updating the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings," pages 9 and 10 give short answers to questions instead of reference to another pamphlet.

51 "A.A. in Your Community" be discontinued, since this pamphlet is so much like "A Brief Guide" (and "A.A. at a Glance"). It was found to be unnecessary to have two pamphlets so much alike.

52 The trustees' P.I. Committee take excerpts from the current pamphlet "Too Young?" and make them into a flyer for teenagers. The committee particularly liked the 12 questions illustrated at the end. (The current proposed draft for such a flyer was rejected.)

53 There be a substantial reduction in the price of the pamphlet "Too Young?" to encourage a wider distribution of the current pamphlet.

Workshop touching on Advisory Actions 52, 53: p. 19



Report and Charter

54 It was recommended that no changes or amendments be made to the first 11 articles of the Conference Charter at this time.

55 A description of the alternate service worker be added to the "Glossary of Conference Language" (page 30 of "The A.A. Service Manual"), as follows: "Alternate—at group, district, or area level, assists, supports, and participates in service responsibilities where feasible, depending on local autonomy and local needs."

56 The role of the alternate G.S.R. (page 36 of "The A.A. Service Manual") be further described, as follows: "Alternates should be encouraged to assist, participate, and share in responsibilities of the G.S.R., attending district and area meetings where feasible, depending on local needs."

57 The role of the alternate committee member (page 39 of "The A.A. Service Manual") be further described, as follows:

"Alternate committee members should be encouraged to assist, participate, and share in the D.C.M.'s responsibilities, attending district and area meetings where feasible, depending on local needs."

58 Page 48 of "The A.A. Service Manual" include a paragraph regarding "Alternate Committee Officers," described as follows: "Some areas find it helpful to select alternates for all committee officers, the position of alternate chairperson being especially encouraged. The alternate committee officers may provide continuity at the area level and may or may not be seated as voting members, depending on local autonomy and area needs. Where feasible, alternates are encouraged to share and participate in committee activities as fully as possible. It is suggested that the qualifications of alternates closely resemble the qualifications for the positions they may be assuming."

59 Sentence 1, section 11 (page 55 in "The A.A. Service Manual"), describing the delegate's responsibilities, be revised to read: "They assume added responsibilities if the area committee chairperson and alternate chairperson are unable to serve."

60 The 1974 Conference action regarding directory listing of A.A. groups be reaffirmed ("All A.A. groups should be listed in the *World Directory* in accordance with the description of an A.A. group in the *World Directory*"), and further recommended that decisions regarding verification of "a true A.A. group" be resolved locally.

61 Adding names, addresses, and telephone numbers of district committee members to U.S. and Canadian directories is not feasible at this time.

Workshop touching on foregoing Advisory Actions: p. 19

Treatment Facilities

62 It was recommended that a modification in the scope of the Treatment Facilities Committee be made so that it will now read as follows:

"The purpose of the committee is to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics in treatment facilities.

"The committee will review all aspects of A.A. services to treatment facilities and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements in these A.A. services."

63 It is not appropriate to send a specific ("bridging the gap") letter to treatment facilities administrators at this time. However, G.S.O. is encouraged to forward copies of the newly published "A.A. in Treatment Centers" pamphlet to all facility administrators.

64 Although the directory of *A.A. Groups in Treatment Facilities* may be of value to a limited number of treatment facility administrators and A.A. members, its value to the A.A. community is questionable. It is, therefore, recommended that the Report and Charter Committee and G.S.O. review this matter, at their earliest convenience, for possible continued value.



65 The submitted modifications to the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers" were not significant enough to modify the pamphlet at this time.

66 No new action is required on ways to distribute the Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field.

Presentations related to treatment facilities: p. 13. Workshop: p. 15

Committee on Trustees

67 It was recommended that Donald F. Daly be elected as a Class B general service trustee (New York) at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board.

68 William E. Flynn, M.D., be elected as a Class A (non-alcoholic) trustee at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board.

69 The following persons be elected as trustees of the General Service Board for the period beginning April 1980 through April 1981 [see page 40; Conference and board approved the slate presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee, including the new Class A and general service trustees; among the regional trustee candidates, the Conference recommended the election of M. T. (Bud) Grondahl for West Central U.S. and Aime Dupont for Western Canada]; and that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see page 41; slate of officers also approved].

70 The speeches nominating trustee candidates be reduced from three minutes to two minutes at the Conference election session, with delegates giving verbal information not included in the written résumé.

71 Retired G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members should not be excluded from service on the General Service Board and/or the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards solely because of their past staff service.

72 Owners and operators of alcoholism facilities should not be excluded from service on the General Service Board solely because of their occupations; but it is desirable that the board and its Nominating Committee maintain the guardianship of A.A. on a nonprofessional basis.

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1979

	1979	1978
INCOME		
Net sales	\$3,262,844	\$2,696,888
Less: Cost of printing	(967,589)	(771,597)
Royalties	(383,850)	(315,852)
Gross profit from literature	1,911,405	1,609,439
Contributions – A.A. groups and members	1,239,557	1,081,347
Interest income	23,460	23,478
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>3,174,422</u>	<u>2,714,264</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	1,107,755	991,038
Pension expense	118,462	108,409
Rent	108,736	114,061
Box 4-S-9	58,497	48,177
A.A. directories	49,134	46,319
Other service printing	78,257	76,809
Shipping and mailing	308,070	249,661
Other office expenses	231,704	189,869
Insurance and payroll taxes	137,853	114,502
Professional services	26,802	25,300
Board, committee, and staff meetings	51,007	48,199
1978 World Service Meeting	3,373	31,829
Writers' fees	39,088	44,946
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	44,893	41,622
General Service Conference	93,512	93,315
E.D.P. system development	46,671	51,245
Regional Forums and other expenses	32,349	27,213
Film project	52,755	67,191
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>2,588,918</u>	<u>2,369,705</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u><u>585,504</u></u>	<u><u>344,559</u></u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 849,742	\$ 664,331
General Fund – General Service Board	(264,238)	(319,772)
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND		
Balance, January 1	\$2,179,126	\$1,756,418
Transfers from: A.A. World Services, Inc.	350,000	265,000
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	–	10,000
Investment income	163,401	147,708
Balance, December 31	<u><u>2,692,527</u></u>	<u><u>2,179,126</u></u>
() denotes red figures.		

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1979

Note A – Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was redefined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees, and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., are amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

(continued)

INCOME STATEMENT

Financial statements

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1979

	1979	1978
INCOME – from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$689,171</u>	<u>\$608,042</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$ 86,998	\$ 79,093
Printing	172,586	143,147
Mailing – service	52,089	42,476
– postage	47,497	34,496
Other printing costs	15,126	12,557
Calendar costs	23,804	21,892
Occupancy costs	9,923	10,384
Telephone	1,294	1,436
Office supplies and expenses	5,778	6,035
Other editorial expenses	<u>3,774</u>	<u>1,539</u>
<u>Total</u>	418,869	353,055
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	126,590	92,194
Data processing costs	36,311	29,200
Stationery and supplies	8,407	5,498
Occupancy costs	9,923	10,384
Telephone	1,294	1,436
Office expense	10,807	5,528
Selling expense – regular	25,681	21,177
– GvR program	4,783	4,439
Postage	<u>26,442</u>	<u>25,733</u>
<u>Total</u>	250,238	195,589
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	5,971	4,323
Insurance	8,392	6,879
Legal and accounting	16,700	7,300
Payroll taxes	15,519	11,592
Meetings and conferences	1,627	3,566
Furniture and equipment	1,923	2,018
Contribution to Retirement Plan	3,500	3,500
Canadian exchange	<u>5,471</u>	<u>4,093</u>
<u>Total</u>	<u>59,103</u>	<u>43,271</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>728,210</u>	<u>591,915</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	(39,039)	16,127
Interest earned	<u>39,039</u>	<u>–</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u><u>-0-</u></u>	<u><u>16,127</u></u>

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1979

	December 31, 1979		December 31, 1978	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash - checking accounts	\$ 215,891	\$ 96,608	\$ 123,477	\$ 133,368
Savings accounts and certificates	794,454	-	563,874	388,395
Investment (Note C)	-	462,502	-	388,395
Accounts receivable	54,755	3,027	26,907	2,326
Due from Grapevine	3,498	-	3,363	-
Inventories	631,649	10,559	578,665	3,949
Prepaid expenses	61,195	23,901	52,986	20,718
Total Assets	1,761,442	596,597	1,349,272	548,756
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	289,653	15,052	256,931	22,126
Due Reserve Fund	350,000	-	265,000	-
Deferred income	58,944	483,333	-	423,940
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	-	1,320	-	5,798
Total Liabilities	698,597	499,705	521,931	451,864
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	827,341	96,892	747,782	90,765
Net income (Exhibits A and B)	585,504	-	344,559	16,127
Transfer from (to) Reserve Fund	(350,000)	-	(265,000)	(10,000)
Total Net Worth	1,062,845	96,892	827,341	96,892
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,005,832		\$ 770,328	
General Fund - G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds - as above	1,062,845		827,341	
Reserve Fund	2,692,527		2,179,126	
Total Net Worth	3,755,372		3,006,467	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 500		\$ 500	
Savings accounts and certificates	93,120		189,170	
Due from A.A.W.S.	350,000		265,000	
Due from A.A. Grapevine	18,210		45,545	
U.S. Treasury obligations	2,227,617		1,883,643	
Government agency and corporate bonds	415,972		159,949	
Accrued interest	67,826		59,259	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(480,718)		(423,940)	
Balance, December 31, 1979	2,692,527		2,179,126	

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

Note B - After transfers of \$264,238 in 1979 and \$319,772 in 1978 from Publishing to General Fund.

Note C - Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund - \$480,718, less amounts pending transfer, \$18,216, resulting in a net investment of \$462,502 at December 31, 1979.

These financial statements and the foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1980 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. – PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$3,569,900. Taking the growth of the Fellowship into consideration, and allowing for a 6% sales discount effective February 1, 1980, we expect the net increase in sales over 1979 to be 9%. During 1980, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 356,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 178,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" – regular edition, 42,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" – pocket edition, 23,000 "A.A. Comes of Age," 44,600 "As Bill Sees It," 146,000 booklets, and more than 7,000,000 pamphlets and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$1,570,800, the cost of producing the literature and the royalties paid on book sales, the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$1,999,100. After adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$2,016,100.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$1,248,600. This takes into consideration increasing publishing activity and inflationary pressures and represents a 16% increase over 1979. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$767,500.

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

Income: Against the cost of servicing groups, contributions have been budgeted at \$1,349,500, an increase of 10% over 1979.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are paid out of contributions, are expected to be \$1,508,100. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, which totals \$106,900. Total service expenses are budgeted to be \$158,600 greater than contribution income. This deficit will be funded from the net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$287,600, less the interest earned on a day-of-deposit-to-day-of-withdrawal account. These expenses represent the cost of the quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community and the Public Information Committee, the cost of Regional Forums, and legal and auditing expenses, plus other special projects such as filmstrips and archival expenses and the estimated net expense of the 1980 International Convention. These expenses, totaling \$279,600, will also be funded out of the income from the publishing operation.

After budgeted deficits in the amount of \$438,200, the total net income for the General Service Office is anticipated to be \$329,300. After satisfying operating requirements, the balance of this net will be transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

1980 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Estimated income, from magazine and other sales, is budgeted at \$802,000. This represents an increase of \$112,900, or 16.3%, over 1979.

Total expenses: Editorial and printing costs are budgeted \$92,900 higher than 1979; circulation and business expense, \$21,700 higher; and general and administrative expenses, \$6,800 higher than 1979. All expenses totaled are expected to be \$849,400, an increase of 16.7%.

With the acceptance of a recommendation of a \$1.00 per year subscription price increase to be effective July 1, 1980, the projected deficit of \$47,400 is expected to be offset and a net income of \$9,600 realized.

1980 G.S.O. Budget

Financial statements

The budget for 1980 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. – PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$3,569,900*
Less: Cost of products and royalties	1,570,800
Gross profit from sales	1,999,100
Interest income	17,000
Total income	\$2,016,100

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	<u>767,500</u>
----------------------------	----------------

**Based on the sale of:*

356,000 books – "Alcoholics Anonymous"	
178,000 books – "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (reg.)	
42,000 books – "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (pocket)	
23,000 books – "A.A. Comes of Age"	
44,600 books – "As Bill Sees It"	
and	
Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items	

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$1,349,500
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TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	<u>1,508,100**</u>
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***Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$106,900*

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 8,000
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TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of income (expense)	<u>287,600***</u>
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****Board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, Regional Forums, World Service Meeting, etc.*

The publishing activity will contribute \$438,200 to offset the budgeted deficits.

1980 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$ 802,000
Total costs and expenses	849,400
Net loss from operations	<u>(47,400)</u>

Contributions

1979 Contributions From Groups—by Delegate Area

Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Total Group contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per capita	Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Total Group contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per capita
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	178	114	64.0%	\$ 7,227.15	2,363	\$3.06	63.	S.Dak.	121	58	47.9%	\$ 4,308.93	1,766	\$2.44
2.	Alsk.	76	35	46.1	2,788.00	877	3.18	64.	Tenn.	228	120	52.6	6,918.14	3,016	2.29
3.	Ariz.	294	156	53.1	11,964.34	4,213	2.84		Tex.						
4.	Ark.	130	86	66.2	4,027.85	1,835	2.20	65.	N.E.	174	105	60.3	14,913.96	5,173	2.88
5.	Calif.	739	405	54.8	37,276.94	27,705	1.35	66.	N.W.	132	68	51.5	4,642.45	2,640	1.76
6.	N. Coastal	792	554	69.9	46,975.47	18,168	2.59	67.	S.E.	172	84	48.8	11,067.14	5,215	2.12
7.	N. Int.	306	170	55.6	10,460.18	5,777	1.81	68.	S.W.	215	128	59.5	9,745.63	4,029	2.42
8.	San Diego	268	162	60.4	11,236.34	6,289	1.79	69.	Utah	111	72	64.9	4,516.87	1,406	3.21
9.	Mid-S.	623	388	62.3	32,943.44	15,693	2.10	70.	Vt.	76	43	56.6	2,464.56	855	2.88
10.	Colo.	296	177	59.8	15,979.98	4,576	3.49	71.	Va.	447	310	69.4	23,826.91	6,928	3.44
11.	Conn.	590	312	52.9	22,113.56	11,145	1.98	72.	Wash.	526	298	56.7	25,120.30	7,658	3.28
12.	Del.	75	58	77.3	4,187.87	1,144	3.66	73.	W.Va.	108	82	75.9	5,188.22	1,084	4.79
13.	D.C.	200	133	66.5	15,730.45	5,866	2.68		Wis.						
14.	N.	215	134	62.3	10,147.00	6,778	1.50	74.	N.Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	310	189	61.0	13,252.21	4,488	2.95
15.	S.	559	338	60.5	34,365.58	9,083	3.78	75.	S.	353	186	52.7	11,158.24	4,536	2.46
16.	Ga.	324	245	75.6	17,739.10	5,297	3.35	76.	Wyo.	62	34	54.8	1,913.58	744	2.57
17.	Haw.	106	54	50.9	2,534.68	1,770	1.43	77.	P.R.	89	63	70.8	3,611.00	1,313	2.75
18.	Idaho	76	65	85.5	3,374.82	849	3.98	78.	Alta./N.W.T.	301	164	54.5	11,954.68	3,675	3.25
19.	Chicago	491	254	51.7	15,686.69	10,956	1.43	79.	B.C./Yukon	469	234	49.9	18,472.00	6,077	3.04
20.	N.	533	301	56.5	19,010.01	8,082	2.35	80.	Man.	131	75	57.3	5,406.03	2,809	1.92
21.	S.	189	104	55.0	5,589.36	2,799	2.00	81.	N.B./P.E.I.	156	94	60.3	5,578.32	1,999	2.79
22.	N.	262	145	55.3	10,189.56	3,489	2.92	82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab. Ont.	172	101	58.7	4,882.89	1,775	2.75
23.	S.	184	122	66.3	10,147.04	2,919	3.48	83.	E.	388	165	42.5	15,999.16	8,054	1.99
24.	Iowa	268	153	57.1	10,979.65	4,679	2.35	84.	N.E.	128	39	30.5	2,552.55	1,623	1.57
25.	Kans.	213	135	63.4	8,340.10	3,923	2.13	85.	N.W.	62	25	40.3	2,587.69	1,023	2.53
26.	Ky.	233	128	54.9	18,209.25	3,171	5.74	86.	W.	342	168	49.1	22,854.22	4,719	4.84
27.	La.	199	125	62.8	8,456.91	2,917	2.90		Que.						
28.	Me.	153	94	61.4	4,500.01	1,877	2.40	87.	S.W.	393	393	100.0	8,034.24	10,457	.77
29.	Md.	386	235	60.9	16,376.41	4,732	3.46	88.	S.E.	156	156	100.0	4,203.49	2,563	1.64
30.	Mass.	615	314	51.1	28,709.95	15,079	1.90	89.	N.E.	220	36	16.4	1,398.03	4,732	.30
31.	E.	94	52	55.3	3,540.55	1,891	1.87	90.	N.W.	207	207	100.0	18,654.99	4,092	4.56
32.	Cent.	222	150	67.6	17,491.13	4,360	4.01	91.	Sask.	256	165	64.5	9,017.44	3,333	2.71
33.	S.E.	237	144	60.8	13,183.68	5,647	2.33		Total U.S./Canada	23,696	14,032	59.2% ²	\$1,085,137.81	444,193	\$2.44 ²
34.	W.	166	94	56.6	8,773.13	3,120	2.81		C.Z.	3	-0-	-0-	150.00	97	1.55
35.	N.	291	161	55.3	9,118.36	4,635	1.97		Bahamas	5	-0-	-0-	240.00	162	1.48
36.	S.	532	310	58.3	30,307.16	17,087	1.77		V.I. of U.S.	4	2	50.0	240.00	95	2.53
37.	Miss.	104	67	64.4	3,473.29	1,316	2.64			23,708	14,034	59.2% ²	\$1,085,767.81 ¹	444,547	\$2.44 ²
38.	E.	241	152	63.1	8,657.36	2,793	3.10		Individual, anniversary & in-memoriam				37,331.05		
39.	W.	125	74	59.2	6,341.86	2,256	2.81		Specials				100,982.66		
40.	Mont.	134	81	60.4	4,126.30	1,444	2.86		Total for U.S. & Canada				\$1,224,081.52		
41.	Nebr.	269	173	64.3	14,099.61	4,255	3.31		FOREIGN AND OTHER						
42.	Nev.	92	69	75.0	3,480.85	1,049	3.32		Foreign				6,371.25		
43.	N.H.	144	83	57.6	5,553.11	2,325	2.39		Birds of a Feather				627.00		
44.	N.J.	484	270	55.8	21,954.59	8,910	2.46		Correctional facility groups				380.00		
45.	S.	149	107	71.8	11,083.10	1,984	5.59		International Doctors in A.A.				350.00		
46.	N.M.	117	73	62.4	4,445.70	1,455	3.06		International Lawyers in A.A.				531.05		
47.	Cent.	247	116	47.0	8,717.56	3,277	2.66		Internationalists				738.67		
48.	H./M./B.	216	112	51.9	6,997.76	2,652	2.64		Internationalists groups				10.00		
49.	S.E.	840	440	52.4	47,124.17	24,679	1.91		Treatment facility groups				6,644.62		
50.	W.	127	67	52.8	4,534.07	1,729	2.62		World Hello				150.00		
51.	N.C.	360	255	70.8	18,724.59	5,227	3.58		Grand Total				\$1,239,884.11		
52.	N.Dak.	119	75	63.0	5,294.70	1,607	3.29								
53.	Ohio	188	87	46.3	6,506.25	2,618	2.49								
54.	Cent. & S.E.	431	154	35.7	8,451.01	10,468	.81								
55.	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	121	80	66.1	5,601.86	1,643	3.41								
56.	S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.	164	90	54.9	6,576.94	2,399	2.74								
57.	Okla.	197	162	82.2	12,758.02	2,367	5.39								
58.	Oreg.	229	138	60.3	8,508.29	2,922	2.91								
59.	E.	451	293	65.0	30,118.66	8,687	3.47								
60.	W.	301	183	60.8	14,790.31	4,401	3.36								
61.	R.I.	106	64	60.4	6,958.72	1,530	4.55								
62.	S.C.	120	98	81.7	6,333.56	1,627	3.89								

COMPARISON - 1979-1978

	# Gps. re-ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per capita
U.S. & Canada 1979	23,708	14,034 ²	59.2% ²	\$1,085,767.81	444,547	\$2.44 ²
U.S. & Canada 1978	22,083	12,328	55.8	915,823.15	409,984	2.23
Increase (Decrease)	1,625	1,706	3.4%	\$ 169,944.66	34,563	\$.21

1. Group contributions reported on this schedule represent only those received directly from individual groups within Conference areas and do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and anniversary.

2. Reflects contributions from Conference areas 87, 88, and 90 at 100%.

U.S.	#Gps. re- ported	#Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alabama	141	90	63.8%	\$ 6,093.21	1,974	\$3.08
Alaska	76	35	46.0	3,372.00	877	3.84
Arizona	291	157	53.9	13,468.52	4,193	3.21
Arkansas	130	86	66.1	4,653.85	1,835	2.53
California	2,759	1,660	60.1	153,265.05	74,327	2.06
Colorado	302	177	58.6	18,726.15	4,644	4.03
Connecticut	589	312	52.9	27,252.81	11,185	2.43
Delaware	75	58	77.3	4,222.68	1,144	3.69
District of Columbia	83	60	72.2	6,553.66	2,603	2.51
Florida	813	494	60.7	61,792.79	16,333	3.78
Georgia	324	246	75.9	18,513.10	5,297	3.49
Hawaii	106	54	50.9	3,176.66	1,770	1.79
Idaho	101	76	75.2	4,433.73	1,162	3.81
Illinois	1,213	655	53.9	43,605.06	21,844	1.99
Indiana	446	267	59.8	23,176.68	6,516	3.55
Iowa	268	153	57.0	12,181.96	4,679	2.60
Kansas	213	135	63.3	10,856.10	3,923	2.76
Kentucky	229	127	55.4	21,339.74	3,132	6.81
Louisiana	200	126	63.0	8,540.56	2,926	2.91
Maine	143	90	62.9	5,288.54	1,781	2.96
Maryland	498	312	62.6	27,913.31	7,883	3.54
Massachusetts	726	357	49.1	34,478.24	17,286	1.99
Michigan	736	443	60.1	49,883.69	14,455	3.45
Minnesota	824	473	57.4	52,063.10	21,712	2.39
Mississippi	104	67	64.4	3,554.29	1,316	2.70
Missouri	365	227	62.1	15,669.50	5,015	3.12
Montana	135	82	60.7	5,219.95	1,455	3.58
Nebraska	268	174	64.9	14,203.76	4,245	3.34
Nevada	84	63	75.0	4,497.10	960	4.68
New Hampshire	143	82	57.3	5,877.28	2,310	2.54
New Jersey	631	376	59.5	35,924.02	10,834	3.31
New Mexico	119	76	63.8	4,595.35	1,472	3.12
New York	1,446	734	50.7	69,527.02	31,783	2.18
North Carolina	360	255	70.8	18,876.59	5,227	3.61
North Dakota	119	75	63.0	10,136.33	1,618	6.26
Ohio	884	403	45.5	27,386.86	16,866	1.62
Oklahoma	198	162	81.8	13,587.17	2,372	5.72
Oregon	230	138	60.0	9,059.54	2,932	3.08
Pennsylvania	752	487	64.7	47,968.46	13,250	3.62
Rhode Island	102	67	65.6	7,591.09	1,468	5.17
South Carolina	120	98	81.6	6,746.56	1,627	4.14
South Dakota	120	58	48.3	5,000.23	1,754	2.85
Tennessee	230	120	52.1	7,602.57	3,075	2.47
Texas	693	382	55.1	48,176.11	16,888	2.85
Utah	111	72	64.8	4,608.71	1,414	3.25
Vermont	75	44	60.2	2,706.89	837	3.23
Virginia	451	316	70.0	24,889.06	7,013	3.54
Washington	492	290	58.9	28,569.13	7,232	3.95
West Virginia	104	82	78.8	6,028.65	1,047	5.75
Wisconsin	571	330	57.7	21,676.28	7,942	2.72
Wyoming	64	34	53.1	2,223.59	772	2.88
Commonwealth of P.R.	90	63	70.0	3,791.00	1,316	2.88
Canal Zone	3	1	33.3	150.00	97	1.54
Bahama Islands	5	2	40.0	240.00	162	1.48
Virgin Islands of U.S.	4	3	75.0	240.00	95	2.52
TOTAL for U.S.	20,359	12,006	58.9%	\$1,071,174.28	387,875	\$2.76

CANADA	#Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alberta	284	157	55.2%	\$ 12,088.38	3,498	\$3.45
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	115	69	60.0	4,289.98	1,350	3.17
Nfld. & Lab.	55	27	49.0	1,360.87	518	2.62
Nova Scotia	119	74	62.1	3,997.18	1,295	3.08
Prince Edward Island	45	28	62.2	1,631.35	730	2.23
British Columbia	473	241	50.9	22,782.05	6,234	3.65
Manitoba	130	76	58.4	6,252.12	2,798	2.23
N.W. Territories	11	5	45.4	248.62	111	2.23
Ontario	887	394	44.4	52,415.99	15,043	3.48
Quebec	969	225	23.2	37,347.19	21,686	1.72
Saskatchewan	256	165	64.4	10,493.51	3,333	3.14
Yukon Territory	5	—0—	—0—	—0—	76	—0—
TOTAL for CANADA	3,349	1,461	43.6%	\$ 152,907.24	56,672	\$2.69
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	23,708	13,467	56.8%	\$1,224,081.52	444,547	\$2.73

FOREIGN AND OTHER

Foreign	6,371.25
Birds of a Feather	627.00
Correctional facility groups	380.00
International Doctors in A.A.	350.00
International Lawyers in A.A.	531.05
Internationalists	738.67
Internationalists groups	10.00
Treatment facility groups	6,644.62
World Hello	150.00
GRAND TOTAL	\$1,239,884.11

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1979-1978

	#Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
U.S. 1979	20,359	12,006	58.9%	\$1,071,174.28	387,875	\$2.76
U.S. 1978	18,926	10,842	57.3	912,462.53	356,383	2.56
Increase (Decrease)	1,433	1,164	1.6%	\$ 158,711.75	31,492	\$.20
Canada 1979	3,349	1,461	43.6%	\$ 152,907.24	56,672	\$2.69
Canada 1978	3,157	1,486	47.1	151,579.42	53,601	2.82
Increase (Decrease)	192	(25)	(3.5%)	\$ 1,327.82	3,071	(\$.13)
U.S. and Canada 1979	23,708	13,467	56.8%	\$1,224,081.52	444,547	\$2.73
U.S. and Canada 1978	22,083	12,328	55.8	1,064,041.95	409,984	2.59
Increase (Decrease)	1,625	1,139	1.0%	\$ 160,039.57	34,563	\$.14

1980 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Lucetta De Young, S. Calif.
 *Ken Himes, Cent. Mich.
 Louis Ladouceur, N.E. Que.
 **Terry Leach, N.E. Ohio

Jack Braybrook, Alta./N.W.T.
 Jack Denby, Oreg.
 Jackie Jones, Ky.
 Jim Nutting, N.H.

Secretary: Sarah Price

Finance

**Frank Buffo, Utah
 *Jack Ford, B.C./Yukon
 Leo Kelly, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
 Ken Winegarner, S.E. Mich.

Joanne McCartin, W. N.Y.
 Joe Phelan, Ga.
 Ralph Richards, S. Ind.
 Larry Trager, Kans.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Literature

*Dan Byrne, Iowa
 Bill Geer, La.
 Wilf O'Grady, E. Ont.
 **Elma Stone, E. Mo.

Frank Anderson, Me.
 Bill Carroll, Miss.
 Ern Manzano, W. Mich.
 Gerry McAvoy, N.W. Ohio/
 S.E. Mich.
 Pat Walters, Man.

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Public Information

Bob Bisanz, S. Minn.
 Al Farley, W.Va.
 *Terry Schemel, Wash.
 **Herb Weatherwax, Haw.

Deborah Harrington, Del.
 Les Leuthaeuser, Nebr.
 Gerard Page, W. Mass.
 Lorin Pigg, N.W. Tex.

Secretary: Susan Daly

Conference Report and Charter

Mickey Boynton, Ala./N.W. Fla.
 **Hal Halm, N. N.J.
 *Ruth Jagodzinski, Nev.
 George Van Dyke, W. Mo.

Raymond Coutellier, N.W. Que.
 Raul Marin, S.W. Tex.
 Sunny Nisewaner, Md.
 Roger Stevens, S.C.

Secretary: Vincina McCarthy

Grapevine

Laurent Biron, S.E. Que.
 Jim Cooney, D.C.
 Louise Holsten, N. Ind.
 *Lou Mobley, N. Fla.
 **Chuck Roberts, Va.

Pat Enright, Idaho
 Bruce Irwin, N.M.
 Nancy McComas, S. N.J.
 Murph Outhwaite, W. Ont.

Secretary: Retha Gresham

Conference Policy/Admissions

John Callaghan, Conn.
 Hershell Hood, S. Ill.
 *Jo Kugel, S.E. N.Y.
 **Ian McKenzie, W. Pa.

Marjorie Farber, Alsk.
 Dick Hahn, N. Wis./Upper
 Pen. Mich.
 Don Mellem, N. Minn.
 Perry Rodreick, Mont.

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Treatment Facilities

LeRoy Belt, Okla.
 *Dave Buckley, Colo.
 **Anna Diggs, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
 Al Hurley, N.W. Ont.

Naydene Barnes, N. Int. Calif.
 Charles Ealy, Tenn.
 Fred Marchand, N.Dak.
 Felix Martinez, P.R.

Secretary: Lyla Bonney

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Neil Dobbins, N.C.
 Hank Coleman, N.E. Tex.
 **Chico Cortez, S. Fla.
 *Lois Jacobson, N. Coastal Calif.

Douglas Beck, S.Dak.
 Denis Longtin, S.W. Que.
 Irv Poissant, Ariz.
 John Salesses, R.I.

Secretary: Lois Fisher



Correctional Facilities

Tom Devereux, Chicago
 *Tina Martin, N.E. Ont.
 Ambrose Mohan, E. Pa.
 **Wayne Parks, Ark.

Bob Adams, Hudson/Mohawk/
 Berkshire
 Carl Budd, Wyo.
 Bob Campbell, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
 Denver Colvin, Mid-S. Calif.

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons

Committee

Conference Agenda
 Conference Report and Charter
 Cooperation with the Professional
 Community
 Correctional Facilities

Finance
 Grapevine
 Literature

Conference Policy/Admissions
 Public Information
 Treatment Facilities
 Committee on Trustees

Chairperson

Jack Braybrook, Alta./N.W.T.
 Raul Marin, S.W. Tex.

Irv Poissant, Ariz.
 Bob Campbell, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.

Joe Phelan, Ga.
 Pat Enright, Idaho
 Pat Walters, Man.

Dick Hahn, N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.
 Deborah Harrington, Del.
 Fred Marchand, N.Dak.
 Ken Fraser, N.B./P.E.I.

Alternate

Jack Denby, Oreg.
 Sunny Nisewaner, Md.

Denis Longtin, S.W. Que.
 Bob Adams, Hudson/Mohawk/
 Berkshire
 Ralph Richards, S. Ind.
 Bruce Irwin, N.M.
 Gerry McAvoy, N.W. Ohio/
 S.E. Mich.

Perry Rodreick, Mont.
 Gerard Page, W. Mass.
 Naydene Barnes, N. Int. Calif.
 Betty Daniels, Vt.

Committee on the 1980 International Convention

Judd Black, Cent. N.Y.
 *Bill Geer, La.
 Al Hurley, N.W. Ont.
 Lois Jacobson, N. Coastal Calif.

Terry Leach, N.E. Ohio
 Carl Budd, Wyo.
 Bruce Irwin, N.M.

Tom McDonald, Sask.
 Irv Poissant, Ariz.

Secretary: Betty Liddle

*Chairperson
 **Alternate chairperson

1980 Trustees' Committees

Rosters

Archives

Fernand Ippersiel, *chairperson*
John D. Bealer, M.D.
Cecil E. Corrigan
Virginia C. Hallman
Mary Phelps
John Ryall
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Nell Wing, *archivist*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

George E. Dorsey, *chairperson*
John Bragg
Donald F. Daly
Jerry A. Danzig
Richard J. Driscoll
Don Nicolson
Samuel E. Smith
Sarah Price, *secretary*

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Gordon M. Patrick, *chairperson*
John D. Bealer, M.D.
John Bragg
Stan N. Cameron
Jeanne Conway
Richard J. Driscoll
Martin Le Boutillier
Hal Marley
John Williams
Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.
Barry Leach, *consultant*
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

W. J. Estelle Jr., *chairperson*
Cecil E. Corrigan
Timothy Danaher
Lucas Gonzalez
Virginia C. Hallman
Ray Leary
William McDuffie
Ray O'Keefe
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Frank Smeal, *chairperson*
John D. Bealer, M.D.
John Bragg
George E. Dorsey
Martin Le Boutillier
Edward J. Small
Michael Alexander
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Robert G. Pearson, *secretary*
Dennis I. Manders, *assistant secretary*

Finance

Frank Smeal, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
John D. Bealer, M.D.
Stan N. Cameron
Donald F. Daly
George E. Dorsey
Martin Le Boutillier
Don Nicolson
John Ryall
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Dennis I. Manders, *secretary*

General Service Sharing Session

Membership includes all trustees
(see following pages)
Don Nicolson, *chairperson*
John L. Norris, M.D.
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

International

Virginia C. Hallman, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
Stan N. Cameron
Louis Kraus
Ann Macfarlane
Hal Marley
John L. Norris, M.D.
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Cecil E. Corrigan, *chairperson*
LaVelle Clifford
Jeanne Conway
Jerry Danzig
Ruth K. Hartshorn
Louis Kraus
Samuel E. Smith
Betty Liddle, *co-secretary*
Lavinia McCarthy, *co-secretary*

Literature

Samuel E. Smith, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
LaVelle Clifford
Fernand Ippersiel
Jack Morley
Gordon M. Patrick
Mary Phelps
Jacquelyn Solomon
Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.
Janet Graves, *consultant*
Barry Leach, *consultant*
Mary Anne O'Dea, *consultant*
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Nominating

Edward J. Small, *chairperson*
LaVelle Clifford
George E. Dorsey
Richard J. Driscoll
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Fernand Ippersiel
Don Nicolson
John Ryall
Jacquelyn Solomon
June Russell, *secretary*

Public Information

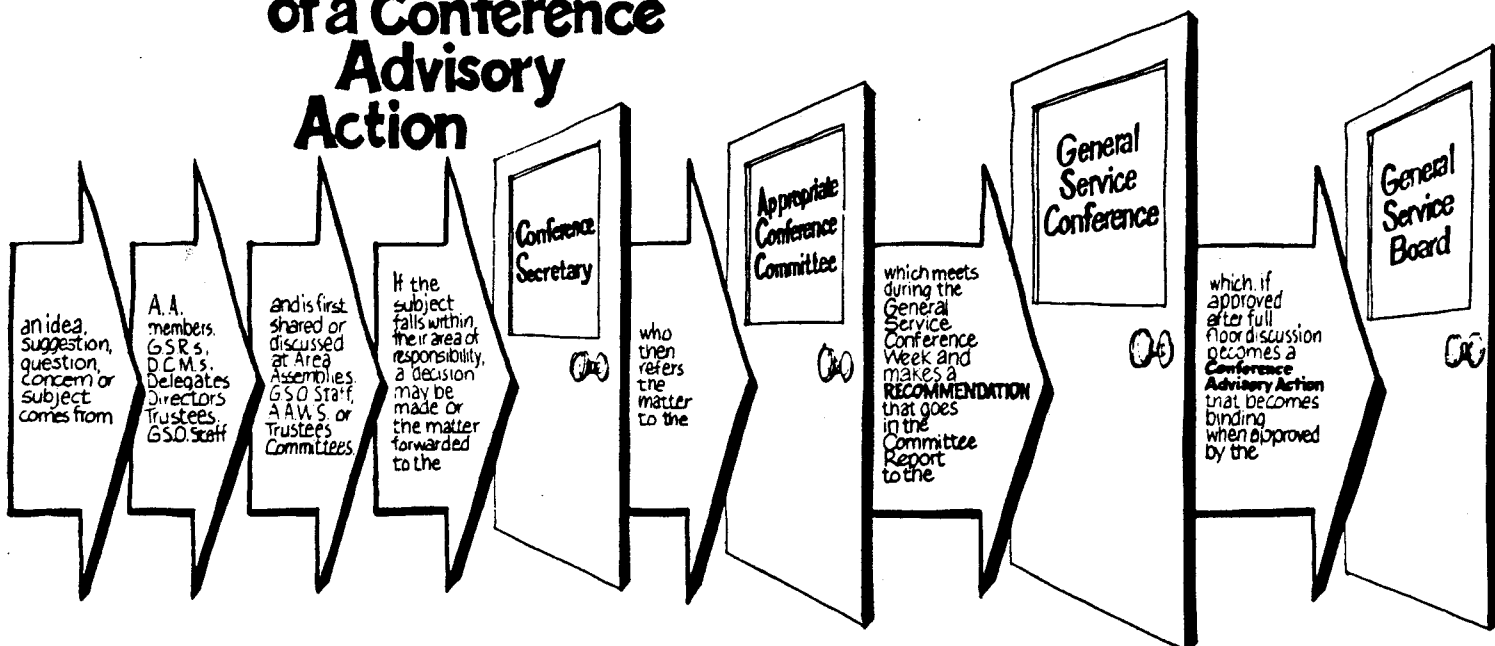
Jerry Danzig, *chairperson*
William H. Croke
Denison Demac
William Dowling
Robert Gulian
Ruth Hartshorn
Phil Parker
Edward J. Small
John Bragg, *consultant*
Charles H. Hanson, *consultant*
Mary Anne O'Dea, *consultant*
Susan Daly, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Ruth K. Hartshorn, *chairperson*
Jeanne Conway
Hal Harmon
Frank Herzlin, M.D.
Henry Hudson
Gordon M. Patrick
Robert Pope
Emily Rayford
Edward J. Small
Robert Stuckey, M.D.
John Williams
Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.
Lyla Bonney, *secretary*

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., and Robert G. Pearson are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for Committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence the Committees' importance has grown even more."
...from the A.A. Service Manual, p. 72.

1980 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (25 Bacchus Ct., 3300 Carpenter Rd. S.E., Olympia, WA 98503), was elected to the board in April 1971 and became its chairperson in 1978. Before his retirement in 1975, he was professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. For 18 years prior to that, he was on the faculty of Washington State University, Pullman. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics, and A.A.

Michael Alexander (150 E. 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal adviser to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith — so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director of the British American Chamber of Commerce, a trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society, and a director of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. He is a member of the Finance, Literature, and International Committees and nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

¹**John D. Bealer, M.D.** (3639 Emerson Cir., Bethlehem, PA 18017), elected to the board in April 1971, is corporate medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corp. He is a member of the American Medical Society on Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. Dr. John serves on the Committees on Finance, Employee Retirement, Archives, and Cooperation with the Professional Community.

W. J. Estelle Jr. (director, Texas Department of Corrections, Box 99, Huntsville, TX 77340) was named a trustee in April 1977. He was born in Indiana and educated in California, where he began his career in corrections in 1952. He then spent two years as warden of Montana State Prison. Jim has taught courses in corrections in two California colleges and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice, correction, and services to children and youth. He is chairperson of the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the Nominating Committee.

²**William E. Flynn, M.D.** (1164 Old Gate Ct., McLean, VA 22101), joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he was certified in psychiatry by the American Board of Psychiatry and Neurology. Currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse, he also serves as a consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and to the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital, in Virginia.

Gordon M. Patrick (Box 100, Lyndhurst, Ont. K0E 1N0, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, is president of Gordon Patrick Associates, a firm of consultants specializing in occupational alcoholism. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he is a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism. Gordon is chairperson of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community and also serves on the Literature and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Frank Smeal (Goldman Sachs & Co., 55 Broad St., New York,

NY 10004) began service as treasurer of the General Service Board in April 1979. He is partner and member of the management committee of an investment banking firm, after 30 years with Morgan Guaranty Trust Company, New York. He has degrees from Pennsylvania State University, the Harvard Graduate School of Business Administration, and New York University Law School. Frank is a trustee and member of the executive committee of the Citizens' Budget Commission and chairperson of the Government and Federal Agencies Securities Committee of the Public Securities Association. He chairs the Employee Retirement and Finance Committees.

Kenneth H. Williams, M.D. (104 Glen Haven La., Pittsburgh, PA 15238), joined our board in 1979. He teaches psychiatry and internal medicine at the University of Pittsburgh School of Medicine, and previously taught at the Yale University School of Medicine. He is consultant physician to the Governor's Council on Drug and Alcohol Abuse (Pennsylvania) and to a residential detoxification program for alcoholics. Ken is a member of the Committees on Cooperation with the Professional Community, Literature, and Treatment Facilities.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

Stan N. Cameron (P.O. Box 1201, Saskatoon, Sask. S7M 2X4, Canada) became Canadian trustee-at-large in 1979. He was a Panel 26 delegate after service as a G.S.R., intergroup representative, and roundup and public information chairperson. Stan helped set up two A.A. central offices. He is chairperson of a halfway house and member of an occupational alcoholism association. He has had governmental and union experience, and is now president of an industrial-relations consulting firm. He serves on the Cooperation with the Professional Community, Finance, and International Committees, and as a U.S./Canada delegate to the World Service Meeting (1980-82).

LaVelle Clifford (228 Maricopa, El Paso, TX 79912) was a Panel 22 delegate, and was elected to the board in 1979 as Southwest U.S. regional trustee. Locally, she had served as group secretary, treasurer, program chairperson, intergroup secretary, and G.S.R. She helped organize the El Paso Central Office. She has served on two non-A.A. alcoholism bodies in her community, and retired from business life in 1972. LaVelle is a member of the Literature, Nominating, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

¹**Cecil ("Cec") E. Corrigan** (12-12th St. E., Prince Albert, Sask. S6V 2L9, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in 1976. He was a Panel 8 delegate. Cec has had more than two decades of experience in management of women's-wear and fur businesses, and also has interests in real estate. He chairs the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Archives and Correctional Facilities Committees and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

²**Donald F. Daly** (1361 Madison Ave., New York, NY 10028) was elected as a general service trustee in April 1980, to join the board in August. Don has served groups in Northport (Long Island), N.Y., and in Manhattan in most capacities, currently as a Grapevine representative. On the Grapevine Corporate Board since 1976, he becomes its chairperson upon starting his trusteeship. Don is an investment counselor, secretary of the Investment Counsel Association of America. He is a member

of the Conference and Finance Committees.

Jerry A. Danzig (993 Park Ave., New York, NY 10028) became a general service trustee in April 1977. Since 1972, he has been a director of A.A.W.S. He serves as chairperson of the Public Information Committee and a member of the Conference and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees. He served the New York Intergroup P.I. Committee for two years. Jerry has been officer of a broadcast network and special assistant to two New York governors. He is a partner in a management consultant firm.

George Dorsey (4761 Paradise Dr., Tiburon, CA 94920) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1978. He was a Panel 25 delegate and chairperson of the 1976 Conference Finance Committee. George had previously served as a G.S.R., D.C.M., and alternate delegate. Prior to general service activities, he served for several years in various capacities for the San Francisco Bay Area Intercounty Fellowship. George is vice-president and director of an insurance corporation. He serves as an A.A.W.S. director, chairperson of the Conference Committee, and member of the Employee Retirement, Finance, and Nominating Committees.

Richard J. Driscoll (129 Rhinebeck Ave., Springfield, MA 01129) was named Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1979 after serving as G.S.R., on P.I., C.P.C., institutions, and area committees, at an intergroup, and as a Panel 22 delegate. Besides belonging to various health and civic societies, Dick does volunteer work for two local non-A.A. alcoholism agencies. A licensed public accountant, he is now an officer in a bank and trust company. He is a member of the Committees on the Conference, Cooperation with the Professional Community, and Nominating.

²**Aime Dupont** (36 Albert St., Kamloops, B.C. V2B 4E8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1980. On May 19, Aime died while on a Twelfth Step call. Sober in A.A. since 1948, he had been a tireless worker in both general service and intergroup activities. A veteran in the construction business, Aime was just about to retire from his last position, as an officer of his union. After the usual procedure for choosing regional trustee candidates, a new Western Canada trustee will be elected in 1981.

²**M.T. (Bud) Grondahl** (65 16th Ave. N., Fargo, ND 58102) became West Central U.S. regional trustee in 1980. Long active in A.A. service work—at group, district, and area levels—Bud was a Panel 26 delegate. As chairperson of the 1977 Conference Grapevine Committee, he was involved in the expanded GvR program that helped move GV circulation past the 100,000 mark. Bud has been editor of the *Silver Dollar*, monthly A.A. newsletter, for more than 12 years. On the job, he is a claims representative with a Federal agency.

Virginia C. Hallman (4304 N. Alpine Ave., P.O. Box 11507, Shorewood, WI 53211) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1977. She was secretary of the Milwaukee Central Office four years and was a delegate (Panel 23). She has also been active as a volunteer in behalf of a recovery home for women and a local alcoholism council, and as an outside sponsor for a women's prison (for 20 years). She is office manager of a manufacturing concern. A World Service Meeting delegate and chairperson of the International Committee, Virginia also serves on the Archives and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Ruth K. Hartshorn (190-18 89th Ave., Hollis, NY 11423) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in 1977. She became a G.S.R. in 1961, has worked on all state and local conventions since 1963, was a Panel 23 delegate, and helps local intergroups. She operates an antiques and collectibles store, and is treasurer of a realty company. Ruth is chairperson of the Treatment Facilities Committee and a member of the International Convention A.A. Regional Forums and Public Information Committees.

Fernand Ippersiel (1025 Sherbrook E., #1504, Montreal, Que. H2L 1L5, Canada) was chosen Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1978. He was a Panel 18 Conference delegate and became editor of *La Vigne A.A.* in 1969. He was one of the translators of the Big Book and the Twelve Concepts into French. Fernand is a television director, chairperson of the Archives Committee, and a member of the Literature and Nominating Committees.

Martin Le Boutillier (1165 Fifth Ave., New York, NY 10029) started his general service trusteeship in April 1977. He is a former president of New York Intergroup. He has been a director of A.A.W.S. since 1974, is now its chairperson, and serves on the Finance, Cooperation with the Professional Community, and Employee Retirement Committees. Martin is an officer of a large Wall Street firm.

¹**Don Nicolson** (One Riverside, #602, Moorhead, MN 56560), elected West Central regional trustee in 1976, was a Panel 12 delegate. Don is president of a fast-food company operating in three states. He serves on the Conference, Nominating, and Finance Committees and is chairperson of the General Service Sharing Session and a director of A.A.W.S.

John Ryall (32 Garden Ave., Carle Place, NY 11514) was elected general service trustee in 1979, after three years as a Grapevine director. Besides filling all group offices, John has been a Conference delegate (Panel 21) and assembly treasurer. He was instrumental in founding the Northeast Region's Delegate Association. John is a marketing specialist for a major communications network. He serves on the Archives, Finance, and Nominating Committees and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

⁴**Edward J. Small** (P.O. Box 582, Cooper Union Sta., New York, NY 10003) was elected general service trustee in August 1976. After stints at all group jobs, Ed served New York Intergroup and became a regular Grapevine contributor. He is chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the Nominating Committee and also serves on the Employee Retirement, Public Information, and Treatment Facilities Committees. Ed directs a health program for a large publishing firm.

Samuel E. Smith (820 N.W. 87 Ave., Apt. 203, Miami, FL 33126) was elected from the Southeast Region in April 1977. Active in the Third Legacy since 1968, Sam served as a delegate on Panel 25. He has been active in local P.I. and has been an attorney 26 years. Sam is chairperson of the Literature Committee and a member of the Conference and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

1 Retiring at close of 1980 Conference meeting

2 New trustee, becoming a Conference member immediately after 1980 Conference meeting

3 New trustee, to begin serving August 1980

4 Retiring August 1980

1980 Conference Members

A.A. World Services directors

Martin Le Boutillier, <i>chairperson</i>	Phyllis Masback
John Bragg	Don Nicolson
Jerry Danzig	Robert Pearson
George Dorsey	Jacquelyn Solomon
Louis Kraus	

A.A. Grapevine directors

Edward Small, <i>chairperson, president</i>	Cecil Corrigan
Retha Gresham, <i>secretary, vice-president</i>	Virginia Hallman
Donald Daly, <i>treasurer</i>	Mary Phelps
Jeanne Conway	John Ryall
	Lucy Warner
	John Williams

General Service Office staff

Robert Pearson, <i>general manager</i>	Betty Liddle
Frank Mauser, <i>administrative assistant</i>	Phyllis Masback
Lyla Bonney	Vincina McCarthy
Susan Daly	Curtis Monahan
Lois Fisher	Sarah Price
Beth Kuhlmann	June Russell
	Helen Turnquest

Grapevine staff

Retha Gresham, <i>managing editor</i>	Tom Neary, <i>associate editor</i>
	Lucy Warner, <i>associate editor</i>

Others attending Conference (not as voting members)

Donna Berkowitz, *office manager*
 Norman Bradley, *supervisor, Data Control*
 Charles Clark, *supervisor, Mail Department*
 Charles Columbia, *assistant controller/internal auditor*
 Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
 Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
 Edward Gordon, *assistant controller/manager supporting departments*
 Shirley Grant, *personnel manager/interdepartmental coordinator*
 Janet Graves, *editor, Conference Report*
 Robert Hughie, *supervisor, Shipping Department*
 Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File Department*
 John Kirwin Jr., *supervisor, Accounting Department*
 Barry Leach, *writer, Conference Report*
 Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records Department*
 Dennis Manders, *controller/business administrator*
 Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*
 John L. Norris, M.D., *chairperson emeritus, General Service Board*
 Mary Anne O'Dea, *editorial assistant*
 Ann Warner, *writer, Conference Report*
 Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
 Adeline Wilmot, *assistant to the Conference secretary*
 Nell Wing, *archivist*

Two observers (nonvoting) from each of the following may also attend:

Trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities
 Trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community
 Trustees' Finance Committee
 Grapevine Editorial Board
 Trustees' Literature Committee
 Trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities
 Trustees' Public Information Committee

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 30th Conference includes Panel 29 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 30 (new delegates).

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	29	Mickey Boynton, 1034 S. Old Corry Field Rd., Pensacola, FL 32507
Alaska	2	30	Marjorie C. Farber, 3958 Reka Dr., Anchorage, AK 99504
Arizona	3	30	Irving (Irv) Poissant, P.O. Box 1662, Glendale, AZ 85311
Arkansas	4	29	Wayne Parks, 1120 W. Cypress, Rogers, AR 72756
California	5	29	Southern - Lucetta De Young, 119 California St. #26, San Gabriel, CA 91776
	6	29	Northern Coastal - Lois Jacobson, 102 Village Cir., Novato, CA 94947
	7	30	Northern Interior - Naydene Barnes, 1117 El Terino, Modesto, CA 95350
	8	30	San Diego - Gerald (Gary) Ulrici, 4619 Orchard, San Diego, CA 92107
	9	30	Mid-Southern - Denver Colvin, 4276 Agnes, Lynwood, CA 90262
Colorado	10	29	David I. (Dave) Buckley, 1422 Kern St., Colorado Springs, CO 80915
Connecticut	11	29	John A. Callaghan, 62 Forest Dr., Wethersfield, CT 06109
Delaware	12	30	Deborah (Debbie) C. Harrington, 202 Welwyn Rd., Woodbrook, Wilmington, DE 19803
District of Columbia	13	29	Jim Cooney, 10013 Sidney Rd., Silver Spring, MD 20901
Florida	14	29	Northern - Louis W. (Lou) Mobley, P.O. Box 474, San Mateo, FL 32088
	15	29	Southern - Carlos F. (Chico) Cortez, 1308 E. Libby Dr., West Palm Beach, FL 33406
Georgia	16	30	Joe Phelan, 272 The South Chace, Atlanta, GA 30328
Hawaii	17	29	Herb Weatherwax, 272 Ilihu St., Kailua, HI 96734

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Idaho	18	30	Patrick W. (Pat) Enright, 3409 Williamsburg Way, Boise, ID 83706	Missouri	38	29	Eastern – Elma F. Stone, 3411 Hinkson Creek Rd., Columbia, MO 65201
Illinois	19	29	Chicago – Tom Devereux, 2328 N. Normandy, Chicago, IL 60635		39	29	Western – George Van Dyke, 6038 Truman Rd., Kansas City, MO 64126
	20	30	Northern – LaVerne Peters, 1260 S. Walnut, Freeport, IL 61032	Montana	40	30	Perry Rodreick, P.O. Box 424, Laurel, MT 59044
	21	29	Southern – Hershell Hood, 711 St. Maud, Cahokia, IL 62206	Nebraska	41	30	Leslie (Les) Leuthaeuser, 1912 Avenue B, Scottsbluff, NE 69361
Indiana	22	29	Northern – Louise C. Holsten, 508 High St., Fort Wayne, IN 46808	Nevada	42	29	Ruth Jagodzinski, 2934 S. Lindell Rd., Las Vegas, NV 89102
	23	30	Southern – Ralph Richards, 13033 Shelborne Rd., Carmel, IN 46032	New Hampshire	43	30	James Nutting, 28 Linlew Dr., Apt. 24, Derry, NH 03038
Iowa	24	29	Dan Byrne, 2900 19th Ave., Marion, IA 52302	New Jersey	44	29	Northern – Herman H. (Hal) Halm Jr., 329 Hillside Pl., South Orange, NJ 07079
Kansas	25	30	Larry Trager, 2537 S. 12th Ter., Kansas City, KS 66103		45	30	Southern – Nancy McComas, 32 Paul Rd., Maple Shade, NJ 08052
Kentucky	26	30	Jacquelyn Jones, 4317 Brookhaven Ave., Louisville, KY 40220	New Mexico	46	30	Bruce Irwin, 1719 Avenida Cristobal Colon, Santa Fe, NM 87501
Louisiana	27	29	Bill Geer, 317 Peake St., Lake Charles, LA 70601	New York	47	29	Central – Judd H. Black, 725 Lake Shore Blvd., Rochester, NY 14617
Maine	28	30	Frank Anderson, 370 Main Ave., Hollowell, ME 04347		48	30	Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Robert L. Adams Jr., 33 Amsterdam Ave., Kingston, NY 12401
Maryland	29	30	Sunny Nisewaner, 3719 Carroll Dr., Turkey Point, Edgewater, MD 21037		49	29	Southeastern – Josephine (Jo) Kugel, 34-24 82nd St., Jackson Heights, NY 11372
Massachusetts	30	29	Eastern – Glenice M. Sheehan, 371 Chandler St., Tewksbury, MA 01876		50	30	Western – Joanne McCartin, 304 Charlesgate Cir., East Amherst, NY 14051
	31	30	Western – Gerard Page, 42 West Shore Dr., Enfield, CT 06082	North Carolina	51	29	Neil Dobbins, P.O. Box 7585, Asheville, NC 28807
Michigan	32	29	Central – Kenneth Himes, 1521 Pine Valley, Ann Arbor, MI 48104	North Dakota	52	30	Fred Marchand, P.O. Box 961, Watford City, ND 58854
	33	29	Southeastern – Ken Winegarner, 1144 Lakeview, Detroit, MI 48215	Ohio	53	29	Central & Southeastern – Anna M. Diggs, 1312 E. Broad St., Columbus, OH 43205
	34	30	Western – Ernest W. (Ern) Manzano, 410 McAllister Rd., Battle Creek, MI 49017		54	29	Northeastern – Terry Leach, 7009 Columbia Rd., Olmsted Falls, OH 44138
Minnesota	35	30	Northern – Don Mellem, Box 516, Hibbing, MN 55746		55	30	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan – Gerry McAvoy, 1711 Navarre Ave., Toledo, OH 43605
	36	29	Southern – Robert S. Bisanz, 13 Crocus Hill, St. Paul, MN 55102		56	30	S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky – Robert D. Campbell, 115 Gregory La., Hamilton, OH 45013
Mississippi	37	30	William H. (Bill) Carroll, P.O. Box 5397, Greenville, MS 38701				

1980 Conference Members

State	Area no.	Panel	Canada	Area no.	Panel
Oklahoma	57	29 LeRoy Belt, 2529 Cummings Dr., Oklahoma City, OK 73107	Province		
Oregon	58	30 Jack Denby, 1285 Monroe Way, Grants Pass, OR 97526	Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	30 Jack Braybrook, Box 693, Airdrie, Alta., Canada T0M 0B0
Pennsylvania	59	29 Eastern – Ambrose Mohan, 507 Corinthian Ave., Hatboro, PA 19040	British Columbia/ Yukon	79	29 Jack Ford, 3094 W. King Edward, Vancouver, B.C., Canada V6L 1V5
	60	29 Western – Ian McKenzie, 105 Siefert Rd., Coraopolis, PA 15108	Manitoba	80	30 E. Patrick (Pat) Walters, 18 Brereton Rd., Winnipeg, Man., Canada R2J 2T8
Rhode Island	61	30 John R. Saleses, 1250 Greenwich Ave., Apt. S, Warwick, RI 02886	New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	81	30 Kenneth M. (Ken) Fraser, 255 Dominion St., Moncton, N.B., Canada E1C 6H4
South Carolina	62	30 Roger Stevens, 1420 Nunamaker Dr., Columbia, SC 29210	Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	82	29 Leo Kelly, 2 Sanspeck Rd., Cornerbrook, Nfld., Canada A2H 4R2
South Dakota	63	30 Douglas Beck, 4932 W. Chicago, Rapid City, SD 57701	Ontario	83	29 Eastern–Wilfred J. (Will) O'Grady, 1107-465 Richmond Rd., Ottawa, Ont., Canada K2A 1Z1
Tennessee	64	30 Charles Ealy Sr., 317 Waters St., Lewisburg, TN 37091		84	29 Northeastern – Tina Martin, 409 Duke St. W., North Bay, Ont., Canada P1B 6E9
Texas	65	29 Northeastern – Hank Coleman, 2602 Wooddale, Wichita Falls, TX 76301		85	29 Northwestern – Allen (Al) Hurley, 113 Huntington Ct., Thunder Bay, Ont., Canada P7C 2B5
	66	30 Northwestern – Lorin Pigg, P.O. Box 311, Sanford, TX 79078		86	30 Western – B. M. (Murph) Outhwaite, Box 811, Shelburne, Ont., Canada L0N 1S0
	67	29 Southeastern – Dick White, 201 Winding Way, Lake Jackson, TX 77566	Quebec	87	30 Southwestern – Denis Longtin, 57 Tisseur St., Greenfield Park, Que., Canada J4V 3K6
	68	30 Southwestern – Raul A. Marin, P.O. Box 13115, San Antonio, TX 78213		88	29 Southeastern – Laurent Biron, 1700 O'Reilly, Sherbrooke, Que., Canada J1C 1C1
Utah	69	29 Frank Buffo, 155 E. 600 North, Spanish Fork, UT 84660		89	29 Northeastern – Louis M. Ladouceur, 1617 Ranvoys, Ste-Foy, Que., Canada G1W 3K1
Vermont	70	30 Betty Daniels, Dairy Hill Rd. South Royalton, VT 05068		90	30 Northwestern – Raymond Coutellier, 56 – 18th St., Laval, Que., Canada H7N 1G8
Virginia	71	29 Charles J. (Chuck) Roberts, P.O. Box 84, Gainesville, VA 22055	Saskatchewan	91	30 T. C. (Tom) McDonald, Box 283, Meadow Lake, Sask., Canada S0M 1V0
Washington	72	29 Terry Schemel, 609 Wood Pl. #2106, Everett, WA 98203			
West Virginia	73	29 Alfred E. (Al) Farley, P.O. Box 523, Charleston, WV 25322			
Wisconsin	74	30 N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan – Richard (Dick) Hahn, 308 Taylor St., Little Chute, WI 54140			
	75	29 Southern – Michael J. Kelly, 217 N. Spring St., Sparta, WI 54656			
Wyoming	76	30 Carl Budd, 1405 Collins, Rock Springs, WY 82901			
Puerto Rico	77	30 Felix J. Martinez, Box 82, Aibonito, PR 00609			

Literature distributed – 1979

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	310,160
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	155,070
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	37,110
A.A. Comes of Age	20,650
As Bill Sees It	38,850
Alcoholics Anonymous – Spanish edition	5,212
As Bill Sees It – Spanish edition	1,421
A.A. Comes of Age – Spanish edition	645
Total	569,118

Booklets

Living Sober	85,710
Came to Believe	41,500
Living Sober – Spanish edition	1,578
Total	128,788

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee (discontinued)	48,700
A.A. and the Armed Services	19,900
A.A. and the Medical Profession	48,400
A.A. for the Woman	176,400
A.A. — 44 Questions	351,700
The A.A. Group	87,700
A.A. in Hospitals (discontinued)	10,700
A.A. in Prisons	29,000
A.A. in Treatment Centers (new)	13,400
A.A. in Your Community (discontinued)	110,000
The A.A. Member	124,800
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	149,600
The A.A. Service Manual	20,500
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	60,600
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	19,900
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	241,400
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	44,500
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	46,900
Do You Think You're Different?	218,400
G.S.R.	48,400

How A.A. Members Cooperate	33,400
How It Works	161,300
If You Are a Professional	55,400
Inside A.A.	86,200
Is A.A. for You?	480,300
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	176,900
It Happened to Alice	92,200
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell (new)	31,000
The Jack Alexander Article	84,400
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	30,400
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	157,900
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	129,500
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	44,700
Problems Other Than Alcohol	129,000
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	168,800
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	39,900
This Is A.A.	394,700
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	43,700
Time to Start Living (new)	25,000
Too Young?	161,600
Twelve Concepts for World Service	4,900
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	65,300
Understanding Anonymity	107,200
What Happened to Joe	89,600
Young People and A.A.	198,500
Foreign translations	132,000

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards – two-fold	656,100
Wallet cards – I Am Responsible	103,100
Wallet cards – Anonymity	59,000
Parchment – scrolls	4,700
Placards	1,800
A.A. Guidelines	74,100
Group Handbook	3,800
Wire racks	1,200
Cassettes	3,100
A.A. Public Information Manual (discontinued)	2,700
Public Information Workbook (new)	300
Hanging displays	1,800
Fact Files	5,100
Total	916,800

Grapevine circulation – geographical breakdown

Circulation 4/1/80 – 121,000; circulation 4/1/79 – 113,000; increase for period – 8,000 (7%)

U.S.						U.S.						U.S.					
No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-	crease	No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-	crease	No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-	crease
3/79	3/80	4/1/79	4/1/80	U.S.		3/79	3/80	4/1/79	4/1/80	U.S.		3/79	3/80	4/1/79	4/1/80	U.S.	
Ala.	24	32	901	1,009	11	Mont.	25	43	655	667	1	P.R.	3	3	164	148	—
Alsk.	3	7	265	315	2	Nebr.	39	63	1,296	1,450	11	U.S. Poss.			150	148	—
Ariz.	45	85	1,145	1,226	7	Nev.	5	9	366	404	10		2,875	3,994	96,702	102,257	5½
Ark.	98	102	812	763	—	N.H.	9	17	649	671	3						
Calif.	247	316	10,037	10,664	6	N.J.	46	54	2,956	3,135	6						
Colo.	9	57	1,307	1,433	9	N.M.	20	28	598	655	9						
Conn.	23	28	1,862	1,873	—	N.Y.	159	201	7,579	7,863	3	Canada					
Del.	21	22	336	332	—	N.C.	55	71	2,138	2,432	13						
D.C.	68	67	710	725	2	N.Dak.	27	106	731	831	13	Alta./N.W.T.	28	51	1,897	2,171	14
Fla.	123	149	3,967	4,232	6	Ohio	210	256	3,811	3,947	3	B.C./Yukon	29	32	2,205	2,565	16
Ga.	33	87	1,758	1,979	12	Okla.	32	52	1,515	1,620	6	Man.	26	27	1,243	1,213	—
Haw.	53	59	320	296	—	Oreg.	30	40	990	1,020	3	N.B./P.E.I.	13	15	584	685	17
Idaho	26	30	575	593	3	Pa.	78	179	3,250	3,405	4	N.S./Nfld./					
Ill.	62	85	4,352	4,525	3	R.I.	32	35	560	621	10	Lab.	15	36	1,050	1,224	16
Ind.	55	66	1,698	1,809	6	S.C.	18	102	957	1,096	14	Ont.	211	263	5,850	6,892	17
Iowa	56	60	1,572	1,602	1	S.Dak.	10	11	811	735	—	Que.	6	8	750	752	—
Kans.	24	34	1,485	1,617	8	Tenn.	133	136	1,398	1,309	—	Sask.	30	38	1,222	1,489	21
Ky.	33	39	973	957	—	Tex.	84	114	4,106	4,350	5		358	470	14,801	16,991	15
La.	30	38	1,166	1,264	—	Utah	52	93	429	418	—						
Me.	13	17	628	706	12	Vt.	7	12	368	408	10						
Md.	56	65	2,004	2,036	1	Va.	202	276	2,511	2,921	16						
Mass.	51	78	4,367	4,691	7	Wash.	26	44	2,438	2,762	13	Foreign	14	17	1,497	1,752	17
Mich.	136	160	3,548	3,646	2	W.Va.	35	49	681	578	—						
Minn.	104	134	4,569	4,986	9	Wis.	73	91	2,684	2,731	1						
Miss.	13	20	630	688	9	Wyo.	45	47	319	327	2						
Mo.	14	25	1,605	1,783	11							Total	3,247	4,481	113,000	121,000	7

GvR activity recommended by 1977 Conference: circulation increase 4/1/77 - 4/1/80-32%